

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

TEACHING MANUAL

Content Creation

Session Roadmap · Lesson Notes · Concept Diagrams · Answer Keys

READY TO TEACH

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OVERVIEW

Course Roadmap

What we cover in every session

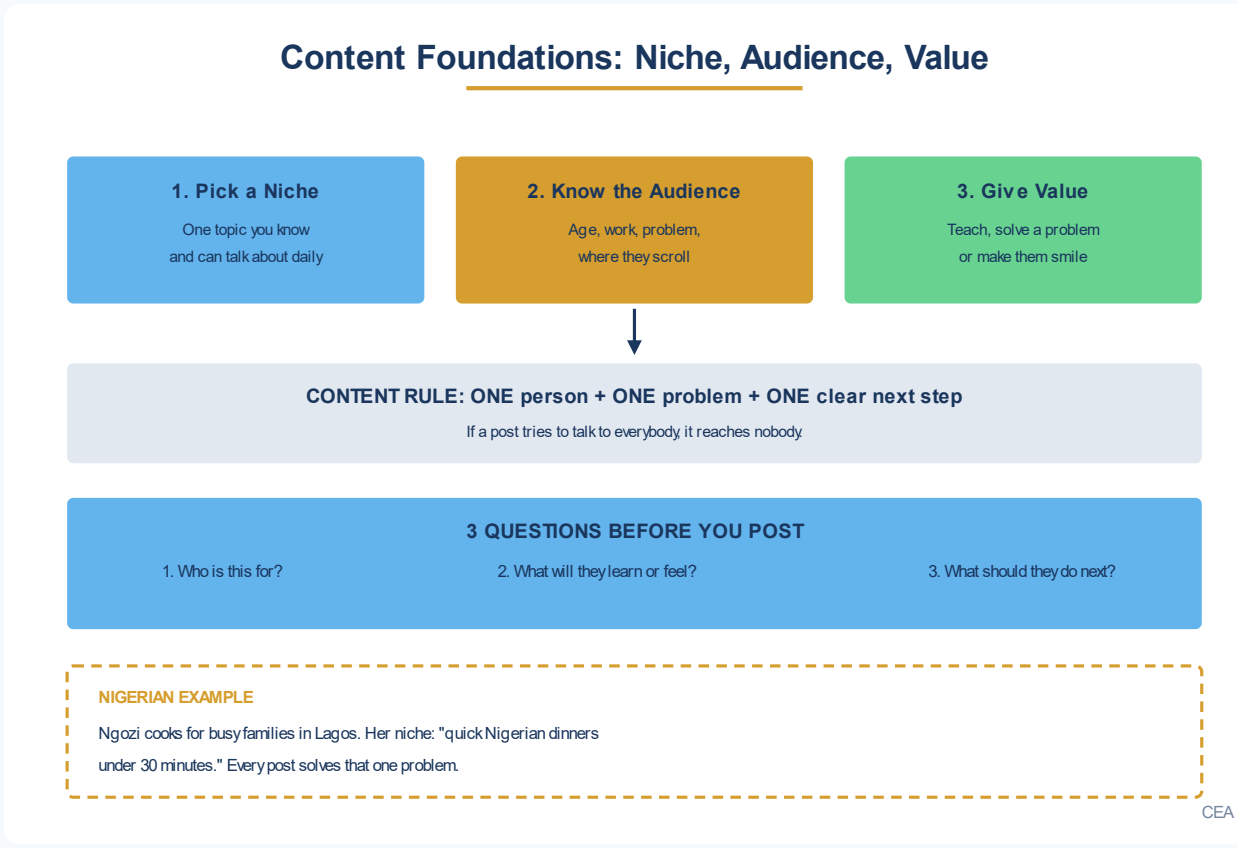
#	SESSION TOPIC	WEEK / MODULE	DURATION
01	Foundations	Week 1 â€" Module 1: See and Plan (Foundations)	105 minutes
02	Shooting	Week 1 â€" Module 1: See and Plan (Foundations)	105 minutes
03	Audio Script	Week 1 â€" Module 1: See and Plan (Foundations)	105 minutes
04	Edit Basics	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Production (Editing)	105 minutes
05	Edit Advanced Thumbnail	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Production (Editing and Graphics)	105 minutes
06	Copywriting	Week 2 â€" Module 4: Copywriting and Repurposing	105 minutes
07	Calendar Branding	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Publish, Measure and Package	105 minutes
08	Publish Analytics	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Publish, Measure and Package	105 minutes
09	Capstone	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Publish, Measure and Package (final session)	105 minutes

How to use this book: Each session below is a complete, ready-to-teach lesson note. Section A tells you what to prepare, B lists the outcomes, D–F are the teaching content, G–H are your demos and practicals, and the knowledge check with answer key is at the end. The concept diagram for each session is embedded as a visual aid.

SESSION 01 OF 9

Foundations

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 01



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 1 â€" CONTENT FOUNDATIONS: NICHE, AUDIENCE AND HOOKS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 9
Session title	Content Foundations: Niche, Audience and Hooks
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: See and Plan (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (no prior experience assumed)
Prerequisite knowledge	None. A learner only needs to own or have access to a smartphone with a camera and be able to open apps on it.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous session	This is the first session. It replaces the old habit of "posting randomly and hoping" with a clear method: choose a niche, know your audience, pick pillars, and lead with a strong hook. Every later session (shooting, editing, writing, publishing) depends on the decisions made today.
Preparation before class	On the projector: this session's slides or the three worksheets printed. Have the running capstone example ready â€" a fictional Port Harcourt fashion business called **Adaeze Fashion** â€" with a simple logo or name card on screen. Have Worksheet 1.1 ("My Niche and Audience") and Worksheet 1.2 ("Three Hooks and a Storyboard Seed") printed, one set per learner. Ensure the Wi-Fi is on in case learners want to look at example pages. Have a whiteboard and markers. No software is required for this session.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain in their own words** what content creation is and give one example of content that gives value to an audience.
2. **Define a niche** and explain why a focused niche beats posting about "everything".
3. **Build a simple audience avatar** naming who the audience is, what they need, and what stops them from getting it.
4. **Choose three content pillars** for a chosen niche and explain what kind of content belongs in each.
5. **Explain what a hook is** and why the first three seconds of a video decide whether the rest is watched.
6. **Write three hook lines** for a chosen topic in spoken, natural language (not labels).
7. **Distinguish value-driven posting from random posting** and justify a posting choice using the audience avatar.
8. **Produce a storyboard seed** â€" a three-line plan of the beginning, middle and end â€" for one of their hook ideas.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (used only as a writing/reference tool today; no filming yet). Learners without a phone share with a neighbour.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector or large screen.
- Whiteboard and markers.

Software

- None required for today. (CapCut and Canva are introduced in later sessions.)

Accounts

- None required today.

Sample files / examples

- The instructor prepares one screen showing the "Adaeze Fashion" name card (or simply writes it on the board): *Adaeze Fashion â€" Port Harcourt â€" affordable ready-to-wear for young working women.*
- Optional: three short example captions from everyday Nigerian businesses (a salon, a restaurant, a tailor) written out on screen, one strong and two weak, for the lecture on hooks.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 1.1 â€" "My Niche and Audience Avatar" (printed, 1 page).
- Worksheet 1.2 â€" "Three Hooks and a Storyboard Seed" (printed, 1 page).

Tools

- The learner's own notebook/pen for planning.

Internet

- Not required, but helpful if the instructor wants to show a couple of example pages. Do not depend on it.

Alternatives for learners who lack a facility

- A learner with no phone can complete every task on paper today. The planning skills (niche, audience, pillars, hooks, storyboard) are all pen-and-paper friendly. Pair them with a classmate who has a phone.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: Before class, write two questions on the board:

> ***1. Which Instagram/TikTok accounts do you always stop to watch? 2. How many of them make you buy something, learn something, or laugh?***

What the instructor says:

> *"Raise your hand if you have ever scrolled past a video in one second because it looked boring. (Most hands go up.) Now raise your hand if you have ever watched a whole video twice because it was interesting. (Many hands.)*
>
> *The difference between those two videos is not the phone. Both were probably shot on a phone like yours. The difference is **planning**. Somebody decided who the video was for and what the first second would say. That is content creation. Today we learn the thinking behind the video â€" before we ever touch a camera."*

Concrete hook (do this): Show or say three real first-lines (hooks) and ask learners to pick which one would make them keep watching:

1. *"Welcome to my channel, please subscribe."*
2. *"Adaeze Fashion â€" quality clothing."*
3. *"This â¦8,000 dress made a bride's sister cry at her wedding."*

Expected learner response: Learners almost always choose line 3 and can often say *why* â€" it tells a story, creates curiosity, mentions a price, and promises emotion. Confirm their instinct: **the first line is called a hook**, and it decides whether anyone hears the rest.

Why this opener works: It starts from something every learner already does (scrolling), proves they already have taste, and creates the exact problem the course solves: not "how do I get a good camera" but "how do I make people stop and watch."

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Since this is Session 1, there is no technical prerequisite. Instead, run a quick **experience round** to surface what learners already know and to build confidence. Put these three questions on the board and take short answers.

Question 1: "Name one business near your house that people talk about a lot. Why do people talk about it?"

- Expected answers: good food, good service, affordable price, funny owner, nice packaging.
- Purpose: this shows that "attention" comes from something specific and repeatable â€" not luck. That thing can be planned.

Question 2: "When you open YouTube or TikTok, what makes you decide to keep watching?"

- Expected answers: interesting start, it's funny, it's useful, someone I like is in it, the picture is clear.
- Purpose: connect to the idea of the **hook** and to quality.

Question 3: "Have you ever posted something and nobody watched it? Do you know why?"

- Expected answers: "I don't know", "maybe bad timing", "I didn't know who it was for".
- Purpose: name the gap. Most beginners do not know *who* they were talking to. Today we fix that with a niche and an audience avatar.

Gap handling: If the room is quiet, ask in pairs first ("turn to your neighbour, one minute"), then collect. Do not correct any answer as "wrong" â€" every honest answer is useful data. Bridge with this line:

> *"You already know when something is good to watch. Today we turn that instinct into a method any business can use."*

If the class is very new to the topic: spend two extra minutes asking each learner to say, in one sentence, a business or person they would like to make content for. This becomes their working project for the rest of the course.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What content creation actually is

The idea. Content creation is the work of planning, making and sharing material (videos, photos, graphics, captions) that gives something useful, entertaining or interesting to a specific audience.

Plain-English definition. Content creation is not "posting". Posting is pressing a button. Content creation is everything that comes *before* and *after* the button: deciding who you are talking to, what you will say, how you will shoot it, how you will edit it, the words you put around it, and when you put it out.

Why it exists. Businesses, churches and people need attention to grow, but attention is scarce â€" people scroll past thousands of posts a day. Content creation exists as a craft because *some* posts stop the scroll and most do not, and the difference can be learned.

What it does. Good content does at least one of these for the audience:

- **Informs** (a shop announces a new stock or a price),
- **Teaches** (a tailor shows how to measure a shoulder),
- **Entertains** (a restaurant owner does a funny skit),
- **Inspires** (a church shares a short encouraging word),
- **Connects** (a personal brand shares an honest story).

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader versus a quiet shop**. The quiet shop keeps its doors closed and hopes people come. The market trader calls out, shows samples, arranges goods attractively, and knows exactly which customers buy what. Content creation is the trader's skill: showing and telling the right people, in the right way.

Common misconception. "Content creation is about being famous." Not true. A tailor with 200 local followers who buy is more successful than a random account with 50,000 followers who buy nothing. We create content to **reach and serve a specific audience**, not merely to collect followers.

Limitation. Content creation cannot fix a bad product. Content can bring people to a business; it cannot make them happy if the product or service is poor. Content and quality must work together.

How a learner recognises content creation in the wild. Look at any account that grows steadily. You will find a clear topic (niche), a consistent look (branding), strong first lines (hooks), and regular posting. None of that happens by accident.

F.2 Choosing a niche â€" focus beats "everything"

The idea. A **niche** is the specific subject or area your content focuses on.

Plain-English definition. Your niche answers the question: *"What am I mainly about?"* Examples: affordable fashion for young women; local Port Harcourt food; church teaching clips; small-business photography tips; secondary-school maths lessons.

Why niche matters. Social platforms and audiences reward focus. If your page is about *everything* â€" fashion today, football tomorrow, prayer the next day â€" the platform does not know who to show it to, and the audience does not know why to follow. A clear niche tells both the platform and the audience exactly what to expect. Expectation builds trust; trust builds growth.

What a good niche looks like. It is usually the overlap of three things:

1. **What you know or can produce** (your skill or access).
2. **What people want** (a real need or interest).

3. **What you can keep doing** (turning up regularly, even when you are busy).

Write this on the board as three overlapping circles. The niche is the middle.

Analogy. A niche is like a **signboard on a shop**. "Shoes and bags" tells a customer instantly. "We sell many things" tells them nothing, so they walk past.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion. Adaeze sells clothes in Port Harcourt. "Fashion" alone is too broad. Narrow it: *affordable ready-to-wear for young working women in Port Harcourt.* Now we know who she is for: young women who work and want to look good without spending a fortune. This is specific enough to plan a week of posts around.

Misconception 1: "A niche is too small â€" I'll run out of things to post." In practice, a narrower niche makes posting *easier*, because everything you shoot is on-topic. **Misconception 2:** "I must pick forever." No. Start focused; you can widen or adjust later once you know what your audience responds to.

Limitation. A niche is a starting boundary, not a cage. The same business can still post a variety of formats (video, photo, story, testimonial) â€" as long as they serve the same audience.

F.3 Defining the target audience â€" the audience avatar

The idea. Your **target audience** is the specific group of people your content is made for. An **audience avatar** is a simple, friendly description of one typical person in that group, so you stop talking to "everybody" and start talking to a real person in your head.

Why it exists. When you try to speak to everyone, you move nobody. When you picture one person â€" Mama Ngozi who runs a small restaurant, or Chinedu who just finished NYSC â€" your words become specific, warm and useful, and specific content performs better.

What an avatar includes (keep it short):

- **Name and age** (make a realistic person).
- **What they do** (job, business, school, church, family).
- **What they need** (the problem your content helps with).
- **What stops them** (money, time, trust, fear, location).
- **Where they spend time online** (TikTok, Instagram, YouTube, WhatsApp status).
- **What they react to** (price, honesty, humour, results, faith).

Analogy. An avatar is like writing a **letter to one friend** instead of shouting into a market. A letter can be personal; a shout cannot.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion's avatar.

Field	Example
Name	Blessing
Age	27
What she does	Works at a bank in Port Harcourt, lives in Rumuokoro
What she needs	Smart, affordable outfits she can wear to work and church
What stops her	Busy; dislikes long shopping trips; afraid of being overcharged
Where she is online	Instagram and WhatsApp status in the evening
What she reacts to	Price shown clearly, real photos, fast replies

Now every Adaeze Fashion post can ask: "*Would Blessing stop for this? Does it answer her worry about price? Can she act on it easily?*"

Common misconception. "My audience is everyone." Say gently: if everyone is your audience, no one feels spoken to. Also: the avatar is a helpful picture, not a rule that excludes people â€" it just keeps your message sharp.

Limitation. An avatar is a starting guess. Real comments, questions and DMs are the ground truth. Update the avatar as you learn what your real audience actually asks.

F.4 Content pillars â€” the three (or four) themes you rotate

The idea. Content pillars are the two to four main themes your content rotates around within your niche. If the niche is your shop, the pillars are the shelves.

Why they exist. Without pillars, you stare at your phone asking "what do I post today?" Pillars answer that question ahead of time. They also keep your content balanced: not all selling, not all jokes, not all teaching.

Common pillar sets. A simple and reliable set for a small business:

1. **Value / teaching** â€” tips and how-tos that help the audience (e.g., "3 ways to style one skirt").
2. **Showcase / product** â€” the actual products or services, shown attractively.
3. **Trust / behind-the-scenes** â€” real people, real process, real stories (the tailor at work, a happy customer).
4. **Connection / humour or faith or community** â€” light, human content that builds warmth.

Worked example â€” Adaeze Fashion's pillars:

- **Style tips** (how to combine outfits for work and church)
- **New arrivals & offers** (clear price posts)
- **Customer stories** (a real buyer wearing the outfit; behind-the-scenes of packing orders)

Analogy. Pillars are like a **restaurant menu with sections**: starters, mains, drinks. Customers know what to expect, and you always know what to cook.

Common misconception. "Every post must sell." If every post says "buy, buy, buy", the audience gets tired and stops following. Teaching and trust content earns the right to sell occasionally.

Limitation. Pillars should not be so rigid that you ignore a timely opportunity (e.g., a festival or a customer request). Pillars guide; they do not forbid.

F.5 The hook â€” why the first 3 seconds decide everything

The idea. A **hook** is the opening of your content â€” the first sentence, the first frame, the first three seconds â€— designed to make a person stop scrolling and keep watching.

Why it exists. People scroll fast. If the first moment is slow, unclear or dull, they leave, and nothing later can be seen. The hook is the doorway: if nobody comes through the door, the beautiful room inside does not matter.

Plain-English definition. A hook is a reason to keep watching, given in the very first second or two.

What makes a strong hook (the C-P-C pattern):

- **C â€” Curiosity:** make them want to know the rest ("You have been tying your wrapper the wrong way").
- **P â€” Problem or promise:** name the pain or the reward ("This 1 trick saves â‚¦2,000 per style").
- **C â€” Clarity:** still tell them what the video is about â€— mystery without meaning bores people.

Worked example â€” turning a weak opener into a hook.

Weak (no hook)	Strong (hook)
"Hi everyone, welcome to my page."	"If you have less than 5 minutes to dress, watch this."
"Today I want to talk about dresses."	"This â‚¦8,000 dress made a bride's sister cry."
"Please follow for more fashion."	"Three outfits, one skirt â€— under â‚¦12,000."

How long is "the hook"? On short-form video, roughly the **first 3 seconds** (sometimes 1 second). It can be a spoken line, on-screen text, a movement, or a striking first image â€— often all of them together.

Analogy. A hook is like the **first page of a novel** or the **first drumbeat of a song**. If the opening does not grab you, you close the book or change the song.

Common misconception. "The hook is only the words." No â€— the first *visual* matters just as much. A dark, shaky first frame with no face and no text can lose people even with a clever line.

Limitation. A hook promises; the **body of the video must deliver** on that promise. A hook that tricks people into watching something disappointing loses trust and hurts future posts. Honest hooks only.

F.6 Value-driven posting versus random posting

The idea. Value-driven posting means every post is made with a clear reason and a clear audience in mind. **Random posting** means posting whatever comes to mind, whenever, with no plan.

Why it matters. Random posting is tiring and inconsistent â€" you post for two days and disappear for two weeks, and the audience never learns what to expect. Value-driven posting is repeatable: you know your niche, your avatar, your pillars and your hooks, so you can plan a week in one sitting.

A simple test for any proposed post. Ask these three questions:

1. **Who is this for?** (Name the avatar.)
2. **What does it give them?** (Inform, teach, entertain, inspire or connect â€" choose one.)
3. **What should they do next?** (A clear next step â€" the call-to-action, taught in Session 6.)

If you cannot answer all three, the post is probably random.

Analogy. Value-driven posting is like a **shop that opens at the same time every day with goods arranged on purpose**. Random posting is a shop that opens whenever the owner feels like it and sells whatever is left in the store.

Misconception. "Being planned means being boring or fake." No â€" planning makes space for your real personality, because you are no longer panicking about what to post.

Limitation. Value-driven posting still requires consistency to work. One excellent planned post a month will not grow an audience; steady, on-topic posting will. Consistency is taught properly in Session 7.

F.7 The running example â€" Adaeze Fashion

Throughout this course we use one fictional Port Harcourt business so every learner can see the same method applied end to end. Introduce it clearly today:

> ***Adaeze Fashion*** *â€" a small ready-to-wear fashion business in Port Harcourt, run by a young woman named Adaeze. It sells affordable clothes to young working women. Its content niche is "affordable, smart outfits for young working women in Port Harcourt." Its audience avatar is Blessing (Section F.3). Its pillars are style tips, new arrivals/offers, and customer stories. It is preparing for a* ***launch week*** *and needs a full week of content â€" which becomes the capstone.*

Learners may adopt Adaeze Fashion or bring their own small business/personal brand with instructor approval. Using one shared example makes it easier to compare work and give feedback, while still allowing learners to personalise.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

This session's demonstration is a **live planning demonstration** on the board and projector. The instructor builds an entire content plan for a business the class can see, thinking aloud.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- Whiteboard split into four areas: **Niche**, **Avatar**, **Pillars**, **Hooks**.
- A simple "business card" on the projector: a second fictional business, different from Adaeze Fashion, so learners see the method transfer. Use **"Mama Ekaette's Kitchen"** â€" a small restaurant in Port Harcourt selling local dishes.
- The three example captions from Section C (one strong, two weak).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" building a niche and avatar live (5 minutes)

Say: "Watch how I turn a vague business into a clear plan. I will think out loud."

Do this step by step:

1. Write the raw business: *"Mama Ekaette's Kitchen â€" we sell food."*
2. Narrow it into a niche: *"Affordable home-style Nigerian lunches for workers in Port Harcourt."* Explain the three circles: what they know (cooking), what people want (cheap filling lunch), what they can keep doing (cooking daily).
3. Build the avatar in the Avatar column:

Name	Age	Does	Needs	Stops them	Online	Reacts to
Emeka	34	Government office worker	Hot, filling, affordable lunch near work	Short lunch break; no time to cook	WhatsApp status, Facebook	Price, speed, real food photos

4. **Ask the class:** "*Should Mama Ekaette post a video about her new kitchen tiles, or about a â,¦1,500 lunch that fills you till evening?*" Let them answer. Guide them to see that the second speaks to Emeka's actual need.

Expected result: a visible niche and avatar on the board. **Reasoning to state aloud:** "I keep choosing the option that answers Emeka's real worry â€" price and time. That is what makes content useful."

Errors to watch and correct: Learners may suggest "everybody in Port Harcourt". Correct gently: name one real person. Also correct "we sell food" as too broad to plan around.

Questions to ask: "Who exactly is Emeka?" "What is he afraid of when he buys lunch?" (Being hungry again, or being overcharged.)

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" pillars and a hook (10 minutes)

Say: "Now I choose three pillars and write a hook that would stop Emeka's thumb."

Step by step on the board (Pillars column):

1. **Value/teaching:** "How to eat well on â,¦1,500 a day in Port Harcourt."
2. **Showcase/offer:** "Today's plate: rice, beans, stew and chicken."
3. **Trust/behind-the-scenes:** "How we cook our stew from scratch every morning."

Then write hooks (Hooks column) and evaluate against the C-P-C pattern (Curiosity, Problem/Promise, Clarity):

- Weak: "*Come and buy our food.*" â†' No curiosity, no reason.
- Better: "*This â,¦1,500 lunch keeps office workers full until 6pm.*" â†' Promise + clarity + price.
- Strong: "*If lunch always finishes your salary by the 10th, watch this.*" â†' Curiosity + problem + clarity.

Ask learners to rate each hook using the pattern. **Expected result:** learners can point out that strong hooks name a real problem and still say what the video is about.

Deliberately demonstrate a weak hook and fix it: Show the three captions from Section C. Ask the class to rank them, then rewrite the weakest one together on the board.

Errors to watch and correct:

- Hooks written as labels ("fashion video") instead of spoken lines. Fix: say it the way a person talks.
- Clickbait hooks that promise something the video does not deliver. Explain that trust is the real asset.
- Overlong hooks â€" the hook should fit in the first breath.

Questions to ask throughout: "Who is this for?", "What does it give them?", "Would Emeka stop scrolling?", "Does the hook deliver what it promises?"

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner produces a one-page plan for a business or personal brand of their choice: a niche, an audience avatar, three content pillars, and three hooks.

Starting materials: Worksheet 1.1 ("My Niche and Audience Avatar"), Worksheet 1.2 ("Three Hooks and a Storyboard Seed"), a pen, and (optionally) a phone for reference.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. **Choose your subject.** Write the name of one business or personal brand you will plan for this week. It may be your own, a family business, a church, or a fictional one. Example: "*Chisom's Salon*" or "*Adaeze Fashion*".
2. **Write the raw description** in one line: what does it sell or offer, and to whom roughly? Example: "*A salon in Port Harcourt that does braids and natural hair.*"
3. **Narrow it into a niche** using the three circles (what you know / what people want / what you can keep doing). Write it in one clear sentence.

4. **Build your audience avatar** in the table on Worksheet 1.1: name, age, what they do, what they need, what stops them, where they are online, what they react to.
5. **Pause and predict:** Before moving on, ask learners to say aloud: *"My avatar's biggest worry is ____."* (e.g., "cost", "time", "trust"). This worry should shape the hooks.
6. **Choose three content pillars.** Pick from: value/teaching, showcase/product, trust/behind-the-scenes, connection/humour/faith. Write a one-line example post idea under each pillar.
7. **Write three hooks** for your business, using the C-P-C pattern. Each hook must be a *spoken line*, not a label. Example for the salon: *"If your braids always pull at the edges, this style protects your hairline."*
8. **Check each hook** against the three questions: Who is it for? What does it give them? Does it say clearly what the video is about?
9. **Storyboard seed (Worksheet 1.2):** pick your best hook and write three quick lines â€" **Beginning** (the hook moment), **Middle** (the main point), **End** (what the viewer should do next). This is the seed of a storyboard you will draw properly in Session 3.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Will our hooks talk about price, speed, or results? It depends on the avatar's worry."
- After step 7: "Which of your three hooks would make *you* stop scrolling? Why?"

Expected result: each learner has a completed Worksheet 1.1 (niche + avatar + pillars) and the top half of Worksheet 1.2 (three hooks), plus a three-line storyboard seed.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner stuck on niche â†' ask "What could you make 20 posts about without getting bored?"
- Avatar too broad ("everybody") â†' ask "Give me one specific person's name and job."
- Hooks sound like labels â†' ask the learner to *say* it out loud to you as if to a friend; write down what they said.
- Hooks all about selling â†' remind them of the pillars; ask for one teaching hook and one trust hook.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ I wrote one clear niche sentence.
- ☐ I completed the audience avatar with a real obstacle.
- ☐ I chose three content pillars with one example idea each.
- ☐ I wrote three hook lines in spoken language.
- ☐ I checked each hook with the three questions.
- ☐ I wrote a three-line storyboard seed.

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Plan content for a *different* business on your own, without copying your practical work or your neighbour's.

Scenario: You have been asked to help **Grace's Provisions**, a small neighbourhood shop in Port Harcourt that sells rice, beans, oil, tomatoes and other food items. The shop owner, Grace, says customers always wait until prices rise before they buy, and she wants to help them save money and buy smart. Grace posts only rarely and does not know who to talk to.

Requirements:

1. Write a **niche sentence** for Grace's Provisions (one line).
2. Build a short **audience avatar** (name, what they do, what they need, what stops them).
3. Choose **three content pillars** with one example post idea each.
4. Write **three hooks**, each using at least two of the C-P-C elements. At least one hook must be about *saving money* and at least one must be *teaching* something.
5. Write a **three-line storyboard seed** for your best hook.

Constraints:

- Do not use the same niche wording you used in the practical.
- Every hook must be a spoken line, not a label.
- Keep the whole thing to the space on Worksheet 1.2 (or one notebook page).

- No copying.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- The niche is specific and clearly tied to the shop.
- The avatar names a real obstacle.
- The three pillars are different from one another.
- The three hooks each work on their own (you could say them aloud and they'd make sense).
- The storyboard seed has a clear beginning, middle and end.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Grace's customers care about **price changes**. A teaching hook like *"Buying beans now could save you money next month â€" here's why"* uses curiosity and a promise.
- Hint 2: A trust pillar could be "how we check our tomatoes are fresh before selling."
- Hint 3: For the storyboard, keep it to three beats: hook, main point, next step.

Instructor answer key / model (do not show learners until after time is up):

Niche: "Affordable food staples for families in Port Harcourt who want to buy smart before prices rise."

Avatar:

Name	Does	Needs	Stops them	Reacts to
Mama Chidi	Runs a small food business from home	Fresh staples at the best price	Busy; doesn't know when prices will rise	Clear prices, freshness, trustworthy shopkeeper

Pillars:

1. **Value/teaching:** "When to buy beans, rice and oil to beat price rises."
2. **Showcase/offer:** "Today's fresh stock and price board."
3. **Trust:** "How we store and sort our food items for freshness."

Hooks:

1. *"Rice is about to go up â€" buy this week and stop overpaying."* (Curiosity + problem/promise + clarity)
2. *"The onion test: how to know fresh onions in 3 seconds."* (Curiosity + teaching + clarity)
3. *"Why buying in bulk now is cheaper than buying small-small later."* (Promise + clarity + money)

Storyboard seed (hook 1):

- **Beginning:** Text on screen: "Rice price warning" + spoken line "Rice is about to go upâ€¦"
- **Middle:** Show the price board; explain how small early buying saves money.
- **End:** "Visit Grace's Provisions this week â€" prices won't wait."

Marking guidance (out of 10):

- Specific niche (2)
- Avatar with a real obstacle (2)
- Three distinct pillars (2)
- Three spoken hooks using C-P-C (2)
- Hook quality â€" could genuinely stop a scroll (1)
- Clear three-beat storyboard seed (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ngozi* runs a small catering business from her kitchen in Port Harcourt. She cooks for small events â€" birthdays, church gatherings, office parties. She has a smartphone and posts occasionally, but her posts are inconsistent. Sometimes she posts a photo of a pot of jollof rice with the caption "Better food 4 u". Sometimes she posts nothing for three weeks. She gets

almost no bookings from her page; all her customers come by word of mouth. She is frustrated and wants to give up on "social media".

Relevant facts.

- Ngozi cooks very well; her word-of-mouth reputation is strong.
- Her page does not say what she does, who she cooks for, or how to book.
- She posts whatever she is doing that day, with no plan.
- She has never chosen a niche or described an audience.
- Competitors who post clean, clear content get more enquiries even though their food is not better.

Decision point. Should Ngozi (a) keep posting random food photos and hope, (b) give up on content and rely only on word of mouth, or (c) pick a niche, define her audience, choose pillars and write strong hooks?

Possible approaches.

1. **Keep posting randomly.** Free, but it is not working and wastes effort.
2. **Abandon content entirely.** Word of mouth still works, but it does not scale and she stays invisible to new customers.
3. **Plan like a creator.** Ngozi chooses a niche ("affordable event catering for small church and office gatherings in Port Harcourt"), builds an avatar (a church committee member booking food for 40 people), picks pillars (menus/prices, behind-the-scenes cooking, happy customers), and writes hooks such as *"Feeding 40 people on a small budget? This menu did it."*

Recommended solution. Approach 3. It costs nothing but an hour of planning, and it turns her existing skill and reputation into visible, bookable content.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 requires no effort but repeats the failure.
- Approach 2 protects her from effort but caps her growth.
- Approach 3 takes a planning session and consistent effort, but every post now works toward bookings, and her excellent cooking finally gets discovered.

Professional connection. Every content agency and social media manager starts by asking the same four questions: *What is the niche? Who is the audience? What are the pillars? What are the hooks?* Ngozi's problem is the exact problem professional creators solve. Learners who master this session's skills can charge to solve it for businesses like hers.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the session's live guide. When a learner gets stuck, ask them to check the relevant row before giving the answer.

K.1 The niche is too broad

Symptoms: The niche reads like "fashion", "food", "music" or "everybody". **Likely cause:** The learner is afraid to leave people out. **How to investigate:** Ask, "Can you name 10 different posts that all clearly belong to this topic?" If not, it is too broad. **Corrective steps:** Narrow by **audience** (who), **place** (where) or **problem** (what they need). Example: not "food", but "affordable office lunches in Port Harcourt". **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can name three on-topic pillars and one specific person the content is for. **Prevention:** Always finish a niche by naming the audience it serves.

K.2 The audience avatar is really "everyone"

Symptoms: Avatar row says "men and women, all ages" or "anybody who likes fashion". **Likely cause:** The learner has not pictured a real person. **How to investigate:** Ask for one person's name, age and job. **Corrective steps:** Build the avatar around one realistic person, like Blessing or Emeka. Everyone is still welcome to consume the content â€” the avatar just sharpens the message. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can state the avatar's biggest worry in one sentence. **Prevention:** Name the obstacle, not just the person.

K.3 Pillars all say "sell"

Symptoms: All three pillars are variations of "promote the product". **Likely cause:** The learner thinks content equals advertising. **How to investigate:** Count how many pillars teach, help or build trust. **Corrective steps:** Replace at least one pillar with value/teaching and one with trust/behind-the-scenes. **How to confirm resolved:** At least one pillar would be useful even to someone who never buys. **Prevention:** Rotate teaching and trust between selling posts.

K.4 Hooks are labels, not spoken lines

Symptoms: Hooks read like "fashion tips video" or "product post". **Likely cause:** The learner is describing the post instead of opening it. **How to investigate:** Ask the learner to *say the hook aloud to you* as if to a friend. **Corrective steps:** Write down exactly what they said aloud. That spoken version is the hook. **How to confirm resolved:** The hook sounds natural when spoken and creates curiosity or names a problem. **Prevention:** Always test hooks by saying them out loud.

K.5 Hooks that overpromise (clickbait)

Symptoms: The hook promises something the video never delivers. **Likely cause:** The learner is chasing attention only. **How to investigate:** Ask, "Does the video actually show or answer this?" **Corrective steps:** Change the hook to promise only what the content honestly gives. **How to confirm resolved:** After watching the content, the learner still believes the hook was fair. **Prevention:** Remember that trust is the asset; keep hooks honest.

K.6 Nobody can tell what the business is

Symptoms: After the plan, a stranger still cannot say what the business sells or to whom. **Likely cause:** The niche sentence is vague. **How to investigate:** Show the niche sentence to a classmate and ask them to explain it back. **Corrective steps:** Rewrite until a classmate can repeat it correctly. **How to confirm resolved:** A classmate can restate the niche and audience without help. **Prevention:** Test every niche sentence on one other person.

Likely vs confirmed: Each "likely cause" becomes a "confirmed cause" only after you check it â€" for example, by trying to name 10 on-topic posts, or by asking a classmate to explain the niche back. Always confirm before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Niche and Three Hooks"

Purpose: Apply this session's planning method to the learner's own chosen subject (their own business, family business, church, personal brand, or a fictional one with instructor approval), producing the foundation of the capstone.

Realistic scenario: You are the content planner for your chosen business or brand. Before making a single video, you must clearly define who you serve and how you will speak to them, because in later sessions you will shoot, edit and publish based on this plan.

Detailed instructions:

1. On one page, write your chosen business/brand name.
2. Write your **niche** in one clear sentence (audience + place/problem).
3. Complete an **audience avatar** with: name, age, what they do, what they need, what stops them, where they are online, what they react to.
4. Choose **three content pillars** and write one example post idea under each.
5. Write **three hooks** for the business, each a spoken line using at least two C-P-C elements (Curiosity, Problem/Promise, Clarity).
6. For your best hook, write a **three-line storyboard seed** (beginning, middle, end).
7. Add one short paragraph: "*Why did I choose this niche and audience?*"

Required deliverables:

- A one-page typed or handwritten sheet containing the niche, avatar table, three pillars, three hooks, storyboard seed, and the reflection paragraph.
- Photograph your page and keep the photo, or submit the handwritten sheet, ready to bring to Session 2.

Submission format: Handwritten page photographed and shared in the class folder, or a typed document. Keep it accessible because it becomes capstone Checkpoint 1.

Deadline: Before Session 2.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Specific niche	3	Narrow, audience-focused, believable

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Audience avatar	4	A realistic person with a genuine obstacle
Three content pillars	3	Distinct, balanced (not all selling), with example ideas
Three hooks	4	Spoken lines, use C-P-C, genuinely could stop a scroll
Storyboard seed	3	Clear beginning, middle and end beats
Reflection paragraph	2	Honest reasoning for the niche and audience
Presentation / neatness	1	Clear, legible, complete

Common mistakes to avoid: niche too broad; avatar = "everyone"; all pillars about selling; hooks written as labels; forgetting the obstacle in the avatar.

Instructor reference solution:

Business: "Bright Cuts Barbershop, Port Harcourt." *Niche:* "Affordable, clean, quick haircuts for young men in Port Harcourt who care about looking sharp." *Avatar:* Chidi, 24, university student, needs a neat cut he can afford and trust not to be botched; stops him â€" bad past haircuts and unclear prices; online â€" TikTok and WhatsApp; reacts to â€" before/after results, price, speed. *Pillars:* 1) Value â€" "How to describe the cut you want so you never get it wrong." 2) Showcase â€" "Today's fresh cut and price." 3) Trust â€" "Meet the barber; see how we sanitise our clippers." *Hooks:* 1) "If your last haircut was a disaster, it's not your fault â€" it's how you explained it." 2) "This cut takes 15 minutes and costs less than a plate of food." 3) "Three signs you're going to the wrong barber." *Storyboard seed (hook 1):* Beginning â€" "Last cut went wrong?" on screen, spoken line. Middle â€" show the three words to use when describing a cut. End â€" "Book Bright Cuts â€" get the cut you actually asked for."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers are in the Instructor Key below. Do not show learners the key until they have attempted all questions.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what is content creation, and how is it different from just "posting"?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which is the *best* example of a specific niche? a) Fashion b) Food c) Affordable ready-to-wear for young working women in Port Harcourt d) Everything I like

Q3. Explain in your own words. Why is it a problem to say "my audience is everybody"?

Q4. Practical identification. Look at this avatar row and say what is missing: *"Audience: young people who like nice things."*

Q5. Error / scenario. A learner writes this hook: *"Fashion video, watch it."* Explain two things wrong with it and rewrite it as a stronger hook.

Q6. Short answer. Name the three parts of the C-P-C hook pattern and give a one-line example that uses all three.

Q7. Explain in your own words. Why do content pillars make posting easier?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. Content creation is the whole work of planning, making and sharing material that gives value to a specific audience â€" choosing who it is for, what it says, how it is shot and edited, and the words around it. "Posting" is just pressing the button; content creation is everything before and after the button.

A2. (c) â€" it names a clear audience, product and place.

A3. Because if you speak to everyone, no one feels spoken to; the platform cannot tell who to show your content to, and your message becomes vague. A specific avatar makes the wording sharp and useful.

A4. Missing: a specific audience (a real person), what they *need*, and what *stops* them. It should name one real person, their need and their obstacle.

A5. Problems: (1) it is a label, not a spoken line; (2) it gives no curiosity, promise or reason to watch â€" it doesn't say who it is for or what it delivers. Strong rewrite example: *"This â‚¦8,000 dress made a bride's sister cry at the wedding."* (Accept any hook that is a spoken line and uses C-P-C.)

A6. C = Curiosity (make them want to know more), P = Problem or Promise (name the pain or reward), C = Clarity (still say what the video is about). Example: *"If lunch finishes your salary by the 10th, this â‚¦1,500 plate will fix that."*

A7. Because pillars answer the question "what do I post today?" ahead of time. They give you ready themes to rotate, keep your content balanced, and keep you consistent with your niche. (Accept any answer mentioning planning ahead and consistency.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that content creation is not about having an expensive camera â€" it is about clear thinking. You chose a **niche** (what you are mainly about), built an **audience avatar** (one real person you are speaking to), picked **content pillars** (the themes you rotate), and learned that a **hook** â€" the first 3 seconds â€" decides whether anyone watches the rest. You also saw the difference between **value-driven posting** and random posting, and you practised all of it on real, familiar Nigerian businesses.

Five important takeaways:

1. Content creation is planning + making + sharing value for a specific audience â€" not just pressing "post".
2. A focused niche beats posting about everything.
3. Your audience avatar should be one realistic person with a real need and a real obstacle.
4. Three content pillars (value, showcase, trust) keep you balanced and consistent.
5. The hook â€" the first 3 seconds â€" decides whether the rest of your content is ever seen.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I write my niche in one clear sentence?
- Can I describe one real person my content is for, including what stops them?
- Can I name three pillars and give an example post for each?
- Can I write a hook that makes *me* want to keep watching?
- Can I tell whether a planned post is value-driven or random?

Connection to the next session. You now know *what* you will make and *for whom*. Next session we pick up the phone and learn to **shoot** that content: how to hold the phone steady, how to use light, how to frame with the rule of thirds, which shot types to use, and when to shoot vertical or horizontal. The hooks and storyboard seed you wrote today become the plan for what you will actually film next.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner writes a niche specific enough to plan around and can defend it.
- Learner's avatar names a real person with a genuine obstacle, not "everybody".
- Learner's pillars are balanced â€" at least one teaches or builds trust rather than selling.
- Learner's hooks are spoken lines that create curiosity and are still clear.
- Learner can look at a weak hook and explain *why* it is weak, then improve it.
- Learner connects hooks to the avatar's worry ("she fears being overcharged, so I mention price").

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Content creation = buying a good camera." â†' Correct: it starts with planning; great cameras on unplanned content still fail.
- "My niche is too small." â†' Correct: narrow makes posting easier and audiences trust focus.
- "My audience is everyone." â†' Correct: everyone means no one; name one person.
- "The hook is only the spoken words." â†' Correct: the first visual matters equally.
- "Every post should sell." â†' Correct: teaching and trust earn the right to sell.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Niche narrowing drill:** give five broad topics (fashion, food, music, faith, fitness) and ask the learner to narrow each to a place + audience + problem.
2. **Avatar builder:** hand out a blank avatar card and a photo or description of a real customer; complete it together.
3. **Hook rewrite:** give five weak openers ("Hi guys welcome back") and ask the learner to rewrite each as a strong spoken hook using C-P-C.
4. **Sort the pillars:** give eight example posts and ask the learner to sort them into value, showcase, trust.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a half-completed Worksheet 1.1 with the niche already chosen and the avatar table partly filled; the learner completes the obstacle and writes two hooks with help.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise and assignment as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** write a *fourth* pillar (e.g., a community/humour pillar), write five hooks, and add a short paragraph explaining how each hook targets a specific worry of the avatar. Optionally, plan two different avatars for the same business and compare which content suits each.

Timing guidance. The lecture and demonstration are the backbone of this session; protect at least 18 minutes for the guided practical (Section H) because the learner's personalised plan carries into every later session. If time runs short, shorten the case study (Section J) to a two-minute mention and reduce the independent exercise to two hooks instead of three â€" but never skip the guided practical, since it produces the learner's own working plan.

END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Shooting with Your Phone.

SESSION 02 OF 9

Shooting

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 02



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 2 â€" SHOOTING WITH YOUR PHONE

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 9
Session title	Shooting with Your Phone
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: See and Plan (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (no prior camera experience assumed)
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 concepts: niche, audience avatar, pillars and hooks. A learner should have chosen a subject/business and written at least one hook. If a learner missed Session 1, give them

Item	Detail
	the two-minute catch-up: "Choose a business and one hook idea before we shoot."
Connection to previous session	In Session 1 learners decided *who* the content is for and *what* it says. Today they learn to capture it: how to hold the phone, use light, frame a shot, choose shot types and settings, and plan a shot list. The raw footage shot today becomes the material edited in Week 2.
Preparation before class	Charge phones where possible; ensure at least one tripod or phone stand per 2â€"3 learners; have the ring light ready; find a room or area with good window light; have Worksheet 2.1 ("Shot List") and Worksheet 2.2 ("Rule of Thirds Practice") printed; prepare one sample clip shot badly and one shot well for demonstration. Ensure Wi-Fi is on for any app installation needs. Clear a space where learners can move and shoot safely.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain why** a smartphone camera can produce professional-looking video and list the factors that matter more than the camera itself (stability, light, framing, audio).
2. **Hold or mount a phone** so that footage is stable and shake-free, using a tripod, stand or improvised bracing.
3. **Use light correctly** â€" natural window light, a ring light, and simple fill â€" and **avoid backlighting**.
4. **Apply the rule of thirds** when framing a subject.
5. **Identify and use** at least four shot types: wide, medium, close-up and over-the-shoulder.
6. **Choose vertical or horizontal** framing appropriate to the target platform and explain the reason.
7. **Set basic phone camera options** â€" resolution, focus lock, grid and exposure â€" for a clean shot.
8. **Build a shot list** that plans at least five shots for a short piece of content.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone with a working camera per learner (shared is fine).
- Tripod or phone stand: academy-provided. Ideally one per 2â€"3 learners. Improvised stands (stacked books, a wall ledge, a chair back) are acceptable and should be demonstrated.
- Ring light (academy-provided, at least one), plus access to natural window light.
- Optional: earphone mic (introduced fully in Session 3) for demonstration.

Software

- The phone's built-in camera app. No other software is required today.
- Optional: any free camera app that allows grid and manual focus; the built-in app is usually enough.

Accounts

- None required today.

Sample files / examples

- Instructor prepares two short sample clips (both under 15 seconds) recorded *before* class: one deliberately shaky, dark and backlit; one stable, well-lit and framed with the rule of thirds. Store on the instructor's phone or the academy computer.
- A printed or on-screen example shot list.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 2.1 â€" "Shot List" (printed, 1 page with ~6 rows: shot number, shot type, description, notes).
- Worksheet 2.2 â€" "Rule of Thirds Practice" (one page with a light grid overlay for sketching frames).

Tools

- Whiteboard and markers.

- A wall or window area clear for the lighting demonstration.

Internet

- Not required for shooting. Wi-Fi helpful only if a learner needs to install or update a camera app.

Alternatives for learners who lack a facility

- Learners without a phone pair with a classmate and act as director ("move closer", "hold steady") â€" directing is the same skill. They can also use academy devices if available. All planning work (shot list, framing sketches) is done on paper and is fully valid.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: Play (or describe) the two sample clips back to back: the bad clip first, then the good clip. Both feature the same person â€" ideally the instructor or a willing learner â€" saying the same short line (e.g., "*This is Adaeze Fashion â€" affordable outfits for working women*").

What the instructor says:

> *"Both of these clips were shot on a phone. Same phone, in fact. Same person. Same words. So why does the first one look like a homemade video and the second looks like something a real brand posted?*
>
> *(Wait for answers.)*
>
> *It is not the phone. The phone cost the same. The difference is **how it was shot**: the second one was steady, it had good light, the person was framed properly, and we could hear clearly. That is the whole secret of shooting with a phone. Today you learn those four things.*"

Concrete hook (do this): Ask the class to clap once, then clap again but with their hands held far apart and loose. Ask: "Which clap was clearer?" (The firm, close one.) Say:

> *"That is what it feels like when footage is stable and clear versus shaky and messy. Viewers decide in the first second â€" just like the hook we learned last time.*"

Expected learner response: Learners usually say the second clip was "brighter", "not shaking", "the person was clear". Confirm: those are **light**, **stability** and **framing** â€" the three pillars of shooting â€" and today we master them.

Why this opener works: It destroys the myth that gear is the problem and replaces it with specific, learnable skills on the phone the learner already owns.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run a quick oral round-robin. Put these questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is a niche? Give your own example."

- Expected answer: the specific subject your content focuses on, e.g., "affordable office lunches in Port Harcourt".
- Common gap: learners give a broad topic ("food"). Remind them: audience + place + problem.

Question 2: "What is a hook, and how long do you have to grab attention?"

- Expected answer: the opening of your content; roughly the first 3 seconds (sometimes 1).
- Common gap: thinking the hook is only words. Remind them the first *visual* counts too â€" which is exactly why today's shooting matters.

Question 3: "From your Session 1 plan, what is one hook you will shoot today, and who is it for?"

- Expected answer: a learner's own hook and their avatar.

- Common gap: learners who did not complete the assignment. Pair them with someone who did, and ask them to adopt that classmate's plan for today's practical (with permission).

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Last time you decided what to say and who to say it to. A great hook written on paper is useless if the video looks dark and shaky â€" people scroll before they hear your words. Today we make sure the picture earns the hook a chance."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1 or 2: spend 10 extra minutes reviewing niche/audience/hooks from Session 1 before continuing, using the whiteboard. Shooting is only worthwhile if there is a plan behind it.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Your phone is a real camera â€" and the myths

The idea. The camera in a modern smartphone is genuinely capable of professional-quality video. The things that once required expensive equipment â€" decent resolution, slow motion, good autofocus â€" are now in almost every phone.

Plain-English definition. "Shooting" means capturing the video and audio you will later edit. A shot is a single continuous recording from one camera position.

Why the myth exists. People believe good video needs an expensive camera (a "DSLR" or "cinema camera"). Those cameras are useful, but they only matter *after* the basics. A well-shot phone video beats a badly-shot professional-camera video almost every time, because viewers care about clarity, stability, light and sound â€" not the brand of the camera.

The four factors that matter more than the camera:

1. **Stability** â€" no shaking.
2. **Light** â€" bright, even, on the subject's face.
3. **Framing** â€" the subject well placed in the frame.
4. **Audio** â€" clear sound (fully covered in Session 3).

Analogy. A phone camera is like a **good pen**. A skilled writer with a simple pen produces better work than a careless writer with an expensive fountain pen. The tool helps, but the hand matters more.

Common misconception. "More megapixels = better video." For video, megapixels are far less important than light, stability and focus. A 12-megapixel phone with good light beats a 48-megapixel phone shot in a dark room.

Limitation. Phone cameras struggle in very low light, produce "grainy" (noisy) footage, and have limited zoom before the picture gets soft. We work *with* these limits: shoot in good light, avoid heavy digital zoom, and move the phone closer instead of zooming.

How a learner recognises good phone footage. Steady, bright on the face, subject clearly placed, and easy to hear. If any of those is missing, the phone is not the problem â€" the technique is.

F.2 Stability â€" no shaky video

The idea. Stability means the phone does not shake while recording. Shaky footage is one of the fastest ways to lose a viewer.

Why it exists as a skill. Handheld phones move with every heartbeat and breath. Without support, even a calm hand produces micro-shakes that look unprofessional and can make viewers feel uncomfortable.

How to get stable footage:

1. **Use a tripod or phone stand.** This is the easiest and best method. Set it to the subject's eye level.
2. **Improvise a stand** when there is no tripod: stack books, rest the phone on a wall or table edge, or use a chair back. Make sure it cannot slide or fall.
3. **Brace your body** if handheld: hold the phone with both hands, tuck your elbows into your ribs, plant your feet shoulder-width apart, and hold your breath for a few seconds while recording.
4. **Move slowly** and deliberately if you must move; avoid fast pans.
5. **Lean on something:** a wall, a doorframe or a table can steady you.

Analogy. Holding a phone steady is like **pouring water into a cup** â€" small movements spill everywhere. Supporting the phone is like setting the cup on a table first.

Worked example. For a talking-head clip of Adaeze Fashion's owner, the phone sits on a tripod at her eye level, about 1.5 metres away. No movement at all. For a handheld walkthrough of the shop, the operator holds the phone with both hands, elbows tucked, and walks slowly to reduce bounce.

Common misconception. "A little shake is fine, editing will fix it." Video stabilisation in editors can help a *little*, but it crops and softens the image and cannot fully rescue badly shaky footage. Get it right at the moment of shooting.

Limitation. Some artistic content uses intentional movement (a smooth reveal, a slow push-in). This is fine â€" intentional movement is different from accidental shaking. The rule is: be *in control* of the camera.

F.3 Lighting â€" natural light first, ring light second, never backlight

The idea. Lighting is how the subject is lit. Good light is bright, soft and on the subject's face. Most beginner footage fails because of light, not framing.

Why it exists as a skill. Phone cameras need light to record clean images. In dark scenes, the camera raises its "ISO" (light sensitivity) and the image becomes grainy and soft. More light = cleaner picture.

The three working light sources for this course:

1. **Natural window light.** The best and cheapest source. Put the subject a step or two *facing* a window. Outside it may be the sun; inside it is the window. Soft daylight is ideal.
2. **Ring light.** A circular light, often mounted around the phone or on a stand, that lights the face evenly and adds a nice small catch in the eyes. Great for indoor talking-head videos, especially in the evening.
3. **Simple fill.** If one side of the face is much darker, add a second light (a ring light, a lamp, or a white reflective surface such as a white wall or a piece of white card) on the dark side to soften shadows.

The most common lighting mistake â€" backlighting. Backlighting means the bright light (a window or the sun) is *behind* the subject, so the camera sees a bright background and a dark face. The subject looks like a silhouette. Fix: turn the whole setup around so the light is *in front of* the subject's face, or move the subject so they face the light.

Analogy. Lighting a person is like lighting a **portrait on a wall**. If the lamp is behind the painting, the painting looks dark. The lamp must be in front unless you want a silhouette.

Worked example. Adaeze shoots at 10am in a room with one big window. She places her chair facing the window (not with her back to it). The window floods her face with soft light; the background is a plain wall behind her. The result is a bright, even face and a clean background.

Common misconception. "Brighter is always better." Not quite â€" *hard* light (direct harsh sun) creates ugly strong shadows and makes people squint. Prefer *soft* light: open shade, a window, or a ring light. Also avoid mixed colours (a yellow bulb plus blue daylight can make skin look odd).

Limitation. At night, natural light is gone, so a ring light or a well-placed lamp is essential. Phone "night mode" is for photos, not ideal for smooth video; prefer adding light.

F.4 Framing and the rule of thirds

The idea. Framing is where you place the subject and the scene inside the phone screen. The **rule of thirds** is a simple guide for placing things attractively: imagine the screen split into a 3Ã—3 grid (two vertical lines, two horizontal lines). Put the important things on or near those lines and their crossings, not dead centre.

Why it exists. The rule of thirds gives a balanced, professional look that "feels right" to the eye. Placing a person exactly in the middle can look flat; placing them slightly to one side and their eyes near the top line looks natural.

How to apply it:

1. Turn on the phone's **grid** (a setting in almost every camera app), which draws the 3Ã—3 lines for you.
2. For a talking-head video, place the subject on one of the vertical lines (left or right), not the exact centre.
3. Place the **eyes** near the top horizontal line.
4. Leave **headroom** â€" a little space above the head, not a large gap.
5. Use the empty side ("**lead space**" or "**looking room**") for on-screen text, so the text does not cover the face.

6. Keep the **horizon** level and on a horizontal line if shooting landscape.

Analogy. The rule of thirds is like **hanging a picture on a wall** â€” it looks best slightly off-centre and at the right height, not shoved into the middle.

Worked example. A close-up of Adaeze speaking: her eyes sit on the top-left crossing point, she is placed on the left vertical line, and the right two-thirds of the frame is empty background where we will add the caption text and the price.

Common misconception. "The subject must be in the centre." Centring is fine for some shots (a direct, symmetrical product shot), but for most people-on-camera shots, the rule of thirds looks better. Both are valid tools.

Limitation. The rule of thirds is a *guideline*, not a law. Sometimes a centred or symmetrical frame is exactly right (a product shot, a formal announcement). Use it as a reliable default.

F.5 Shot types â€” wide, medium, close, over-the-shoulder

The idea. A **shot type** describes how much of the subject and scene fills the frame. Mixing shot types keeps content interesting and gives the editor choices later.

Shot type	What it shows	Best used for
Wide (establishing)	The whole scene/room; the person is small	Showing where we are; setting the scene
Medium	The person from about the waist up	Talking to camera; most common shot
Close-up	The face, hands or a product in detail	Emotion; showing a detail like fabric or a price tag
Over-the-shoulder	Looking past the subject at what they see	Demonstrations, unboxing, showing "how it's done"

Why mixing matters. If every shot is a medium shot of the same person, the video feels flat. A wide to open, a medium to talk, a close-up to show the detail, and an over-the-shoulder to demonstrate makes the content feel alive â€” and gives the editor material to cut between.

Analogy. Shot types are like the **pages of a photo album**: wide photos show the place, close photos show the smiles. Together they tell a story.

Worked example. A 30-second Adaeze Fashion video might be: wide shot of the shop (establishing), medium shot of Adaeze explaining the outfit (talking), close-up of the fabric and stitching (detail), over-the-shoulder shot of her packing the order (action).

Common misconception. "Close-ups are only for faces." Close-ups are excellent for products, hands, textures and prices.

Limitation. Very wide shots on a phone can look empty or grainy; very tight close-ups may lose focus, because phones have a "minimum focus distance" â€” if too close, the image blurs. Move back a little and zoom gently or tap the subject to refocus.

F.6 Vertical or horizontal â€” which platform wants which

The idea. Vertical footage is tall (like the phone held upright); **horizontal** footage is wide (like a TV). You choose based on where the content will be watched.

Why it matters. Most short-form social platforms (TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, WhatsApp status) are watched on a phone held upright, so they prefer **vertical**. Longer, "cinema-style" content (a full YouTube video, a landscape product demo) may suit **horizontal**.

Rule of thumb for this course: choose **vertical (9:16)** for the short 30â€“60 second videos in the capstone, because they are made for phone-first platforms. Choose **horizontal (16:9)** only when you know the content is for a wide screen (a TV, a laptop, YouTube long-form, or an in-store screen).

A trap to avoid â€” mixing orientations in one edit. If you shoot some clips vertical and some horizontal, the editor has to crop or add big black bars, which looks messy. Decide the orientation *before* you shoot and keep it consistent for the whole video.

Analogy. Vertical vs horizontal is like **choosing a portrait or landscape painting** to fit the wall you will hang it on. Match the shape to the space.

Worked example. Adaeze Fashion's launch-week reels are all shot vertical, because they will be posted as Reels and TikToks. The only horizontal footage they keep is a longer "about the shop" video for their Facebook page.

Common misconception. "I can always crop later." Cropping vertical from horizontal loses most of the frame and quality; cropping horizontal from vertical adds bars. Shoot the right orientation now.

Limitation. Some phones default to the orientation of the first frame; check before recording, because rotating mid-clip produces footage that is wrongly oriented.

F.7 Phone settings for a clean shot

The idea. A few simple camera settings improve every shot. You do not need to change much â€" just the right few.

Settings to set once:

1. **Resolution and frame rate.** Set video to **1080p (Full HD)** at **30fps** (frames per second) as the safe default. 1080p is sharp enough and not too heavy. Some phones offer 4K, but 1080p is lighter to edit. Keep 30fps for normal talking and demonstrations. (Higher fps like 60 is for smoother motion or slow-motion; it also takes more storage.)
2. **Grid.** Turn the grid **on** â€" it draws the rule-of-thirds lines.
3. **Storage awareness.** Check free storage before a shoot. HD video fills a phone quickly.

Settings to use while shooting: 4. **Focus and exposure lock.** Tap and hold on the subject's face until you see "AE/AF Lock" (Auto Exposure / Auto Focus lock). This stops the camera from "hunting" for focus or changing brightness mid-shot. To unlock, tap elsewhere. 5. **Exposure adjustment.** After locking, a little sun-slider appears; slide up to brighten, down to darken. Nudge slightly brighter if the face is dark. 6. **Do not use digital zoom.** If you need to be closer, *walk* closer. Digital zoom makes the picture soft. 7. **Tap record and let it run with a small buffer.** Start recording a couple of seconds *before* the action and stop a couple of seconds *after*, so the editor has room to trim (you will use this in Session 4).

Analogy. These settings are like **checking your car mirrors before you drive** â€" small habits that prevent big problems.

Common misconception. "Higher resolution is always better." 4K is great but heavy; for phone-based editing, 1080p is the smart default because it edits smoothly and saves storage.

Limitation. Different phones place the grid and focus-lock slightly differently. The instructor should demonstrate on a couple of phones, or ask learners to find the settings on their own device with help.

F.8 Planning a shot list

The idea. A **shot list** is a simple written plan of the shots you will capture: what each shot shows, its type, and any notes. It is the shooting version of the storyboard.

Why it exists. Without a shot list, you shoot randomly, then discover in editing that you are missing a key shot (for example, no close-up of the product). With a shot list, you shoot with purpose and save time.

A shot list usually has:

- Shot number (1, 2, 3â€¦)
- Shot type (wide / medium / close-up / over-the-shoulder)
- Description (what happens / what is shown)
- Notes (location, lighting, who is speaking, any text on screen)

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion, 30-second launch reel (vertical):

#	Type	Description	Notes
1	Close-up	Text on screen: "New drop" + hand pulls a dress off the rack	By the window, bright
2	Medium	Adaeze smiles and says the hook line	Tripod, eye level, face the window
3	Close-up	Fabric and stitching detail	Slow, steady; tap to lock focus
4	Over-the-shoulder	Adaeze packing the dress into a branded bag	Rear camera; steady hands or tripod
5	Medium	Adaeze says the call-to-action + price	Same setup as shot 2

Analogy. A shot list is a **shopping list**. You go to the market with it so you come home with everything you need instead of forgetting the onions.

Common misconception. "Shot lists are only for professionals." Beginners benefit most, because they forget shots they cannot re-shoot easily.

Limitation. A shot list is a guide, not a script set in stone. If you spot a better shot on location, take it â€” then update the plan.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- One phone, one tripod, one ring light.
- Two pre-recorded sample clips (bad and good) from Section D.
- A window area and a plain wall.
- A willing learner as the subject (or the instructor films themselves).
- Worksheet 2.1 (Shot List) visible on projector.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” stability and framing (7 minutes)

Say: "Watch how the same shot changes when I fix stability and framing."

Do this step by step on the projector or big screen:

1. First, record a deliberately shaky shot: hold the phone one-handed, arms out, and pan quickly. Play it back. Ask: "How does this feel?" (Uncomfortable.)
2. Now set the phone on the tripod at eye level. Turn on the grid. Place the subject on the left vertical line with eyes near the top line.
3. Record a steady medium shot. Play it back.
4. **Ask:** "What changed?" (Steady, balanced, professional.)

Expected result: a visibly steadier, better-framed clip. **Reasoning to state aloud:** "The camera didn't change â€” the support, the grid and the placement did."

Deliberate error to show and correct: Put the subject dead centre with too much headroom, then correct it to the rule of thirds. **Say:** "Small changes, big difference."

Questions to ask: "Where should the eyes sit?" "What do we do with the empty side of the frame?" (Leave it for text.)

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” lighting, then the backlight mistake (8 minutes)

Say: "Light is the number-one thing beginners get wrong. I will show you both the right way and the wrong way."

Step by step:

1. Put the subject **facing the window**. Record a 10-second clip. Play it back. Point out the bright, even face.
2. Now move the subject so the window is **behind** them. Record again. Play it back. The face is now dark â€” this is **backlighting**.
3. **Ask:** "Which looks like something a brand would post?" Let learners explain.
4. Fix it: move the subject back to face the window, or add a ring light in front. Record again â€” bright again.
5. Turn off the window light metaphorically by moving to a dim corner, then switch on the ring light and show how it lights the face evenly.

Expected result: learners can instantly tell good front-lighting from bad backlighting and describe how to fix it.

Errors to watch and correct:

- Subject squinting in harsh sun â†' move to open shade or a window.
- Ring light too close/harsh â†' move it back, or diffuse by angling it.
- Mixed colour light (window + yellow bulb) â†' turn one off or match them.

Questions to ask: "Which direction is the light coming from?" "Is the light on the face or behind the head?" "If this were posted now, would people see her face?"

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” a quick shot list walk-through (optional if time)

Show the Adaeze Fashion shot list (Section F.8) on the projector and explain how each line tells the shooter what to capture and why. Emphasise that the editor in Week 2 will be grateful for the close-ups and over-the-shoulder shots.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner or pair shoots a short clip (about 10â€"15 seconds) applying **good lighting** and the **rule of thirds**, using a tripod/stand or braced stance.

Starting materials: A phone, tripod/stand (shared), a window area, Worksheet 2.2 for framing sketches, and one hook line from Session 1.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. **Open the camera app** and turn the **grid** on (settings).
2. **Set video to 1080p, 30fps** (or the closest available).
3. **Choose your location:** face the strongest light (a window or outdoors in shade). Never put the light behind the subject.
4. **Set the phone on the tripod/stand** at the subject's eye level, or brace it firmly and stand steady.
5. **Frame using the rule of thirds:** place the subject on a vertical line; put the eyes near the top horizontal line; leave the empty side for text.
6. **Tap and hold on the face** to lock focus and exposure; nudge the exposure slider so the face is bright but not blown out.
7. **Pause and predict:** before recording, ask the pair: "If we post this right now, is the face bright and is the framing balanced? Predict whether viewers would keep watching."
8. **Record 10â€"15 seconds.** Have the subject say the hook line from Session 1. Hold still. Count three seconds before and after the speech.
9. **Play it back.** Check: steady? bright face? subject on a thirds line? clear enough?
10. **Improve in one take:** change one thing (move closer for a medium shot, or add fill light) and record again.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 5: "Where is the empty space, and what will we put there?" (Text/caption.)
- After step 7: "Will this be too dark or too bright? Why?"

Expected result: each learner/pair has at least two clips â€" a first attempt and an improved one â€" that are steady, well-lit and framed on the rule of thirds.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Face is dark â†' light is behind the subject; turn the setup around.
- Footage is shaky â†' use the stand, or brace elbows into the ribs.
- Subject in the centre â†' turn on the grid and move them to a line.
- Blurry subject â†' too close; move back slightly and tap to focus.
- "AE/AF Lock" won't hold â†' different phones differ; demonstrate on that device.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Grid is on and used.
- ☐ Video resolution set to 1080p/30fps.
- ☐ Subject is facing the light (no backlight).
- ☐ Focus/exposure locked on the face.
- ☐ Subject placed on a rule-of-thirds line.
- ☐ Clip is steady.
- ☐ At least two takes, with one improvement made.

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: On your own, plan and shoot a **5-shot sequence** for a *new* short piece of content, using a shot list.

Scenario: *Mama Ngozi's Kitchen*, a small restaurant in Port Harcourt, wants a 20â€“30 second vertical clip to show "how we prepare our famous pepper stew". You are the shooter. You must plan a shot list first, then shoot the shots.

Requirements:

1. Complete a **shot list** (Worksheet 2.1) with **five shots** for this clip. Use at least **three different shot types** (from wide, medium, close-up, over-the-shoulder).
2. Decide the orientation: **vertical** (this is for Reels/TikTok). Write it at the top of your shot list.
3. Make sure **at least one shot is a close-up** of a product or detail, and **at least one is over-the-shoulder**.
4. Note the **lighting plan** for each shot (window light / ring light / shade) in the Notes column.
5. Shoot the five shots. Each clip should be 3â€“8 seconds. Keep the phone steady and framed on the rule of thirds.
6. Add **two seconds of extra recording** at the start and end of each shot (buffer for editing).

Constraints:

- Five shots only â€” no more, no less.
- All shots **vertical** and consistent.
- No backlighting.
- No digital zoom â€” move the phone instead.
- Time: 15 minutes total (plan first, then shoot).

Success criteria:

- Shot list complete with 5 shots and at least 3 types.
- At least one close-up and one over-the-shoulder shot present.
- All five clips are steady, well-lit and correctly framed.
- Orientation is consistently vertical.
- You can explain, for each shot, its type and why you chose it.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: A natural 5-shot sequence: (1) wide of the kitchen, (2) over-the-shoulder of chopping, (3) close-up of the sizzling pepper, (4) medium of the cook stirring and smiling, (5) close-up of the finished plate with text space.
- Hint 2: If the kitchen is dark, put your subject (the cook) facing a window or use the ring light in front.
- Hint 3: Leave the empty side of close-up frames for the caption text you will add in editing.

Instructor answer key / model (do not show learners until time is up):

#	Type	Description	Notes
1	Wide	The kitchen and cook at the counter	Window light; vertical; leaves room for title text at top
2	Over-the-shoulder	Chopping peppers and onions (hands and board in view)	Cook faces window; steady
3	Close-up	Pepper sizzling in the pan	Lock focus on pan; ring light if dim
4	Medium	Cook stirs and smiles toward camera	Cook faces window; rule of thirds, cook on left line
5	Close-up	Finished plate of stew; empty side for price/caption	Good light; leave right side clear for text

Orientation: vertical (9:16). *Lighting:* window light for 1, 2, 4; ring light or window for 3 and 5.

Marking guidance (out of 10):

- Complete 5-shot list with types (2)
- At least 3 shot types used (2)
- Close-up and over-the-shoulder included (1)
- Lighting plan noted and followed (2)
- Steady, correctly framed footage (2)
- Consistent vertical orientation (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Emeka* is the media volunteer at a mid-sized church in Port Harcourt. He records the Sunday service on his phone to post a short recap clip during the week. His clips always look dark (the church auditorium has big windows *behind* the pulpit), sound far away, and are often shaky because he films standing in the aisle. The pastor is happy the church is posting, but the clips get few views and members do not share them.

Relevant facts.

- The strongest light (the windows) is **behind** the preacher â€" classic backlighting.
- Emeka films handheld from the back of the hall, so the subject is far away and tiny.
- He never plans shots; he just records and posts.
- The phone and the church's willingness are both fine; the *technique* is the problem.

Decision point. Should Emeka (a) keep filming the same way, (b) buy an expensive camera to "fix" it, or (c) change his shooting technique â€" reposition for light, get closer, stabilise and plan shots?

Possible approaches.

1. **Keep filming as before.** No change, so no improvement.
2. **Buy a better camera.** The camera is not the problem; the same backlight and distance would still hurt a pricier camera.
3. **Change the technique.** Move to a position where the preacher faces the light (or bring a light in front), shoot from nearer the front, brace the phone or use a small tripod, and plan three key shots (wide of the auditorium, medium of the preacher, close-up of a worshipper's hands or the choir).

Recommended solution. Approach 3. It costs nothing but attention and produces a dramatic improvement.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 repeats the failure.
- Approach 2 spends money without solving the actual cause.
- Approach 3 requires Emeka to move during the service and plan ahead, but it directly fixes lighting, distance and stability â€" the real causes.

Professional connection. Every professional videographer scouts the location for light and chooses camera positions before shooting. The rule "face the light, get close, stay steady, plan your shots" is exactly what paid shooters do. Emeka's fix is a professional habit, not a beginner trick.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

K.1 The subject's face is dark (backlighting)

Symptoms: The background is bright but the face is dark or shadowed. **Likely cause:** The main light (window/sun) is behind the subject. **How to investigate:** Look at where the light is coming from relative to the subject. **Corrective steps:** Turn the setup so the subject faces the light, or move the subject, or add a ring light in front. **How to confirm resolved:** The face is clearly bright on the playback. **Prevention:** Before every shot, ask "which way is the light coming from?"

K.2 Footage is shaky

Symptoms: The image moves, wobbles or bounces. **Likely cause:** Handheld one-handed filming; fast movement; heavy breathing. **How to investigate:** Watch the playback; notice where the shake happens. **Corrective steps:** Use a tripod/stand; brace elbows into the ribs; plant feet; record in shorter, still segments. **How to confirm resolved:** The playback is smooth. **Prevention:** Default to a stand; only hand-hold with a braced stance.

K.3 Subject is blurry

Symptoms: Soft or out-of-focus subject. **Likely cause:** The phone is too close (closer than the minimum focus distance); focus was not locked; or the phone moved. **How to investigate:** Tap the subject and watch whether it sharpens. **Corrective steps:**

Move back a little; tap and hold to lock focus; keep the phone still. **How to confirm resolved:** Edges and eyes are sharp on playback. **Prevention:** Lock focus before recording and respect the minimum distance.

K.4 Everything is in the centre

Symptoms: The subject sits dead centre with no balance. **Likely cause:** Grid is off; habit. **How to investigate:** Turn on the grid and look at the 3Ã—3 lines. **Corrective steps:** Move the subject onto a vertical line; place eyes near the top line. **How to confirm resolved:** Framing feels balanced and there is space for text. **Prevention:** Always shoot with the grid on.

K.5 Footage is grainy or "noisy"

Symptoms: The image looks speckled, especially in dark areas. **Likely cause:** Not enough light; the camera raised its sensitivity. **How to investigate:** Check the scene's brightness. **Corrective steps:** Add light (window or ring light); move to a brighter spot. **How to confirm resolved:** The image is cleaner and smoother. **Prevention:** Never shoot in dim light if you can add or move to light.

K.6 Mixed orientation in one project

Symptoms: Some clips are tall, some are wide; editing shows black bars. **Likely cause:** The shooter forgot to keep the phone in one orientation. **How to investigate:** Play back all clips together. **Corrective steps:** Decide vertical or horizontal and re-shoot any wrong-orientation clips that cannot be trimmed. **How to confirm resolved:** All clips match. **Prevention:** Announce the orientation at the top of every shoot and check before each clip.

K.7 The wrong thing is in focus

Symptoms: The background is sharp but the subject is soft, or focus keeps changing. **Likely cause:** Autofocus chose the wrong target; no focus lock. **How to investigate:** Tap the subject and watch the focus shift. **Corrective steps:** Tap and hold on the face to lock focus before recording. **How to confirm resolved:** The subject stays sharp throughout. **Prevention:** Always lock focus on the main subject.

Likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after checking it â€” for example, seeing which direction the light comes from, or watching the playback for shake. Always confirm before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Five-Shot Plan and Test Shoot"

Purpose: Practise planning and shooting with the phone â€” lighting, stability, framing, shot types and a shot list â€” in the learner's own content context.

Realistic scenario: Using the business/brand and hook from Session 1, you will plan and shoot a short sequence that could open your first capstone video.

Detailed instructions:

1. At the top of your shot list, write your chosen **orientation** (vertical is recommended).
2. Complete a **shot list** of **six shots** for a 20â€“30 second vertical clip based on your Session 1 hook. Use at least **three different shot types**.
3. Include at least one **close-up** and at least one **over-the-shoulder** shot.
4. In the Notes column, write the **lighting plan** for each shot (window / ring light / shade) and whether you will use a tripod or brace.
5. **Shoot all six shots** (each 3â€“8 seconds) with:
    - the phone steady,
    - the subject facing the light,
    - the rule of thirds applied,
    - no digital zoom.
6. Add **two seconds of buffer** before and after each shot.
7. Write one sentence per shot explaining **why** you chose that shot type.

Required deliverables:

- Completed Worksheet 2.1 shot list (one page).
- The six recorded clips saved on your phone (or academy computer), in a folder named `[YourName]_Shoot2`.
- The one-sentence explanations.

Submission format: Bring the phone/folder to class and photograph the shot list, or copy the clips and photo into the class folder. Keep everything â€" these clips are edited in Week 2.

Deadline: Before Session 3.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Six-shot list, clear and typed	4	Complete, logical sequence, vertical noted
Variety of shot types	4	Three or more types; includes close-up and over-the-shoulder
Lighting plan	3	Sensible per-shot lighting; no backlighting
Stability and framing	4	Steady, rule-of-thirds used, no zoom
Purpose explained	3	Each shot type has a clear reason
Neatness / completeness	2	All parts present and organised

Common mistakes to avoid: all shots the same type; face in the dark; shaky handheld; inconsistent orientation; forgetting the buffer at the start/end.

Instructor reference solution: For *Adaeze Fashion*, the six-shot list from Section F.8 (extended with a customer close-up). For any learner's own business, the model to check is: at least three shot types, one close-up, one over-the-shoulder, a stated lighting plan, and consistent vertical orientation with steady, well-lit footage.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers in the Instructor Key below.)

Q1. Short answer. Name the four factors that matter more than the camera brand for good phone video.

Q2. Multiple choice. The subject's face is dark but the window behind them is bright. This is called: a) Overexposure b) Backlighting c) Rule of thirds d) Focus lock

Q3. Explain in your own words. What is the rule of thirds, and where should the subject's eyes sit?

Q4. Practical identification. Name each shot type: a) A person shown from the waist up talking to camera b) A close view of a price tag on a dress c) The whole room with a small figure inside d) Looking past a cook's shoulder at the chopping board

Q5. Error / scenario. A learner records a clip in a dark room, handheld, one-handed, and then zooms in with digital zoom. List three problems this will cause and one fix for each.

Q6. Short answer. Why should you record two extra seconds before and after each shot?

Q7. Explain in your own words. When is horizontal (landscape) the better choice, and when is vertical better?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. Stability, light, framing and audio.

A2. (b) Backlighting.

A3. The rule of thirds is a framing guideline that divides the screen into a 3Ã—3 grid; you place the subject on or near one of the vertical lines and their eyes near the top horizontal line, keeping a little headroom and leaving empty space on one side (for text). It makes the shot balanced and professional.

A4. a) Medium shot, b) Close-up, c) Wide (establishing) shot, d) Over-the-shoulder shot.

A5. Problems and fixes (any three): (1) grainy/dark footage â†' add light (window or ring light); (2) shaky footage â†' use a tripod or brace the phone; (3) soft/blurry picture from digital zoom â†' move closer instead of zooming. (Also accept: focus problems

â†' lock focus.)

A6. Because the extra footage gives the editor room to trim cleanly in and out of the shot (a "handle" or buffer), so the final video does not start or end abruptly.

A7. Horizontal suits wide screens: a full YouTube video, a laptop/TV, or an in-store screen. Vertical suits phone-first platforms: TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts and WhatsApp status.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that your phone is a real camera and that good-looking video comes from technique, not price. You practised the four things that matter most â€" **stability**, **light**, **framing** and **audio setup** (with a deeper audio lesson coming next) â€" plus shot types, orientation and a few key phone settings. You built a **shot list** so you shoot with purpose, and you ended with real clips that will be edited in Week 2.

Five important takeaways:

1. Stability, light and framing matter more than the camera brand.
2. Use a tripod/stand or brace the phone; never rely on editing to fix shake.
3. Face the light â€" never shoot with the light behind the subject (backlighting).
4. Use the rule of thirds: subject on a line, eyes near the top, space for text.
5. Plan a shot list and choose vertical for phone-first platforms.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I set up a steady shot without help?
- Can I find the light and keep the subject's face bright?
- Can I frame using the rule of thirds?
- Can I name and shoot at least four shot types?
- Can I write a shot list with a lighting plan?

Connection to the next session. Your picture is now clean and steady â€" but video is half sound. Next session we focus on **clear audio** (why bad audio ruins good video, and how to record clear speech) and on **scripts and storyboards** (the hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA structure and a three-panel storyboard). Your shot list and clips from today feed straight into that.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner sets up a steady shot using a stand or braced stance without being told.
- Learner checks the light direction before shooting and keeps the face bright.
- Learner uses the grid and places the subject on a thirds line.
- Learner chooses and names shot types deliberately, not randomly.
- Learner locks focus/exposure, avoids digital zoom, and adds a buffer.
- Learner can explain *why* each shot was chosen.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I need an expensive camera." â†' Correct: technique beats gear; phone + light + hold matters most.
- "Editing will fix the shake." â†' Correct: stabilisation only helps a little; shoot it steady.
- "More megapixels/4K is always better." â†' Correct: 1080p is the smart default for phone editing.
- "Centre is always best." â†' Correct: the rule of thirds usually looks better for people.
- "Digital zoom is fine." â†' Correct: walk closer instead.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Steady hand drill:** record the same object three ways â€" one-handed, two-handed braced, on a tripod â€" and compare.
2. **Light hunt:** in one room, find three spots and describe the light in each; shoot the same subject in all three.

3. **Framing over the grid:** give printed frames with a grid and ask learners to sketch where the eyes and subject should go.
4. **Shot-type scavenger hunt:** with one subject, capture a wide, medium, close-up and over-the-shoulder, and label each.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a pre-written shot list with types and only the descriptions blank; pair the learner with a strong partner for the shoot.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise and assignment as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** add a deliberate, smooth camera movement (a slow push-in or a reveal) while keeping the shot stable, and shoot a 10-second "before/after" lighting comparison where the learner explains both clips in one spoken take.

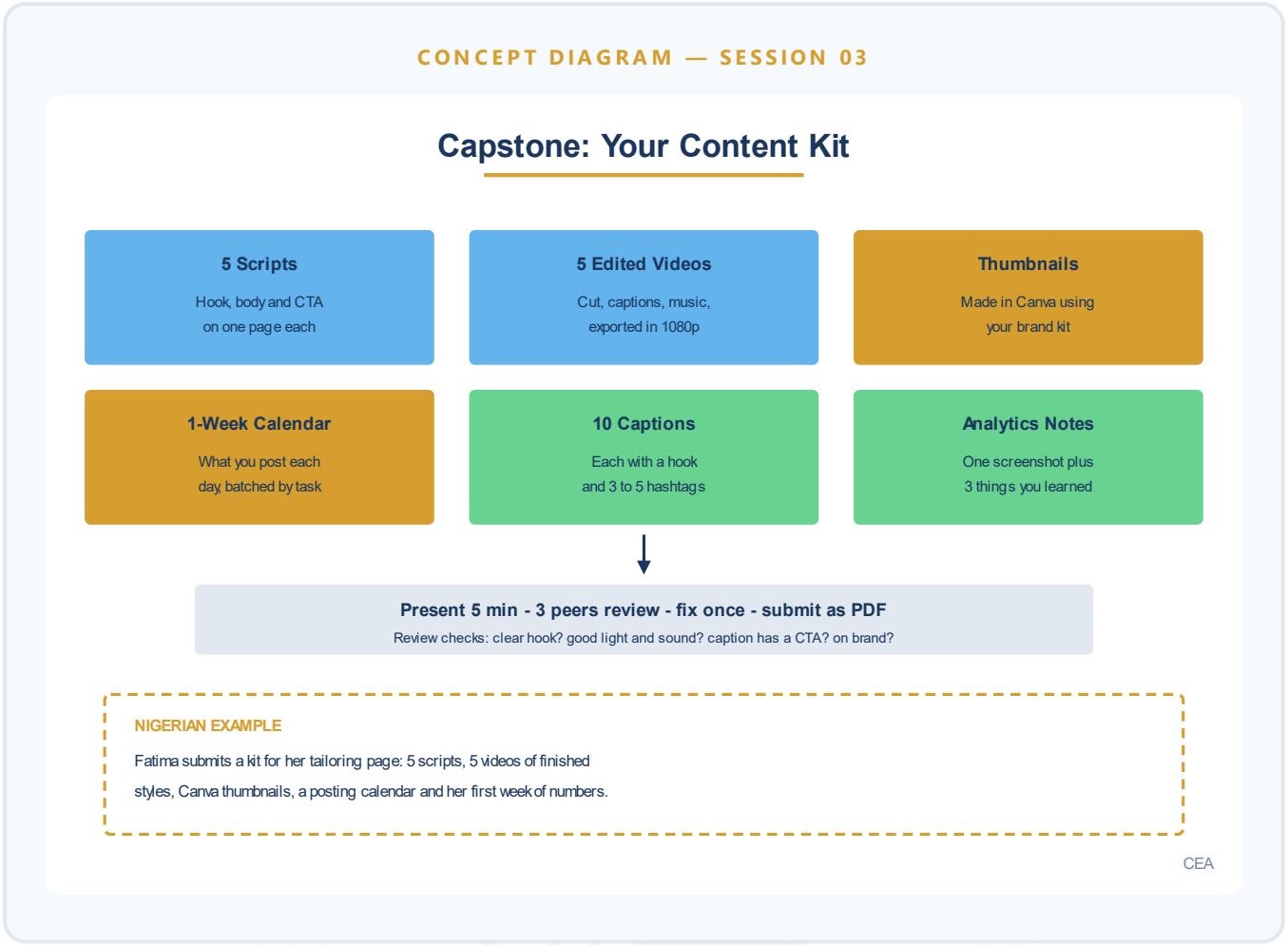
Timing guidance. Lighting is the highest-value skill today, so protect Demonstration 2 (lighting and backlighting) and the guided practical. If time is short, reduce the knowledge check to Q1â€“Q4 and shorten the independent exercise to five shots planned and only two or three shot. Never cut the guided practical â€” it produces the footage the learner needs for Week 2.

END OF SESSION 2

Next: Session 3 â€” Clear Audio and Simple Scripts.

SESSION 03 OF 9

Audio Script



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 3 â€" CLEAR AUDIO AND SIMPLE SCRIPTS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 9
Session title	Clear Audio and Simple Scripts
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: See and Plan (Foundations)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 (niche, audience, hooks) and Session 2 (stable, lit, framed phone footage, shot lists). A learner should have shot a short clip and completed a shot list. If a learner missed

Item	Detail
	Session 2, give the two-minute catch-up: "Face the light, hold steady, use the rule of thirds."
Connection to previous session	In Session 2 learners learned to capture a clean *picture*. Today we fix the other half of video â€" *sound* â€" and then give the content structure by writing a script (hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA), a storyboard and a shot list. The 30-second script and 3-panel storyboard produced today are the plan for the first capstone video.
Preparation before class	Prepare one clip with good picture but bad audio (recorded in a noisy room, phone far away) and one with clear audio (quiet room, close mic); have both ready to play. Ensure earphones with a built-in mic are available (learners' own are fine). Have a lavalier (lapel) mic for demonstration if the academy has one. Print Worksheet 3.1 ("My 30-Second Script") and Worksheet 3.2 ("Three-Panel Storyboard"). Find a quiet corner/room for the audio recording practice.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain why** audio quality often matters more than picture quality for whether a video is watched.
2. **Identify common audio problems** â€" background noise, wind, hum, echo and distance â€" and how they happen.
3. **Record clear speech** using the phone mic, an earphone mic or an external mic, with the mic close to the speaker in a quiet space.
4. **Write a 30-second script** using the **hookâ€"bodyâ€"call-to-action (CTA)** structure.
5. **Draw a three-panel storyboard** matched to a script.
6. **Build a shot list** that supports the script and storyboard.
7. **Read a script aloud naturally** (not robotically) and adjust it to fit a time limit.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (shared is fine).
- Earphones with a built-in microphone (the standard ones that come with phones). Learners should bring their own if possible; the academy keeps a few spares.
- A lavalier (lapel) mic for instructor demonstration if available.
- A quiet room or corner for recording.
- Optional: a soft cloth or foam windscreen for outdoor audio (or simply record indoors).

Software

- The phone's built-in camera/voice recorder app. No editing software needed today.

Accounts

- None required today.

Sample files / examples

- Instructor prepares two clips: one with good picture + bad audio; one with good picture + clear audio. These anchor the whole lesson.
- An example 30-second script and its matching 3-panel storyboard on the projector (use Adaeze Fashion).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 3.1 â€" "My 30-Second Script" (one page with a hook / body / CTA structure and a word-count guide).
- Worksheet 3.2 â€" "Three-Panel Storyboard" (one page with three large boxes for drawing).

Tools

- Whiteboard and markers.
- A timer or phone stopwatch for the 30-second read.

Internet

- Not required. Wi-Fi optional for looking up free, royalty-free music later (introduced properly in Session 5).

Alternatives for learners who lack a facility

- Learners without earphones record with the phone mic held close, or use the phone's voice recorder. All script and storyboard work is paper-based. A learner who prefers not to speak on the recording can write and direct while a partner reads the script.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: Play the two prepared clips behind a black/blank screen or with the phone screen hidden, so learners only *hear* the clips. Clip A has very noisy audio (a busy market or two people talking over each other). Clip B has clear audio (a quiet room, close mic).

What the instructor says:

> *"I am going to play two clips. Do not look at the screen â€" just listen carefully. For each one, I want you to decide: would you keep watching this if it appeared on your feed?"*

(Play Clip A first, then Clip B. Ask for a show of hands for "would keep watching".)

> *"Both clips have the same clear picture. The only difference was the sound. Most of you said you would leave the noisy one â€" and you never even saw the picture. That is the lesson of today: **bad audio makes people leave faster than bad picture**. People will forgive a slightly soft picture, but they will not forgive sound they cannot understand."*

Concrete hook (do this): Ask the class to cover their ears and hum while the instructor speaks a sentence. Then ask what the instructor said. (Almost no one knows.) Say:

> *"You could see my mouth moving perfectly â€" but the sound was breaking it. That is what a noisy video does to a viewer."*

Expected learner response: Learners say the noisy clip was "stressful", "hard to hear", "I would scroll past". Confirm their instinct and reveal that the one they rejected had the same visual quality as the one they liked.

Why this opener works: It proves, with the learners' own reaction, that audio is the hidden make-or-break factor â€" and it primes them to value today's quieter, less glamorous skill.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run a quick oral round. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "Name two of the four factors that matter more than the camera brand."

- Expected answer: stability and light (or framing and audio).
- Common gap: learners forget audio. Perfect â€" today is about audio.

Question 2: "What is the rule of thirds, and why does the empty side of the frame matter?"

- Expected answer: 3Ã—3 grid, subject on a line; the empty side is for text/captions.
- Common gap: confusion between grid lines and headroom. Re-state briefly.

Question 3: "From your Session 2 assignment, what is one hook line you will build a script around today?"

- Expected answer: a learner's own hook.

- Common gap: no hook. Pair the learner with someone who has one, or ask them to write a quick hook now using the C-P-C pattern from Session 1.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Your pictures are clean now. But a clean picture with muddy sound is still a failed video. Today we fix the sound, and we give your hook a structure â€" a script and a storyboard â€" so your video has a clear beginning, middle and end instead of rambling."*

If more than a third cannot answer Question 1 or 2: spend 10 extra minutes on a combined recap of Session 1 (hook) and Session 2 (stability/light/framing) before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why audio matters more than video

The idea. Audio is the sound in your video: the voice, the background noise, the music. When viewers watch a phone video, the sound they hear must be clear and comfortable.

Plain-English definition. "Clear audio" means the voice is loud enough, easy to understand, and not buried under noise, wind, echo or hum.

Why audio matters so much. Viewers are surprisingly forgiving of a slightly soft or slightly dark picture, but they will leave immediately if the sound is painful or hard to follow. They often watch short videos with the sound on *first* â€" and if it hurts, they scroll. Good audio also builds trust: a clear voice sounds professional and confident.

The two enemies of audio:

1. **Distance** â€" the farther the mic is from the speaker, the more the voice fades and the room noise rises.
2. **Noise** â€" anything else in the room: traffic, fans, generators, wind, other people, echo from bare walls.

Analogy. Think of a phone call. If the person is far from their phone in a noisy room, you struggle. If they hold the phone to their mouth in a quiet room, you hear them perfectly. Video audio works the same way.

Common misconception. "The picture is what matters; sound is a bonus." In reality, viewers abandon bad audio far more often than bad picture. Audio is not a bonus; it is half the video.

Limitation. Some audio problems cannot be fully fixed after recording. A noisy room recorded badly cannot be cleaned in a simple editor. That is why we capture it cleanly at the source â€" the same "get it right when you shoot" principle as stability and light.

F.2 Recording clear audio â€" the golden rule

The idea. The golden rule of audio is simple: **get the microphone close to the speaker, in a quiet place.** Almost every other technique follows from this.

Why it works. Sound gets quieter and noisier with distance. Moving the mic from 2 metres to 20 centimetres makes the voice dramatically louder and the room noise much quieter *relative* to the voice. This is called improving the "**signal-to-noise ratio**": the voice (signal) becomes strong compared to the background (noise).

Plain-English definition. Signal-to-noise ratio just means "how much louder is the good sound (the voice) compared to the bad sound (the noise)". We want the good sound much louder.

How to record clear audio (step by step):

1. **Choose a quiet place.** A small room with soft furnishings (curtains, a bed, a rug) absorbs echo. Avoid bare-tiled rooms, busy corridors, generators, fans and main roads.
2. **Turn off noise-makers.** Fans, air conditioners and generators off if possible, or move away from them.
3. **Get the mic close.** Hold the phone (or the earphone mic) about 15â€"30 cm (a hand-span) from the speaker's mouth, slightly to the side so breath does not hit the mic.

4. **Use the right mic:** the phone's built-in mic works if close; an **earphone mic** (the little one on your earphone cable) is usually clearer; a **lavalier (lapel) mic** clips to the collar and is the best simple option when available.
5. **Speak at a normal volume, slightly slower** than usual, and pause between sentences.
6. **Record a few seconds of "room tone"** (silence) at the start â€" it helps when editing to smooth gaps.
7. **Listen back with earphones** before you move on. If you cannot understand every word, re-record.
8. **Avoid wind outdoors.** Wind destroys phone audio. Record indoors, or shelter the mic, or use a foam windscreen.
9. **Avoid handling noise.** Do not rub the phone case or touch the mic cable while recording; this creates rumbles.

Analogy. Recording audio well is like **serving food hot**. You cannot "reheat" a badly recorded conversation in editing into something appetising â€" it is much easier to serve it right the first time.

Worked example. Adaeze records her voiceover in her bedroom in the evening: fan off, door closed, phone's earphone mic held a hand-span from her mouth, speaking slowly. The result is clean voice, no echo. Later she records the same lines in her shop in the afternoon with the fan on and the phone on a table two metres away â€" the result is hollow, humming and hard to follow. The words were identical; the setup decided everything.

Common misconception. "I can remove the noise later." Simple tools like CapCut have a "reduce noise" feature, but it cannot fully rescue badly noisy audio â€" and it often makes the voice sound robotic. Capture it clean.

Limitation. In very loud real-world settings (a busy market, a live event), clean voice audio may be impossible without special gear. In those cases, choose a different approach: record the voice separately in a quiet place, add music, or use on-screen text instead of speech. This is a real professional skill â€" knowing when *not* to rely on live sound.

F.3 The video script â€" hook, body, call-to-action

The idea. A **script** is a written plan of what will be said (and often shown) in your video. A short video script follows a simple three-part structure: **hook â†' body â†' call-to-action (CTA)**.

Why it exists. Without a script, people ramble, forget their point, and run over time. A script keeps the video tight, purposeful and on message â€" and it saves a lot of re-shooting.

The three parts:

1. **Hook (first 3 seconds/one sentence).** Grab attention. Uses the C-P-C pattern from Session 1.
2. **Body (the middle).** Deliver the value: the tip, the product detail, the story, the demonstration. Keep it to one main idea.
3. **Call-to-action (CTA) (last line).** Tell the viewer exactly what to do next: "Order now", "Save this video", "Send us a message", "Follow for more".

Analogy. A script is a **recipe**. A recipe has a start (the idea), a middle (the steps) and a finish (the dish served). A video with no script is cooking without a recipe â€" it might work, but it usually doesn't.

Worked example â€" a 30-second Adaeze Fashion script:

> ***Hook (0â€"3s):*** *"This â‚¦8,000 dress made a bride's sister cry at her wedding."* ***Body (3â€"24s):*** *"Here's why. It's made from a soft cotton blend that doesn't wrinkle, so it still looks fresh after hours of sitting and dancing. It comes in three colours, and the cut flatters both tall and petite frames. I styled it with simple sandals here, but it also works with heels for church."* ***CTA (24â€"30s):*** *"Tap the link in our bio to order yours â€" limited colours this week."*

Notice: one idea (one dress), one clear structure, one action.

Common misconception. "A script means reading stiffly like a newsreader." No â€" a script is a *guide*. Write it in your natural speaking voice, then say it naturally. You can also write **bullet points** instead of full sentences for a looser, more relaxed delivery.

Limitation. For some types of content (a spontaneous vlog, a reaction) a full script would feel fake. In those cases, write a simple **outline** (hook + key points + CTA) and improvise the middle. The structure still holds.

Word-count guide for 30 seconds: In normal, slightly-slow speech, people say roughly **70â€"80 words in 30 seconds**. So keep a 30-second script to about 75 words. Beyond that, it will not fit.

F.4 Storyboards â€" seeing the video before you shoot it

The idea. A **storyboard** is a set of simple drawings (or rough sketches) showing the main shots of your video in order, each with a caption of what happens and what is said. It is the video drawn as a comic strip.

Why it exists. A storyboard lets you "see" the video before you shoot it, so you plan your shots, avoid missing key moments, and save time. It also helps you match the words (script) to the pictures (shots).

How to make a simple three-panel storyboard:

1. Divide the page into three boxes (beginning, middle, end).
2. In each box, draw a rough stick-figure sketch of what the camera will show.
3. Under each box, write:
    - the **shot type** (wide / medium / close-up / over-the-shoulder),
    - the **words** being said at that point (from the script),
    - any **text on screen**.

Analogy. A storyboard is like an **architect's plan before building a house**. The architect draws the rooms before anyone lays blocks. You draw the shots before anyone presses record.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion's three-panel storyboard:

Panel	Sketch	Shot type	Words	On-screen text
1 (Beginning)	Hand pulling dress from rack, close	Close-up	"This â,¦8,000 dress made a bride's sister cryâ€¦"	"The â,¦8,000 dress"
2 (Middle)	Adaeze holding the dress, talking	Medium	"Soft cotton blend, doesn't wrinkle, three coloursâ€¦"	"Cotton â€¢ 3 colours"
3 (End)	Adaeze smiling, holding phone/link	Medium	"Tap the link in our bio to order."	"Order in bio"

Common misconception. "I cannot draw, so I cannot storyboard." Stick figures and boxes are enough. The storyboard is for *you*, not for an art gallery.

Limitation. A storyboard is a plan, not a prison. If a better shot appears while shooting, take it. Update the board when you get home.

F.5 The shot list â€" the practical bridge to shooting

The idea. A **shot list** (introduced in Session 2) is the practical, written list of every shot you need. The storyboard shows the *idea*; the shot list tells you exactly *what to capture and how*.

How they work together.

- The **script** says what will be said.
- The **storyboard** shows roughly what each part looks like.
- The **shot list** spells out each shot (type, description, notes) so the shoot runs smoothly.

Worked example â€" the shot list behind the Adaeze storyboard:

#	Type	Description	Notes
1	Close-up	Hand pulls dress from the rack	By window, tap-lock focus on fabric
2	Medium	Adaeze holds and explains the dress	Tripod, eye level, face the window
3	Medium	Adaeze smiles and points toward the link	End with on-screen text "Order in bio"

Analogy. If the storyboard is the recipe card, the shot list is the shopping list that makes sure you have every ingredient.

Common misconception. "If I have a storyboard I don't need a shot list." The storyboard is visual and general; the shot list is specific and practical. Professionals use both.

Limitation. For very simple one-shot videos, a full shot list may be overkill â€" a storyboard line or two is enough. Match the planning effort to the size of the job.

F.6 Reading naturally and keeping to time

The idea. A script is only good if it is spoken naturally and fits the time. Two skills: sounding human, and being brief.

How to sound natural:

- Write the way you talk (use contractions: "it's", "you're", "don't").
- Read it aloud while writing; if a sentence feels long, shorten it.
- Speak slightly slower than normal; pause at the end of each sentence.
- Smile while you speak â€" it changes the tone of your voice.
- Practise two or three times before recording.

Keeping to time:

- Aim for about **75 words per 30 seconds**.
- Use a stopwatch. Read the script and time it. If it is too long, cut words â€" do not speak faster.
- If it is too short, the video may need a B-roll moment (a cutaway shot); note it for editing.

Analogy. Speaking naturally is like **talking to a friend, not reciting in an assembly hall**. Carry that tone into the recording.

Common misconception. "Faster is better to fit more in." Fast speech is hard to understand and sounds nervous. Cut content instead; keep the delivery calm.

Limitation. Some people simply speak faster or slower naturally. Adjust the word target to your own pace after one timed read.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- Two clips (good picture + bad audio; good picture + clear audio) for the opener.
- A quiet corner of the room.
- Earphones with mic; a lavalier mic if available.
- Adaeze Fashion script and storyboard on the projector.
- A stopwatch.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" record clear audio, then ruin it (8 minutes)

Say: "Watch me record one clean line, then break it on purpose so you can see exactly what causes bad audio."

Step by step:

1. In the **quiet corner**, hold the phone (or earphone mic) a hand-span from the instructor's mouth. Record: "*This â,¦8,000 dress made a bride's sister cry at her wedding.*" Play it back. It is clear.
2. Now **move the phone two metres away** onto a table. Record the same line. Play it back. It sounds distant and hollow.
3. Now **turn a fan on** (or create a hum). Record again. Play it. The voice is buried.
4. Now **hold the phone but rub the case** while recording. Play it. Rumbling handling noise.
5. Now hold the earphone mic close in the quiet corner. Record. Play it. Noticeably clearer than the phone's built-in mic.

Expected result: learners can hear the difference between close/quiet and far/noisy, and between mic options.

Deliberately break it: This *is* the demonstration of breaking it. **Say:** "Every one of these mistakes is easy to avoid â€" check these three things every time: quiet room, mic close, listen back."

Errors to watch and correct:

- Speaker too close to a bare wall (echo) â†' move away or add soft furnishings.
- Breath popping into the mic â†' angle the mic slightly to the side of the mouth.
- Waiting to "fix it later" â†' re-record now, not later.

Questions to ask: "Which clip could you understand without effort?" "What changed â€" the voice or the room?" "Could an editor fully remove that fan noise without harming the voice?" (Not really.)

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" build a script and storyboard live (7 minutes)

Say: "Now I will turn a hook into a full 30-second script and storyboard, live."

Step by step on the projector:

1. Start with the hook: "*This â‚¦8,000 dress made a bride's sister cry at her wedding.*"
2. Write the body in three short sentences (the dress's qualities and how it can be styled).
3. Write the CTA: "*Tap the link in our bio to order yours â€" limited colours this week.*"
4. **Count the words** aloud with the class. If over ~75, cut together.
5. **Time a read** with the stopwatch. If over 30 seconds, trim.
6. Draw the three-panel storyboard beside the script, one panel per part, with shot types.

Expected result: a complete script + storyboard from a single hook, built in front of the class.

Error to show and correct: the instructor initially writes a long, wordy body ("This dress is made from cotton and polyester and it has these buttons and these seams..."). Ask the class to help cut it to one clear idea. **Say:** "One video, one idea. More ideas belong in more videos."

Questions to ask: "Does the hook make you want to hear the body?" "Does the CTA tell a viewer exactly what to do?" "Does the storyboard match the script?"

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes a **30-second script** (hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA) and draws a **3-panel storyboard** for their own chosen business/hook.

Starting materials: Worksheet 3.1 (My 30-Second Script), Worksheet 3.2 (Three-Panel Storyboard), Session 1 hook, Session 2 shot list, a pen.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. **Write the hook** at the top of Worksheet 3.1. Use the C-P-C pattern. Keep it to one spoken sentence.
2. **Write the body** in 3â€"4 short sentences. Deliver **one main idea only** (one product, one tip, one story).
3. **Write the CTA** as one clear line telling the viewer what to do next.
4. **Count the words.** Target about **75 words**. Cut anything unnecessary.
5. **Pause and predict:** before reading, ask learners: "Will this fit 30 seconds? Guess now." Then time it.
6. **Time a read** with a stopwatch (or ask a neighbour to time). Adjust by cutting words, not by speeding up.
7. **Draw the 3-panel storyboard** on Worksheet 3.2: one panel for the hook, one for the body, one for the CTA. In each box, sketch the shot and write the shot type and the words.
8. **Match check:** confirm the storyboard order matches the script order.
9. **Write a short shot list** (3 shots) on the back of the storyboard to match the panels.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Is this 75 words or 120? What should we cut?"
- After step 7: "Which panel needs a close-up, and why?"

Expected result: each learner has a complete 30-second script, a 3-panel storyboard and a 3-shot list for their own content.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Script too long â†' cut to one idea; drop adjectives; aim for 75 words.
- No clear CTA â†' ask "What exactly should the viewer do after watching? Write that."
- Storyboard does not match script â†' line them up side by side and fix.
- Learner can't draw â†' reassure with stick figures; the drawing is for planning, not display.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Hook written as one spoken sentence.
- ☐ Body delivers a single clear idea.
- ☐ CTA tells the viewer a specific action.
- ☐ Script is about 75 words and fits ~30 seconds.
- ☐ Three storyboard panels drawn with shot types.

- [ ] Three-shot list matches the panels.

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: On your own, write a **30-second script and 3-panel storyboard** for a *different* business, then **record the voiceover** with clear audio.

Scenario: *Pastor Ken's Youth Ministry* at a Port Harcourt church wants a 30-second clip inviting young people to a weekend youth fellowship. You will write the script, storyboard it, and record the invited voiceover cleanly.

Requirements:

1. Write a **30-second script** using **hook â†' body â†' CTA**:
    - Hook: something that makes a young person stop scrolling (curiosity or a relatable problem).
    - Body: the key details (what, when, where, why they should come).
    - CTA: a clear action (e.g., "Bring a friend this Saturday").
2. Keep it to about **75 words**.
3. Draw a **3-panel storyboard** with shot types matching the script.
4. **Record the voiceover** in a quiet spot with the mic close (phone mic, earphone mic or lav mic). The recording must be understandable without effort.
5. **Listen back with earphones** and note one thing you would improve.

Constraints:

- One main idea (the fellowship invitation).
- No background noise audible in the recording.
- Mic close to the speaker (hand-span).
- Time: 15 minutes total (write, storyboard, record).

Success criteria:

- Script follows hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA and is about 75 words.
- Storyboard has three panels with shot types.
- The voiceover is clear: every word understandable, no wind/hum/echo dominating.
- The learner can say one improvement they noticed on playback.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: Hook idea â€" "Sunday is not the only day to grow. Here's what happens on Friday nights." (curiosity + clarity).
- Hint 2: Body must answer "what, when, where" in two or three short sentences.
- Hint 3: If the room echoes, record inside a room with curtains/beds, or speak closer to the mic and away from bare walls.

Instructor answer key / model (do not show learners until time is up):

> ***Hook (0â€"3s):*** *"Do you want friends who actually push you to grow?"* ***Body (3â€"24s):*** *"Every Friday at 5pm, our youth fellowship meets in the church hall on Ebony Road. We play games, sing, share real talk about life and faith, and eat together. It is free, and you can bring anyone."* ***CTA (24â€"30s):*** *"Bring one friend this Friday â€" we will be waiting for you."*

Word count: about 70 words (fits 30 seconds). *Storyboard:* Panel 1 â€" medium shot of a young person smiling, hook text on screen; Panel 2 â€" wide shot of the hall with young people, "Fridays 5pm" text; Panel 3 â€" medium shot of the pastor's assistant inviting, CTA text. *Audio:* recorded in a quiet room, earphone mic a hand-span away, fan off.

Marking guidance (out of 10):

- Clear hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA structure (2)
- Hook genuinely attention-grabbing (2)
- Fits ~30 seconds / ~75 words (2)
- 3-panel storyboard with shot types (2)

- Clean, understandable voiceover (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ifeoma* sells handmade soaps on Instagram from her home in Port Harcourt. Her products photograph beautifully, and she films short videos of the soaps in her kitchen. But her videos always do poorly. When a friend watched one closely, the problem became obvious: Ifeoma records while her generator is running outside, her phone sits on the counter two metres from her, and her small tiled kitchen makes her voice echo. Viewers comment "can't hear you" and leave.

Relevant facts.

- The picture is good; the audio is the failure.
- The noise sources are the generator, the distance and the echo.
- Ifeoma speaks quickly and does not listen back before posting.
- She has earphones with a mic but has never used the mic for recording.

Decision point. Should Ifeoma (a) keep posting and hope, (b) give up on videos and post only photos, or (c) change *where* and *how* she records the audio?

Possible approaches.

1. **Keep posting the same way.** The same cause keeps the same result.
2. **Give up on video.** Photos are fine, but video builds much more connection and trust â€” and she can fix this easily.
3. **Fix the audio.** Turn off the generator while recording, move to a room with curtains (less echo), hold the earphone mic a hand-span from her mouth, speak a little slower, and listen back before posting.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Nothing needs to be bought; the tools she already has (her phone, her earphones, a quieter room) are enough.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 repeats the mistake.
- Approach 2 sacrifices the reach and trust that video brings.
- Approach 3 asks Ifeoma to change her routine (quieter room, closer mic, listen-back habit), but it is free and directly fixes the cause.

Professional connection. Professional video makers treat audio as a first-class discipline. On real film sets there is a whole job title â€” the **sound recordist** â€ whose only concern is clean audio, because directors know that audiences forgive a lot except bad sound. Ifeoma is doing, at a small scale, exactly what professionals do.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

K.1 The voice is hard to understand

Symptoms: Viewers cannot hear the words clearly. **Likely cause:** Mic is too far away, or the room is noisy. **How to investigate:** Listen back with earphones; identify whether the voice is quiet or buried under noise. **Corrective steps:** Move the mic closer (hand-span), move to a quieter room, speak slightly louder and slower. **How to confirm resolved:** Every word is understandable on playback. **Prevention:** Always record close and quiet; listen back before finishing.

K.2 Loud background noise (fan, generator, traffic)

Symptoms: A steady hum or rumble under the voice. **Likely cause:** A running appliance or location noise. **How to investigate:** Listen carefully; identify the sound and its source. **Corrective steps:** Turn off fans/generators, close windows, move rooms, or record at a quieter time. **How to confirm resolved:** The voice stands out with no competing sound. **Prevention:** Do a 5-second "silence test" before recording â€ if you hear noise in silence, fix it first.

K.3 Wind noise outdoors

Symptoms: A harsh "whooshing" or rumbling sound. **Likely cause:** Wind hitting the mic. **How to investigate:** Note whether recording is outdoors or near a breeze. **Corrective steps:** Move indoors; shelter the mic behind your body; use a foam windscreen; angle away from wind. **How to confirm resolved:** No whooshing on playback. **Prevention:** Prefer indoor recording; never point the mic at the wind.

K.4 Echo / hollow sound

Symptoms: The voice sounds like it is in a bathroom. **Likely cause:** A bare, hard room (tiles, bare walls) with no soft materials. **How to investigate:** Clap once; a long ring means echo. **Corrective steps:** Record in a room with curtains, a bed or a rug; move closer to the mic; add a soft cloth behind the speaker. **How to confirm resolved:** The voice sounds tight and clear. **Prevention:** Choose soft-furnished rooms for voice recording.

K.5 Handling noise

Symptoms: Rumbles or taps under the voice. **Likely cause:** Rubbing the phone, touching the mic cable, or bumping the stand. **How to investigate:** Listen for the noise lining up with hand movements. **Corrective steps:** Hold still; do not touch the phone or cable during recording; use a stand. **How to confirm resolved:** No rumbles on playback. **Prevention:** Set the phone down or hold it firmly and motionless.

K.6 Script does not fit 30 seconds

Symptoms: The video runs long, or the reading feels rushed. **Likely cause:** More than one main idea; too many words (over ~75). **How to investigate:** Count words and time a read. **Corrective steps:** Cut to one idea; delete adjectives and repeats; do not speed up. **How to confirm resolved:** A comfortable read fits about 30 seconds. **Prevention:** Write to ~75 words from the start.

K.7 Delivery sounds robotic

Symptoms: The presenter sounds like a newsreader reading a page. **Likely cause:** Reading full sentences stiffly; not rehearsing. **How to investigate:** Listen to the playback for flat, fast or stiff delivery. **Corrective steps:** Rewrite in natural speech; use bullet points; rehearse two or three times; smile. **How to confirm resolved:** The delivery sounds like a real person talking. **Prevention:** Write the way you talk; practise before recording.

Likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after checking â€” for example, doing a silence test, clapping for echo, or listening to the playback. Confirm before correcting.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Clear Voice, Clear Script"

Purpose: Practise recording clean audio and writing a structured 30-second script with a matching storyboard â€” the plan for the learner's first capstone video.

Realistic scenario: Using your chosen business/brand and Session 1 hook, you will produce a complete, ready-to-shoot plan: a 30-second script, a 3-panel storyboard, a shot list, and a recorded voiceover of the script.

Detailed instructions:

1. Write your **30-second script** on Worksheet 3.1 using **hook â†' body â†' CTA**, one main idea, about **75 words**.
2. Create a **3-panel storyboard** on Worksheet 3.2 with the shot type and the words for each panel.
3. Write a **shot list** (3â€"5 shots) matching the storyboard.
4. **Record the voiceover** cleanly:
    - quiet room, noise-makers off,
    - mic (phone or earphone) a hand-span from your mouth,
    - normal volume, slightly slow, with pauses,
    - listen back with earphones.
5. **Time the recording.** If it is over ~30 seconds, trim the script and re-record.
6. Write three sentences: what you recorded, where, and one thing you would improve.

Required deliverables:

- Worksheet 3.1 (script) â€" photographed/saved.
- Worksheet 3.2 (storyboard) â€" photographed/saved.
- Shot list.
- The voiceover audio file (saved on phone/computer), named `[YourName]_V03`.
- The three-sentence reflection.

Submission format: Audio file plus photos of the worksheets in the class folder, or brought on your phone to class.

Deadline: Before Session 4.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Script structure (hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA)	4	Clear three-part structure, one main idea
Hook quality	3	Attention-grabbing, uses C-P-C
Length / timing	3	~75 words, fits ~30 seconds
Storyboard	4	Three panels, shot types, words matched to script
Shot list	3	Clear, matches storyboard
Audio quality	3	Clear voice, no wind/hum/echo dominating; mic close

Common mistakes to avoid: more than one idea; script too long; mic too far; recording with noise-makers on; stiff delivery; storyboard not matching the script.

Instructor reference solution: Use the Adaeze Fashion script, storyboard and shot list from Sections F.3â€"F.5, plus the clean-audio technique from F.2. For any learner, verify: three-part structure, ~75 words, a 3-panel storyboard with shot types, and a voiceover whose every word is understandable.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers in the Instructor Key below.)

Q1. Short answer. Why do viewers often leave a video with clear picture but bad audio?

Q2. Multiple choice. The best way to record clear voice audio is: a) Put the phone on a table two metres away b) Record in a busy market for realism c) Keep the mic close (about a hand-span) in a quiet room d) Shout from across the room

Q3. Explain in your own words. What does "signal-to-noise ratio" mean, in simple terms?

Q4. Practical identification. Name the three parts of a short-video script and say what each does.

Q5. Error / scenario. A learner records a voiceover in a tiled room with a ceiling fan on, phone on the table. List two problems this causes and one fix for each.

Q6. Short answer. Roughly how many words fit in a 30-second script, and why does this matter?

Q7. Explain in your own words. What is a storyboard, and how is it different from a shot list?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. Because audio that is hard to understand, painful or noisy makes people uncomfortable and they scroll away fast â€" and they may judge the content as unprofessional. Clear audio is essential for understanding the message.

A2. (c) Keep the mic close (about a hand-span) in a quiet room.

A3. "Signal-to-noise ratio" means how much louder the good sound (the voice) is compared to the unwanted sound (background noise). We want the voice much louder than the noise, which is why we get close and stay quiet.

A4. (1) **Hook** â€" grabs attention in the first seconds. (2) **Body** â€" delivers the main value or message (one idea). (3) **Call-to-action (CTA)** â€" tells the viewer what to do next.

A5. Problems and fixes: (1) echo from the tiled room â†' record in a room with curtains/soft furnishings, or get closer; (2) hum from the ceiling fan â†' turn the fan off while recording (and place the phone closer, not on a table far away â€" that is a third valid problem). (Accept any two with sensible fixes.)

A6. About **70â€"80 words (roughly 75)** fit in 30 seconds. It matters because going over the limit makes the video too long or the delivery rushed, which loses viewers; you should cut words, not speed up.

A7. A storyboard is a set of simple drawings showing the main shots in order (the video as a comic strip) with the words and shot types. A shot list is a written list of each shot to capture (type, description, notes) without drawings. The storyboard shows the idea visually; the shot list is the practical capture plan. They work together.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that sound can make or break a video: viewers forgive a soft picture but not audio they cannot understand. You practised the golden rule of audio â€" **mic close, room quiet** â€" and learned about the enemies of good sound (distance, noise, wind, echo, handling noise). You then gave your hook a structure by writing a **30-second script** (hook â†' body â†' CTA), drawing a **3-panel storyboard**, and building a **shot list**. This is the complete plan for your first capstone video.

Five important takeaways:

1. Bad audio makes viewers leave faster than bad picture.
2. Golden rule: get the mic close (about a hand-span) in a quiet room.
3. Watch out for noise, wind, echo and handling noise â€" and record a clean take.
4. A short video script is hook â†' body â†' CTA, with one main idea and ~75 words.
5. A storyboard shows the shots; a shot list makes them happen.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I record a voiceover that a stranger can understand on the first listen?
- Can I write a 30-second script with a strong hook and a clear CTA?
- Can I draw a 3-panel storyboard that matches my script?
- Can I keep my script to about 75 words?
- Can I spot the five audio problems and fix them before posting?

Connection to the next session. You now have a plan and clean audio. Next week we move from *making* to *editing*: you will open **CapCut** and learn to trim, split, cut and reorder your clips, and add captions and text â€" turning today's script, storyboard and footage into your first finished vertical video.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner records a voiceover that is understandable on the first listen, with the mic close and noise controlled.
- Learner does a silence test and listens back before finishing.
- Learner writes a script with a clear hook, single-idea body and specific CTA.
- Learner keeps the script to about 75 words and times the read.
- Learner's storyboard matches the script order and includes shot types.
- Learner can explain why a noisy recording cannot simply be "fixed later".

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Sound is a bonus; picture matters most." â†' Correct: viewers leave bad audio fast.
- "I'll clean the noise later in editing." â†' Correct: it cannot be fully removed; record clean.
- "A script makes me sound stiff." â†' Correct: write like you talk; use bullet points; rehearse.
- "I can't draw, so I can't storyboard." â†' Correct: stick figures are enough.
- "Faster speech fits more content." â†' Correct: cut words instead; fast speech loses viewers.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Close vs far drill:** record the same line at 1 metre and at a hand-span; compare with earphones.
2. **Silence test habit:** have learners sit quietly and record 5 seconds; identify every noise they hear and how to remove it.
3. **Script slimming:** give a 120-word script and ask learners to cut it to 75 words without losing the main idea or the CTA.
4. **Storyboard match:** give a script and three blank panels; have learners fill the panels so they match exactly.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially written script with the hook done and blanks for the body and CTA; pair the learner for the recording.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise and assignment as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** write two alternative hooks for the same video and record both; choose the stronger one and explain why. Optionally, write a "bullet-point outline" version and perform it unscripted, then compare the natural delivery to the scripted take.

Timing guidance. Audio is today's highest-value skill, so protect Demonstration 1 (clear audio vs broken audio) and the recording part of the practical. If time is short, shorten the knowledge check and reduce the independent exercise to writing the script and storyboard only (record the voiceover as part of the assignment). Never cut the guided practical â€" it produces the script and storyboard that drive Week 2's editing.

END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€" Editing I: Cuts, Trim and Captions in CapCut.

SESSION 04 OF 9

Edit Basics

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 04



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 4 â€" EDITING BASICS IN CAPCUT

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 9
Session title	Editing Basics in CapCut â€" Cuts, Trim, Split, Reorder and Captions
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Production (Editing)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first time inside a video editor)
Prerequisite knowledge	The learner must have (a) phone footage shot in Session 2, (b) a 30-second script written in Session 3, and (c) a working phone or academy machine with CapCut installed. If a learner has

Item	Detail
	no footage, give them the academy "sample clip pack" (Section C) so they can still follow the full session.
Connection to previous work	In Session 3 you wrote a 30-second script with a **Hook (3s) + Value (20s) + CTA (7s)**. That script is your shopping list. Today we open CapCut and turn the raw clips you shot into a real, tight, captioned video that follows that script.
Preparation before class	CapCut installed and signed in on every learner device; sample clip pack copied to machines without learner footage; charger cables; academy Wi-Fi on; projector showing the instructor's phone (screen mirror) or instructor machine running CapCut; the Session 3 script of the running example (Adaeze Fashion) printed for the demo.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain in their own words** what video editing is and why raw footage must be edited before publishing.
2. **Create a new CapCut project** set to a vertical **9:16** aspect ratio and **import** footage from the phone or machine.
3. **Identify and describe the four zones** of the CapCut screen â€" the preview, the timeline, the playhead, and the toolbar â€" and describe what each does.
4. **Perform the five core edit actions** â€" trim, split, delete, reorder and undo â€" on a real clip without help.
5. **Match their clips to their Session 3 script** so that the video follows the planned Hook â†' Value â†' CTA order.
6. **Apply basic pacing** by removing dead air, stumbles and long pauses so the video flows.
7. **Generate auto-captions in CapCut** and **correct at least three caption errors** (spelling, names, Nigerian words).
8. **Export a finished video correctly for vertical platforms** â€" 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4 â€" and confirm the file plays.
9. **Produce a complete 30â€"60 second first-cut video with captions** that can be published to Instagram Reels, TikTok or YouTube Shorts.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (the phone they shot with in Session 2), fully charged, with at least 8 GB free storage.
- One computer per learner or per pair (academy machines). CapCut has a desktop app, but the phone version is what we use by default because most learners publish from a phone.
- Instructor device connected to the projector, ideally with **screen mirroring** so the class sees every tap on the phone in real time.
- A short USB cable or a WhatsApp-to-self / cloud transfer method to move footage between phone and machine if needed.

Software

- **CapCut** (free). Install from Google Play (Android) or the App Store (iOS), or the CapCut desktop app for Windows/Mac. Create or sign in to a free account so projects are saved.
- A phone gallery / Files app to locate footage.
- Optional: Google Drive or a memory card reader to move big files.

Sample files

- The instructor prepares a **"sample clip pack"**: 6â€"8 short clips (wide, mid, close, plus 2 B-roll inserts) of a fictional business, so learners with no footage can still complete the whole session. Store it on each academy machine and on a shareable link.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€" "CapCut Screen Map" (printed, 1 page; learners label the four zones and the icons).
- Worksheet 4.2 â€" "Caption Correction Sheet" (learners write corrected caption lines).

Accounts

- Free CapCut account. No paid subscription is needed for any task in this course.

Internet

- Internet is needed only to sign in, download CapCut and (optionally) use the online template store. The core editing actions in this session work **offline** once the app is installed and the footage is on the phone.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any Android or iOS phone with CapCut works. If a learner has no phone, pair them with a classmate who does, or let them use the CapCut **desktop app** on an academy machine. The five core actions (trim, split, delete, reorder, undo) work the same way on desktop; the buttons are simply clicked with a mouse instead of tapped.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, have two versions of the *same* footage ready.

- Version A: a raw, unedited **2-minute** clip of a person talking to camera â€” with the "umms", a long silence at the start, a stumble, and a repeated sentence.
- Version B: the **40-second** edited version of that same clip, captions on, tight.

Do not explain the difference yet. Play both, back to back.

What the instructor says:

> *"This is the same person, the same camera, the same lighting. The only difference is what I did after the recording. Watch version one â€¦ now watch version two. Which one would you keep watching on TikTok? Which one looks like a business and which one looks like a mistake?*
>
> *The person did not become a better speaker between the two videos. I simply removed the boring parts, cut the mistakes, and added captions. That job has a name: **editing**. It is the single skill that separates a video people scroll past from a video people watch to the end. Today, you learn to do it."*

Expected learner response: Learners will almost always pick version two and say things like "the second one is shorter", "the first one is too long", "I can read the second one". Accept all answers and write their words on the board. Then reveal that the raw clip was not deleted â€” it was **cut**.

Then reveal the hook: Tap play on version B and tap the screen to freeze on a caption. Say:

> *"Everything you see here â€” the cutting, the captions, the tightness â€” was done in a free app on a phone, in about fifteen minutes. By the end of today, you will each do the same to your own footage from Session 2."*

Why this opener works: It creates an immediate, visible gap between "raw" and "edited", it sets the standard (short, tight, captioned), and it removes the fear that editing needs expensive software or a laptop.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this quickly as an oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In your Session 3 script, what are the three parts, and how many seconds each?"

- Expected answer: **Hook (first 3 seconds), Value (about 20 seconds), CTA (last 7 seconds)** â€” about 75 words in total for 30 seconds.
- Common gap: learners remember "hook" but forget the CTA. Remind them the CTA is where you tell the viewer what to do (order now, DM us, visit the shop).

Question 2: "Why do we shoot vertical for Reels, TikTok and Shorts, and not horizontal?"

- Expected answer: Because people watch those platforms on a phone held upright; a vertical video fills the screen. Horizontal is for YouTube long videos and for some church/event footage.

- Common gap: some learners think horizontal is "more professional". Clarify that for short vertical platforms, 9:16 fills the screen and gets more watch time.

Question 3: "In Session 3 we said record audio close to the mouth â€" how close?"

- Expected answer: About **15â€"30 cm** from the mouth, face the mic, quiet room, no fan/noise.
- Common gap: learners confuse "close" with "shouting". Restate: close = near the mic, not loud.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"So you have footage. You have a script. Right now your footage is like a bag of unwashed rice with stones in it â€" good food, but not ready to eat. Editing is the washing and picking. We remove the stones (the stumbles, the silence, the mistakes) and keep only the clean rice (the good parts). CapCut is the bowl and the sieve. Let us begin."*

If more than a third of the class cannot state the three script parts, spend 5 extra minutes re-reading one learner's script aloud and marking it Hook / Value / CTA together before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What video editing actually is

The idea. Video editing is the job of taking the raw recording the camera captured and **arranging, removing and adding** pieces until the video says exactly what you want, in the shortest, clearest way.

Plain-English definition. Editing is choosing *which* seconds the viewer sees and *in what order*. You keep the good, delete the bad, and put the pieces in the right order.

Why it exists. A camera records everything â€" the wait before you speak, the "sorry, I will start again", the passing okada, the two minutes when your hand was in front of the lens. Nobody wants to watch that. Editing exists because **raw footage is almost never watchable, and edited footage can be**.

What it does. Editing:

- **Removes** dead air, mistakes and repeats.
- **Reorders** clips so the story makes sense.
- **Shortens** a long recording into a tight one.
- **Adds** captions, music, text and effects.
- **Sets the pace** â€" how fast the video moves.

Real-life comparison. Think of **cooking**. The market (your shoot day) gives you raw ingredients. Before anyone eats, you wash, cut, remove spoilt parts, and arrange the food on the plate. Your mother's stew is not just thrown in a pot â€" it is *prepared*. Editing is preparing the video for the viewer's plate.

Important limitation / misconception. Editing cannot fix a video that has no clear idea, no light, and no sound. If the footage is dark, shaky and the audio is noise, no amount of editing saves it. **Good shooting makes good editing easy.** This is why we spent Week 1 learning to shoot and write first.

How a learner recognises it. Any video you watch on a phone that feels "smooth", "fast" or "easy to follow" has been edited. When a person on screen finishes a sentence and the next sentence starts immediately, with no pause â€" that pause was cut out.

F.2 The CapCut screen â€" four zones

The idea. CapCut is a **free video editor** made by ByteDance (the company behind TikTok). It runs on phones and on computers. Before you can edit, you must know the four parts of the screen. *The wording of buttons may differ slightly by version, but the four zones are always present.*

Zone	What it is	What it does
1. Preview window	The big rectangle at the top	Shows the video at the current position. Tap the play button to watch.

Zone	What it is	What it does
2. Timeline	The horizontal strip at the bottom	Shows your clips in order, left to right. This is your "workbench".
3. Playhead	The thin vertical white line on the timeline	Marks the exact moment you are at. When you play, the playhead moves. When you cut, you cut *at the playhead*.
4. Toolbar	The row of icons below the timeline	Contains the tools: Split (scissors), Speed, Volume, Text, Audio, Transitions, Delete, and more.

Real-life comparison. The **timeline is like a film strip lying flat on a table**. Each picture frame is a moment. The **playhead is your finger** pointing at one frame and saying "cut here". The **preview is the small TV** showing what the frame looks like.

Key vocabulary you will hear today:

- **Clip** â€" one piece of video on the timeline.
- **Track** â€" a horizontal line on the timeline that holds clips. The main video track is at the bottom; extra tracks (for overlays, music, text) sit above it.
- **Trim** â€" cut a little off the start or the end of a clip.
- **Split** â€" cut a clip into two pieces at the playhead.
- **Playhead** â€" the position marker.
- **Dead air** â€" silence or empty space where nothing useful happens.

Common misconception. Learners think CapCut "deletes" footage permanently. It does not. When you cut, you are only **removing that piece from this project**; the original file stays safe in your phone gallery. This is why you must **never edit the only copy of anything** â€" but with CapCut you are always working on a copy, so you are safe.

F.3 Getting started â€" creating a project and importing media

Step one: New project. Open CapCut. On the home screen tap **New project** (in some versions it says "Create new"). A blank project opens.

Step two: Choose the aspect ratio. This is critical. The **aspect ratio** is the shape of the final video. For Instagram Reels, TikTok and YouTube Shorts we use **9:16** (vertical). In CapCut, you usually pick the ratio when importing, or you can change it later in the **Ratio** / **Aspect ratio** menu (wording may differ by version). Choose **9:16**.

> ***Why 9:16 matters:*** *9:16 means 9 units wide and 16 units tall â€" a tall rectangle, exactly the shape of a phone screen held upright. If you edit in the wrong ratio, your video will have black bars on the sides and look amateurish.*

Step three: Import. Tap **Add media** / **Import** and select the clips you shot. On a phone you will usually see your gallery; pick the clips. Do not pick all 20 clips. For a 30-second video, select **only the clips that match your script** â€" usually 6â€"12 short clips.

Step four: Add to timeline. After selecting, tap **Add**. The clips drop onto the timeline in the order you selected them.

Worked example â€" importing for the Adaeze Fashion video:

- Script: a 30-second "3 reasons to love our new Ankara dress" video.
- Clips shot in Session 2: (1) Adaeze walking into the shop â€" wide; (2) close-up of the fabric; (3) Adaeze holding the dress; (4) the dress on the mannequin; (5) Adaeze smiling to camera; (6) a B-roll shot of hands folding the dress.
- Import all six, then we will trim each one down on the timeline.

Common misconception. Learners import everything and end up with a 5-minute mess. The rule is: **import fewer clips than you think**. It is easier to add than to cut.

F.4 The timeline, the playhead and how video flows

The idea. The timeline reads **left to right, like a sentence in a book**. The first clip is on the far left; the last clip is on the far right. The video plays from left to right.

The playhead. The white line shows where you are. Tap anywhere on the timeline to move the playhead there. Scrub (drag) the timeline left and right to move through the video quickly.

Zoom. You can pinch or use the zoom control to make the timeline bigger so you can see frames more clearly, or smaller to see the whole video at once. *Wording may differ by version.*

How a cut is made. A cut is simply the boundary between two clips. When clip 1 ends and clip 2 begins, that boundary is a cut. Editing is mostly the art of deciding **where those boundaries fall**.

Real-life comparison. The timeline is like a **trail of garri in a row of bowls**. Each bowl is a clip. You can take garri out of a bowl, move bowls around, or pour two bowls into one. The timeline is your row of bowls.

Important concept â€" the "talking head" trap. If your video is just you talking for 60 seconds with no cuts, the viewer gets bored. Even in a talking video, we cut out the pauses so the energy stays high. Watch any popular Nigerian creator: they cut every few seconds.

F.5 The five core actions â€" the heart of this session

These five actions do 90% of all editing. Learn them by heart.

Action 1 â€" TRIM (cut the start or end of a clip)

What it is. Removing a little from the beginning or the end of a single clip.

Why you do it. Every clip begins with you reaching for the phone or saying "are we recording?" and ends with you reaching to stop. Trim removes that.

How (phone): Tap the clip to select it (a white border with handles appears). Drag the **left handle** to the right to cut off the beginning, or the **right handle** to the left to cut off the end.

Diagram of the idea:

```
Before trim:  [ "are we... umm... so today we show you..." ]
After trim:             [ "so today we show you..." ]
                         ^ you dragged the left handle to here
```

Worked example. A clip starts with Adaeze laughing for 3 seconds before she speaks. Trim the left handle forward 3 seconds so the clip starts exactly when she says "Three reasons to love this dress."

Action 2 â€" SPLIT (cut one clip into two at the playhead)

What it is. Cutting a single clip into two separate pieces at the exact point of the playhead.

Why you do it. To remove a mistake *in the middle* of a clip, or to separate the good part from the bad part.

How (phone): Move the playhead to where you want to cut. Tap the clip to select it. Tap the **Split** icon (the scissors). The clip becomes two clips.

How (desktop): Place the playhead and use the **Split** button, or press the keyboard shortcut if available (often shown next to the button; *wording/shortcut may differ by version*).

Worked example. Adaeze says: "This dress is perfect for church." Then she stumbles: "For... for... for burial too." You split at the end of "church" and split again at the start of "too". Now the stumble is a separate middle piece.

Action 3 â€" DELETE (remove the piece you split off)

What it is. Removing a clip or a piece from the timeline.

Why you do it. After you split out the mistake, you delete that piece so it is gone from the video.

How (phone): Select the piece â†' tap **Delete** (usually a trash-can icon) or swipe the clip off the timeline (gesture may differ by version).

Worked example (continued). Select the middle "For... for... for burial" piece and delete it. Now the sentence reads: "This dress is perfect for church." Clean.

> ***Note about closing the gap:*** *After deleting a middle piece, the clips usually close up automatically (CapCut "ripples" them together). If a gap appears, trim the clips to meet, or use a "close gap" option if your version has one (wording may*

differ).

Action 4 â€" REORDER (move clips into the right order)

What it is. Changing the sequence of clips.

Why you do it. To make the story follow your script. Your best hook clip might have been shot last.

How (phone): Press and hold a clip, then **drag** it left or right to a new position. A gap opens and the clip drops in.

Worked example. You shot the dress close-up before the shop-front wide shot, but your script wants the wide shot first. Long-press the wide shot and drag it to the far left.

Action 5 â€" UNDO (put it back the way it was)

What it is. Reversing your last action.

Why you do it. Everyone makes mistakes. Undo is your safety net and the most-used button in editing.

How (phone): Tap the curved **undo arrow** at the top of the screen. There is usually a **redo** arrow beside it.

Real-life comparison. Undo is like **writing with a pencil that has an eraser**. You can try things freely because you can always rub it out.

Rule to teach the class: *Cut boldly, and when unsure, undo.* You cannot break the original file, so experiment.

F.6 Matching clips to your script

The idea. Your Session 3 script is a **shopping list**, and editing is matching. For each line of the script, you place the right clip in the right order.

The method (write this on the board):

1. Read the script Hook line. Find the clip that best *shows* that line. Put it first.
2. Read the Value section. Put the clips that explain the value next, in a sensible order.
3. Read the CTA line. Put the clip where you (or the product) invite action last.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion "3 reasons" script mapped to clips:

Script part	Script words (sample)	Clip chosen	Length after trim
Hook	"Stop! Before you buy that dress, look at this."	Adaeze holding the dress, close	3s
Value 1	"Reason one: the fabric does not fade."	Close-up of fabric	6s
Value 2	"Reason two: it fits all sizes."	Dress on mannequin	6s
Value 3	"Reason three: it is perfect for church."	Adaeze smiling to camera	6s
CTA	"DM 'FASHION' to order yours today."	Shop-front wide shot	7s

Why this matters. When clips match the script, the video *makes sense even with the sound off* â€" which is how many people watch. This is the difference between a "random collection of clips" and a "video".

Common misconception. Learners think they must use every clip they shot. You do not. **Unused clips are not wasted** â€" they are saved for future videos. A good edit uses only what the script needs.

F.7 Basic pacing â€" keeping the video alive

The idea. Pacing is the speed at which the video moves from one moment to the next. Fast pacing feels energetic; slow pacing feels calm or boring.

Why it matters. On short vertical platforms, viewers decide in the first **1â€"3 seconds** whether to keep watching. If the first seconds are slow, they scroll away. Good pacing keeps them.

Rules of thumb for beginners:

1. **The hook must be fast.** Start within 1â€"2 seconds. No logos, no long "Hello everyone, welcome back to my channel." Put the best thing first.

2. **Remove all dead air.** Any pause longer than about a second where nothing happens should usually be cut.
3. **A cut every 3â€“7 seconds** keeps a talking video alive. When you have no B-roll yet (that is next session), tighten the talking clips instead.
4. **End before they are tired.** A 45-second video that holds attention beats a 90-second video that loses it.

Worked example â€” tightening a clip. Adaeze's sentence: "So, umm, this is the ... this is the Ankara dress that, err, we just received." After trimming/splitting out the "umm", "this is the" repeat and the "err", it becomes: "This is the Ankara dress we just received." Same meaning, half the time, twice the energy.

Limitation. Do not over-cut until the video feels like a jerky robot. A little breathing room is human. Pacing is a skill you build with practice â€" watch your own edit twice and remove only what genuinely drags.

F.8 Auto-captions in CapCut

The idea. Captions (also called **subtitles**) are the words of the video written on the screen. CapCut can generate them **automatically** from your audio â€" this is called **auto-captions**.

Why captions matter:

- Many people watch videos with the **sound off** (in a bus, in a class, at work). Without captions, they do not understand your video.
- Captions keep attention and improve accessibility for deaf and hard-of-hearing viewers.
- Captions reinforce your message: viewers read and hear at the same time.

How to add auto-captions (phone):

1. Tap **Text** on the toolbar (in some versions it may be under **Captions**).
2. Choose **Auto captions** / **Auto generate**.
3. Choose the **language** (for Nigerian English content, English; for pidgin, still often English because CapCut may not support pidgin â€" *options differ by version*).
4. Tap **Generate** and wait. CapCut listens to your audio and writes the words on the timeline as caption clips.
5. **Review every line.** Auto-captions make mistakes, especially with names, places and local words.

Correcting captions â€" the golden rule: *Never trust auto-captions without reading them.* Tap a caption line to edit its text. Fix:

- **Names:** "Adaeze" might become "A day zay".
- **Nigerian words and places:** "Port Harcourt" might become "Port Harkot"; "Ankara" might become "Anka ra"; "naira" might become "Nara".
- **Spelling and grammar.**
- **Timing:** if a caption appears before the speaker says it, adjust the caption clip's position.

Formatting captions for readability:

- **3â€"5 words per line.** A wall of 10 words is hard to read.
- **Large enough font** to read on a small phone screen.
- **High contrast:** white text with a dark outline/stroke, or text on a dark background box, so it is readable over any video.
- Keep captions **clear of the bottom edge** (where platform buttons sit) and clear of the top (where the username sits).

Common misconception. Learners think auto-captions are perfect. They are a **first draft**. Your job is to correct them. A misspelled name is a spelling of your own business name wrong in public.

Worked example â€" a caption correction:

Auto-caption said	Corrected to
"come and buy our new anka ra dress"	"Come and buy our new Ankara dress"
"visit us at port harkot"	"Visit us in Port Harcourt"
"message adaeze fashion"	"Message Adaeze Fashion"

Where captions live on the timeline. Each caption is a small clip on a **text track above your video**. You can move them, split them, or delete them just like video clips.

F.9 Exporting correctly for vertical platforms

The idea. Exporting is saving your finished edit as a single video file you can upload. If you export with the wrong settings, the video can look blurry, play choppy, or be refused by the platform.

The correct settings for vertical platforms (Reels, TikTok, Shorts):

Setting	Value	Why
Resolution	**1080 Ã— 1920** (also written **1080p**)	The standard full-quality vertical size. Clear, not blurry.
Aspect ratio	**9:16**	Fills the phone screen.
Frame rate	**30fps**	Smooth standard speed; matches most phone footage.
Format	**MP4**	The format every platform accepts.
Bit rate	**Recommended / High** (the default "Recommended" is fine)	Higher bit rate = clearer video, bigger file.

How to export (phone): Tap the **Export** button (top right, often a small download/arrow icon). Choose the resolution and frame rate. Tap **Export** again, and wait. The file saves to your gallery (CapCut may also save a copy inside its own app folder â€" *wording differs by version*).

About watermarks / end cards. Depending on the version, CapCut may add a short end card or a small watermark. Check the export screen for an option to turn this off, and check the exported video's last second. If your version does not offer the toggle, keep the video tight and simply note it; **do not let a watermark stop you from publishing a good video.** (Free-tier behaviour changes between versions.)

How to confirm the export is correct:

1. Play the exported file from your gallery.
2. Check the picture is sharp, not blocky.
3. Check the captions are readable and correctly timed.
4. Check the sound is present and not crackling.
5. Check the last frame â€" no unwanted end card.

Common misconception. Learners export at the lowest resolution to "save space" and the video looks soft on other people's phones. For a 30â€"60 second video, **1080p is fine and worth the file size**.

F.10 Copyright safety â€" say it plainly

The idea. Using someone else's song, video or photo without permission can get your account a **copyright strike**, take your video down, or (for a business) bring trouble. It is illegal and it is also unnecessary.

Rules for this course:

- **Never re-upload** someone else's video as your own. Editing a stolen clip does not make it yours.
- **For music**, use the **CapCut built-in music library** (marked as free to use for CapCut), or royalty-free sources (see Section C and next session). Do not record a popular song playing from another phone and lay it over your video.
- **For footage**, use only what you shot, or what you have clear permission to use.

Professional connection. A business that uses a copyrighted song in an advert can be asked to remove it or pay. Using free libraries protects the business and builds trust.

F.11 Summary of the session

- **Editing** is choosing which seconds the viewer sees and in what order.
- The CapCut screen has **four zones**: preview, timeline, playhead, toolbar.
- **Five core actions**: trim, split, delete, reorder, undo.
- **Match clips to your script** (Hook â†' Value â†' CTA).

- **Pacing** keeps the video alive: fast hook, remove dead air, cut every few seconds.
- **Auto-captions** must be corrected for names and Nigerian words; keep 3â€“5 words per line.
- **Export** at 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4.
- **Do not use copyrighted music or footage.**

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- CapCut open on the projector device, signed in.
- The **sample clip pack** already transferred to the device (6â€“8 clips).
- The **Adaeze Fashion 30-second script** written on the board.
- A deliberately "messy" starting state: the clips imported in the *wrong* order, with an obvious stumble clip included.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” create, import, and the screen tour (4 minutes)

Say: "Watch my hand. I will do nothing clever â€” just open a project and bring clips in."

Do this on the projector, narrating every tap:

1. On CapCut home, tap **New project**.
2. When the media picker opens, tap the **ratio** option and choose **9:16**.
3. Select **6 clips** only, tap **Add**.
4. Point at the four zones and name them out loud: "Preview. Timeline. The white line is the playhead. This row is the toolbar."
5. Tap the play button and let it play 5 seconds. Note the clips play left to right in the imported order.

Ask the class: "Which clip do I want first, according to our script?" â†’ The hook clip. "Is it first now?" â†’ Usually no. This sets up reorder.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” the five core actions, live (7 minutes)

Action: REORDER. Long-press the hook clip (Adaeze holding the dress) and drag it to the far left. Play the first 3 seconds. Say: "Now the video opens with the hook, like the script says."

Action: TRIM. Select clip 1. Drag the left handle forward until the clip starts exactly on the first word. Play again. Say: "We removed the reach-for-the-phone moment. Instantly more professional."

Action: SPLIT + DELETE. Go to the clip where Adaeze stumbles ("Forâ€¦ forâ€¦ for burial too"). Move the playhead to just after "church". Tap the clip, tap **Split**. Move the playhead to just before "too". Tap **Split** again. Select the middle piece. Tap **Delete**. Play. The sentence is now clean.

Deliberately show a mistake and fix it: Split in the wrong place, then tap **Undo**. Say: "See? Nothing broke. Cut boldly, undo freely."

Action: TRIM the ends of every clip. Show trimming the end of the last clip so the CTA is tight.

Expected results to point at out loud:

- The video now starts with the hook.
- The stumble is gone.
- Total length has dropped from about 90 seconds to about 40 seconds.

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€” auto-captions and correction (4 minutes)

1. Tap **Text** → **Auto captions** → language **English** → **Generate**.
2. Wait for the captions to appear. Point at the text track above the video.
3. **Deliberately show a wrong caption.** The demo clip should contain a name so the auto-caption will mis-hear it (e.g., "Adaeze" → "A day zay").
4. Tap the wrong caption, edit the text to "Adaeze", tap the tick/check to confirm.
5. Show adjusting a caption's timing by dragging its edge if it appears early.

Say: "Auto-captions are a first draft. Every single one of you will find at least three mistakes in yours. Finding them is the skill."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" export (optional if time allows, else describe)

Tap **Export**, show the settings screen, point at **1080p** and **30fps** and **MP4**, and explain you would tap export to finish. If time is short, say you will export together during the guided exercise.

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "What does the playhead mark?" (The exact moment where you edit.)
- "If I delete a clip, is my original footage gone?" (No â€" CapCut works on a copy; the gallery file is safe.)
- "Why do we export at 1080p and not the smallest size?" (Clarity â€" the video must look sharp on other people's phones.)
- "Why must we fix the captions?" (Auto-captions mis-hear names and local words; a wrong business name looks unprofessional.)

G.7 Errors to watch for during the demo

- **Wrong ratio:** if the preview is horizontal, the ratio step was missed. Fix in the ratio menu.
- **Captions not generating:** language set wrong, or no clear speech in the audio. Re-generate after choosing the correct language.
- **Clip won't move:** make sure it is *selected* (white border) before dragging; on some devices you must long-press first.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner edits their own footage into a tight **30â€"60 second** first cut that follows their Session 3 script, adds corrected auto-captions, and exports it. Learners without footage use the sample clip pack with the instructor's Adaeze script.

Starting materials: Your Session 2 footage on your phone; your Session 3 script; CapCut open. Sample clip pack available on the machine.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open CapCut â†' **New project**. Set ratio to **9:16**.
2. Import **only 6â€"12 clips** that match your script. Tap **Add**.
3. Play the whole timeline once. Decide which clip is your **hook** (first 3 seconds). **Pause and predict:** "Which clip should come first? Where is it now?"
4. **Reorder** so the hook clip is first (long-press and drag).
5. **Trim** the start and end of every clip so each one begins and ends on useful action. Remove "are we recording?" and the reach-for-phone moments.
6. **Split and delete** any stumble or repeat in the middle of clips.
7. Watch the whole video. If it is longer than 60 seconds, find two more places to trim. If it is shorter than 30 seconds, that is fine for now.
8. **Pause and predict:** "Read your video with the sound off. Does it still make sense?" (This is why clips must match the script.)
9. Tap **Text â†' Auto captions**, choose **English**, tap **Generate**.
10. **Correct at least three caption errors.** Check names (Adaeze, business name), places (Port Harcourt), and local words (Ankara, naira). Edit each wrong line.
11. Check caption readability: about **3â€"5 words per line**, large font, white text with a dark stroke.
12. **Pause and predict:** "Is any caption covering someone's face or the bottom buttons?" Move it if yes.
13. Tap **Export**. Choose **1080 Ã— 1920**, **30fps**, **MP4**. Export.
14. Play the exported file from your gallery and check quality.

Expected result: A **30â€"60 second vertical video** with a clear hook, no stumbles or dead air, readable corrected captions, matching the script, exported at 1080p in MP4.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 6: "Did the video get shorter or longer? Why?" (Shorter â€" we removed material.)

- After step 9: "What will the captions get wrong first?" (Names and local words.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Video is horizontal â†' set ratio to 9:16.
- Captions far too long â†' split the caption clips or trim them; aim for 3â€"5 words.
- Captions over the face â†' drag them higher on the screen.
- Export greyed out â†' make sure the timeline is not empty and the device has storage.
- App slow â†' close other apps; a long high-resolution project needs memory.
- Audio missing after export â†' check the clip's **Volume** is not set to 0.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Project created in **9:16**
- ☐ Only script-matching clips imported
- ☐ Hook clip is **first**
- ☐ All clips trimmed (dead air removed)
- ☐ At least one **split + delete** for a stumble
- ☐ Video is **30â€"60 seconds**
- ☐ Auto-captions generated and **at least 3 corrected**
- ☐ Captions are readable (3â€"5 words/line, high contrast)
- ☐ Exported at **1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4**
- ☐ Exported file plays correctly

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Take a **deliberately messy raw clip** supplied by the instructor and turn it into a clean **20â€"30 second** edited piece with captions. Unlike the guided exercise, you will decide the cut points yourself with no step-by-step calling.

Scenario: The instructor provides a raw clip: *Brother Emeka from a Port Harcourt church media team* speaking for about 90 seconds about an upcoming youth programme. In the raw clip he: greets for 10 seconds, stumbles once, repeats the date twice (getting it wrong the first time), and ends by trailing off. There are no captions.

Materials: The raw clip (in the sample clip pack under `raw/emeka_programme.mp4`), CapCut, your script-writing knowledge.

Requirements:

1. Import only this one clip.
2. Trim the greeting so the video starts within the first 2 seconds of real content.
3. Split and delete the stumble and the **wrong date** so only the correct date is heard.
4. Trim the trailing end so the video ends on the correct date and the church name.
5. Add **auto-captions** and correct any errors (the correct date, the church name, "Port Harcourt", and the presenter's name).
6. Target length: **20â€"30 seconds**.
7. Export at **1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4** and confirm it plays.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Video is 20â€"30 seconds.
- The wrong date has been removed; only the correct date remains.
- No stumble remains.
- Captions are present, readable, and corrected.
- Exported correctly and plays.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: To find the wrong date, listen once and note roughly *where* it is (e.g., "about 30 seconds in"), then scrub there and split.

- Hint 2: To remove a repeat, split *before* the repeat and *after* it, then delete the middle.
- Hint 3: If captions are too long, split the caption clip and delete the extra words.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Raw clip timeline (approx):

- 0:00â€"0:10 â€" "Good morning, good morning, praise God, how are you allâ€¦" (greeting, cut)
- 0:10â€"0:25 â€" "We want to invite everybody to our youth programme coming up on the **3rd of March**." (first/value)
- 0:25â€"0:35 â€" stumble: "On theâ€¦ on theâ€¦ the third, no, sorryâ€¦" (cut)
- 0:35â€"0:50 â€" "Our youth programme is on the **10th of March**, at Living Faith Chapel, Port Harcourt." (correct date â€" keep)
- 0:50â€"1:30 â€" trailing off: "So please, umm, we hope to see you, yes, soâ€¦" (trim to end on the church name)

Model edit:

1. Trim left handle to ~0:10 â†' start on "We want to inviteâ€¦".
2. Split at end of first sentence (~0:25); split again at ~0:35 (after the stumble) â€" delete the stumble and the first (wrong) date portion so only the second, correct date remains. *(The instructor's actual file may place the wrong date differently; the key is: only the correct date survives.)*
3. Trim the end so the video stops right after "â€¦Port Harcourt."
4. Auto-captions â†' correct "Living Faith" (not "Living Face"), "Port Harcourt" (not "Port Harkot"), the date **10th of March** (not "10 of much"), and the presenter's name **Emeka**.
5. Result: roughly **25 seconds**.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Length 20â€"30s (2)
- Wrong date removed, correct date kept (3)
- Stumble removed (1)
- Captions present + at least 3 corrected (3)
- Exported correctly and plays (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Sister Ngozi* runs the media desk for a small church in Rumuokoro, Port Harcourt. Every Sunday she records the pastor's 12-minute sermon on her phone and posts the **whole thing** to the church's Facebook page. The videos get very few views, and members complain the video is "too long" and "the sound is not clear".

Relevant facts.

- The full sermon is 12 minutes. Most viewers leave within the first 30 seconds.
- The most powerful moment in the sermon is a 40-second story the pastor tells near the end.
- Ngozi has a phone with CapCut. She has never used it.
- She does not have a computer and does not want to pay for software.

Decision point. Should Ngozi keep posting the full 12-minute videos, or change her approach?

Possible approaches.

1. **Keep posting the full video** and hope viewers watch.
2. **Post a 45â€"60 second highlight** cut from the sermon â€" the pastor's best 40-second story plus a hook line at the start and a CTA ("Full message in bio / Join us Sunday") â€" using CapCut on her phone.
3. **Stop posting videos** altogether because the response is poor.

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2. Short, captioned highlight clips are exactly what vertical platforms reward, and Ngozi already has everything she needs (phone + free CapCut). The workflow is the one learned today: **pick the best 40 seconds, trim the rest, split out any stumbles, add captions, export vertical**.

Reasoning / example workflow:

- Find the story (the strongest 40 seconds â€" the "hook" of the whole sermon).

- Trim so the clip starts with the first line of the story.
- Split and delete the church announcements before and after it.
- Add auto-captions and correct the pastor's name and Bible references.
- Add a CTA end frame: "Watch the full message â€" link in bio."
- Export at 1080 Ã— 1920, MP4, and post as a Reel.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is what she already does; it is easy but gets little reach.
- Approach 2 takes about 20 minutes per video but turns one 12-minute recording into several short clips â€" more content, more reach, and the full video can still be posted separately for those who want it.
- Approach 3 loses the church's reach and the members' access â€" not acceptable, as the media desk exists to serve them.

Professional connection. This "long video into short highlights" workflow is a paid job. Churches, coaches, and event organisers pay freelancers to cut long recordings into short clips for social media. Learning to trim, split and caption is directly the skill clients pay for â€" and it can be done from a phone.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live troubleshooting guide. When a learner hits an issue, do not give the answer immediately â€" point them to the relevant row and let them check.

K.1 The video is horizontal / has black bars on the sides

Symptoms: The preview looks like a TV (wide) instead of a tall phone screen; black bars appear. **Likely cause:** The project ratio was left at the default (often 16:9), or the footage was shot horizontal. **How to investigate:** Look at the top of the preview for the ratio label; check the ratio menu. **Corrective steps:** Open the **Ratio** / **Aspect ratio** menu and set **9:16**. If the footage itself was shot horizontal, it will need to be scaled/cropped to fill; for best results, reshoot vertical next time. **How to confirm resolved:** The preview is tall and fills the frame. **Prevention:** Always **set 9:16 at the start** of every vertical project.

K.2 Captions are missing or did not generate

Symptoms: You tapped Auto captions but no text appeared. **Likely cause:** (a) The language was set wrong. (b) The audio is too quiet or noisy. (c) The download of the caption model failed (needs internet the first time). **How to investigate:** Check the language setting; play your audio and listen if the speech is clear; confirm internet. **Corrective steps:** Re-run Auto captions with the correct language on good Wi-Fi; if audio is too quiet, raise the clip's volume first, then regenerate. **How to confirm resolved:** Caption clips appear on the text track. **Prevention:** Record clear audio (Session 3 skill) and generate captions while online.

K.3 Captions are wrong (names, places, local words)

Symptoms: "Adaeze" shows as "A day zay"; "Ankara" as "Anka ra"; the business name is misspelled. **Likely cause:** Speech recognition does not know Nigerian names, places or words. **How to investigate:** Read every caption line against the audio. **Corrective steps:** Tap each wrong caption and type the correct text. Fix capitalisation too. **How to confirm resolved:** Every caption matches what was said, with correct names. **Prevention:** Always budget time to **proofread captions** â€" never publish unchecked.

K.4 A wall of text on screen / captions too long

Symptoms: One caption line holds 10 words and is hard to read. **Likely cause:** Auto-captions grouped long sentences into one line, or the font/box is small. **How to investigate:** Pause on the caption and count the words. **Corrective steps:** Split the caption clip into shorter pieces (3â€"5 words) and delete extras; increase font size; add a stroke/outline. **How to confirm resolved:** Each line is short and readable at a glance. **Prevention:** Set a style with a readable size before generating, and split long lines as you correct them.

K.5 Caption sits on someone's face or under the platform buttons

Symptoms: Text covers a face, or the bottom app buttons hide it. **Likely cause:** Default caption position. **How to investigate:** Preview the video as if on the final platform. **Corrective steps:** Drag the caption up or down to a clear area; keep it clear of the

very top and very bottom. **How to confirm resolved:** Text is fully visible and covers nothing important. **Prevention:** Check caption position on a phone-sized preview before export.

K.6 Deleted the wrong clip and lost your place

Symptoms: A good part disappeared. **Likely cause:** You deleted the wrong piece, or split at the wrong point. **How to investigate:** Look at the timeline around the gap. **Corrective steps:** Tap **Undo** immediately (and repeatedly) until the piece returns. Then split more carefully. **How to confirm resolved:** The clip is back and the video flows. **Prevention:** Move the playhead **slowly** and watch the preview before splitting; undo is always available.

K.7 Export fails or takes forever

Symptoms: Export stuck, fails, or the app closes. **Likely cause:** Low storage, low memory, too many apps open, or very high export settings. **How to investigate:** Check free storage; close background apps. **Corrective steps:** Free up space; close apps; export at **1080p** (not 4K) for short videos; try again. If still failing, restart the phone. **How to confirm resolved:** Export completes and the file appears in the gallery. **Prevention:** Keep at least 5â€“8 GB free before editing; export at 1080p.

K.8 Exported video has no sound

Symptoms: The video plays but is silent. **Likely cause:** A clip's **Volume** was set to 0, or the original clip was muted. **How to investigate:** Select the clip â†’ **Volume** and check the level. **Corrective steps:** Raise the volume back to normal (100% or as recorded). **How to confirm resolved:** Sound plays on the exported file. **Prevention:** Play your edit once before exporting, watching for the sound icon/meter.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: In every row above, the *likely* cause becomes *confirmed* only after you check it (see the language setting, run the volume check, look at the storage number). Teach learners to confirm before changing things.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "First Cut â€” My 30â€“60 Second Captioned Video"

Purpose: To practise the full editing workflow end to end â€” create, import, trim, split, delete, reorder, caption, export â€” on the learner's own footage, producing the first deliverable of the capstone package.

Realistic scenario. Adaeze Fashion (the running business) has just shot footage for a short promo. You are the editor. Your job is to deliver a **first cut**: a clean, captioned, vertical video of 30â€“60 seconds, ready for Adaeze to review before publishing.

Detailed instructions:

1. Create a CapCut project in **9:16**.
2. Import the clips that match your Session 3 script.
3. Reorder so the video follows **Hook â†’ Value â†’ CTA**.
4. Trim all dead air and the reach-for-phone moments.
5. Split and delete at least one stumble or repeat.
6. Add **auto-captions** and correct **at least five** errors (names, places, local words).
7. Make captions readable: 3â€“5 words per line, high contrast, clear of faces and buttons.
8. Export at **1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4**.
9. Save the project (name it `FirstCut_YourName`) so you can add B-roll next session.

Required deliverables:

- The exported video file (30â€–60s, vertical, 1080p, MP4).
- A screenshot of the CapCut **timeline** showing your clips and caption track.
- One sentence in your workbook: "The clip I almost kept but cut was _____ because _____."

Submission format: Upload the video file and the timeline screenshot to the class folder (`/Content-Creation/Week2/FirstCut/`). Name files `FirstCut_YourName.mp4` and `FirstCut_YourName.png`.

Deadline: Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Correct ratio & export settings	3	9:16, 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4; plays cleanly
Cuts (trim/split/delete)	5	No dead air, no stumbles; tight and smooth
Order matches script	3	Hook first; Value and CTA in the right order
Pacing / length	3	30â€“60s; hook within 1â€“2 seconds; no dragging
Captions correct & readable	4	Present, corrected for names/local words, 3â€“5 words/line, high contrast
Presentation / professionalism	2	Clean, no unwanted end card, saved and named correctly

Common mistakes to avoid: forgetting to set 9:16; importing too many clips; leaving dead air at the start; publishing unchecked auto-captions; exporting at the lowest quality.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Reference edit plan for the Adaeze Fashion sample:

1. Project: 9:16.
2. Import 6 clips: hook (holding dress), fabric close-up, mannequin, Adaeze smiling, hands folding dress, shop front.
3. Order: hook â†' fabric â†' mannequin â†' smiling â†' shop front (CTA).
4. Trim each clip to 3â€“8 seconds; hook trimmed to start on "Stop!".
5. Split and delete a repeated phrase in the smiling clip.
6. Total â‰ˆ 45 seconds.
7. Auto-captions, then correct: "Adaeze", "Ankara", "Port Harcourt", "naira", business name.
8. Export 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4.

A strong learner solution will differ in content but will tick every rubric row: correct ratio/export, tight cuts, script order, 30â€“60s, corrected readable captions.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€“ answers only in the Instructor Key below.)

Q1. Short answer. In one sentence, what is video editing?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which aspect ratio should you choose for an Instagram Reel? a) 16:9 b) 9:16 c) 4:3 d) 1:1

Q3. Label the zones. Name the four zones of the CapCut screen.

Q4. Match the action to the job. Match each action to its description: *(trim / split / delete / reorder / undo)* a) Remove a clip's beginning or end. b) Cut one clip into two at the playhead. c) Move a clip to a different position. d) Remove a piece from the timeline. e) Reverse your last action.

Q5. True or false. Auto-captions are always perfectly correct and can be published without checking.

Q6. Error detection. A learner exports their vertical video and the picture looks blurry on a friend's phone. Name one likely cause and the fix.

Q7. Practical. List the correct export settings (resolution, frame rate, format) for a vertical platform.

Q8. Scenario. Your video is 75 seconds but the brief says 30â€“60 seconds. Describe two editing actions you would use to shorten it.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q8)

A1. Video editing is choosing which seconds the viewer sees and in what order â€" keeping the good parts, removing the bad, and arranging them to match the plan. **A2.** (b) 9:16. **A3.** Preview window, timeline, playhead, toolbar. **A4.** a) trim, b) split, c) reorder, d) delete, e) undo. **A5.** False. Auto-captions are a first draft; they mis-hear names, places and local words and must be corrected. **A6.** Likely cause: exported at low resolution. Fix: export again at **1080 Ã— 1920 (1080p)**. (Also accept: footage was

shot at low quality.) **A7.** 1080 Ã— 1920 resolution (1080p), 30fps frame rate, MP4 format. **A8.** Any two: trim long clips' starts/ends; split and delete dead air, stumbles or repeated sentences; shorten the CTA; remove unused clips.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you opened CapCut and turned raw footage into a real video. You learned the four zones of the screen, the five core actions (trim, split, delete, reorder, undo), how to match clips to your script, how pacing keeps viewers watching, how to generate and correct auto-captions, and how to export correctly for vertical platforms. You produced a 30â€“60 second first cut with captions â€” the first real deliverable of your capstone package.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Editing** = choosing which seconds the viewer sees and in what order.
2. The **five core actions** are trim, split, delete, reorder, undo â€” cut boldly, undo freely.
3. **Match clips to your script** (Hook â†’ Value â†’ CTA).
4. **Auto-captions must be corrected** for names and Nigerian words; keep 3â€“5 words per line.
5. **Export** at 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I create a 9:16 project and import clips without help?
- Can I split out a stumble in the middle of a clip and delete it?
- Can I reorder my clips so the hook comes first?
- Can I find and fix three caption errors?
- Can I export a correct vertical video that plays on any phone?

Connection to the next session. Your first cut works, but it is still mostly you talking. Next session we make it **hold attention**: adding **B-roll** (extra shots laid over your voice), legal **music** to set the mood, simple **transitions**, and then designing a **thumbnail in Canva** so people click. You will finish the edit and create the graphic that sells it.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner sets 9:16 **before** importing, without being reminded.
- Learner can find the playhead and explain what it marks.
- Learner splits and deletes a stumble independently and confirms it looks right.
- Learner reorders clips to put the hook first and can explain *why* that clip is the hook.
- Learner reads every caption line and corrects names/local words rather than accepting the first draft.
- Learner checks the exported file plays and looks sharp before saying "I am done".

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Editing deletes my original footage." → No; CapCut works on a copy, the gallery file is safe.
- "Longer is better / use every clip." → Shorter and on-message wins; unused clips are not wasted.
- "Auto-captions are finished automatically." → They always need proofreading.
- "The smallest export size is fine." → It looks blurry on other phones; use 1080p.
- "We can use any song." → No; use the CapCut library or royalty-free music only.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Trim drill:** give a single 30-second clip and ask the learner to remove exactly the first 5 and last 5 seconds.
2. **Split-and-delete drill:** give a clip with a repeated sentence and ask them to remove the repeat cleanly.
3. **Caption-hunt drill:** give a captioned clip and ask them to find and fix five errors.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a pre-imported project with clips already in order; learner only trims, deletes one stumble, and corrects captions.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full workflow from new project.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** add a simple text **title card** at the very start (business name, 2 seconds) and a second text line for the CTA; keep captions consistent; export and confirm. (This previews next session's text overlays.)

Timing guidance. The priority is the **guided exercise and export** (Sections G, H). If the room is slow, shorten Section J (case study) to a 3-minute mention and skip the optional export demo (G.5), then export together during the guided exercise. Protect the export step â€" a learner who never exports has no deliverable.

END OF SESSION 4

Next: Session 5 â€" Editing II + Thumbnails: B-roll, Music, Transitions and Canva Graphics.

SESSION 05 OF 9

Edit Advanced Thumbnail

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 05



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 5 â€" EDITING II + THUMBNAILS (B-ROLL, MUSIC, TRANSITIONS AND CANVA)

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 9
Session title	Editing II + Thumbnails â€" B-roll, Music, Transitions, Text and Canva Graphics
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Production (Editing and Graphics)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (building on Session 4)

Item	Detail
Prerequisite knowledge	The Session 4 first cut (a 30â€"60 second vertical video with corrected captions) and a working CapCut project. A **Canva account** (free) must be created before or at the start of this session.
Connection to previous work	In Session 4 you made a tight first cut â€" mostly a talking clip with captions. Today you make it **hold attention**: lay **B-roll** over your voice, add **music** (legally), use a transition or two, add **text overlays**, improve the **colour**, then design a **thumbnail in Canva** so people actually click.
Preparation before class	Canva accounts created (or create at start); CapCut B-roll permission; the Session 4 project ready to open; a small B-roll shot list written; royalty-free music note; example thumbnails printed for a "clickable or not?" vote; academy Wi-Fi on.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** what B-roll is and why it keeps viewers watching.
2. **Add B-roll** as an overlay clip above their talking-head video in CapCut and synchronise it to the spoken words.
3. **Add music** from the CapCut library (or a royalty-free source), **reduce the music volume** so the voice is clear, and explain why copyrighted songs must be avoided.
4. **Add a transition** and justify why transitions should be used **sparingly**.
5. **Add a text overlay / title** (business name, offer or key point) and make it readable.
6. **Apply basic colour/tone adjustments** (brightness, contrast, saturation) to make footage look consistent and professional.
7. **Export the finished video** with the correct vertical settings.
8. **Explain what a thumbnail is** and why it drives clicks.
9. **Design a thumbnail at 1280 Ã— 720 in Canva** using a template, brand colours, readable text and a face/emotion, and export it as an image.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner with the Session 4 CapCut project saved.
- One computer or a phone with a browser for Canva.
- Instructor device connected to the projector with screen mirroring.

Software

- **CapCut** (free) â€" already installed.
- **Canva** (free tier) â€" accessible via the app or a browser at canva.com. A free account is enough for everything today.
- A free Canva account (email or Google sign-in).

Sample files

- A **B-roll pack**: 8â€"12 short clips of hands, product close-ups, shop front, walking, smiling, packaging â€" for learners with no B-roll of their own. Stored on machines and a shareable link.
- A set of 6 printed example thumbnails (some strong, some weak) for the opening vote.

Music and sound

- Access to the **CapCut audio library** (built into the app).
- A note listing **royalty-free** music sources (CapCut library, YouTube Audio Library, Pixabay) â€" see the Lab Pack.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€" "B-roll Shot List" (hands / product / face / shop front / action).
- Worksheet 5.2 â€" "Thumbnail Sketch" (a 16:9 box for planning before using Canva).

Accounts

- Free CapCut account; free Canva account. No paid subscription required.

Internet

- Internet is needed for Canva and for downloading music from the CapCut library. Editing and export can be done offline once music is downloaded.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Canva runs in any browser and on any phone, so even a learner with only a phone can design a thumbnail. If the phone is too small to work comfortably, use an academy machine. The design decisions (colours, text, face) are the same.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, prepare the **same 40-second talking clip** in two versions:

- Version A: talking head only (the Session 4 style).
- Version B: the same talking head **with B-roll** laid over the voice â€" hands folding fabric, a close-up of the product, the shop front â€" plus quiet background music.

Play A, then B. Ask for a show of hands: "Which one would you watch to the end?"

What the instructor says:

> *"Same person, same words, same length. The only thing I changed is what you see while the person is talking. In version one, your eyes get tired of the same face. In version two, your eyes are busy â€" hands, product, shop â€" so your brain stays awake and you keep watching.*
>
> *The extra shots I laid over the talking are called **B-roll**. Today you will add B-roll and music to your own video. And then â€" because a great video nobody clicks is a wasted video â€" you will design the **thumbnail** that makes people click."*

Expected learner response: Learners will pick version B and may say "it is more interesting", "I can see the product", "it is not boring". Accept all answers. Write "B-roll = the shots over the voice" on the board.

Then reveal the hook: Show the six example thumbnails on the projector and ask, "If you saw all six on YouTube, which would you click? Which would you never click?" Count the votes. Say:

> *"Look at what made you click â€" a face, big words, bold colour. That is not luck. That is design. By the end of today, you will each make one of these, for free, in Canva."*

Why this opener works: It makes the value of B-roll *visible* (attention), then immediately connects editing to the next deliverable (the thumbnail), and it starts the session with a real decision the learners make themselves.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "Name the five core editing actions from last session."

- Expected answer: **trim, split, delete, reorder, undo**.
- Common gap: learners forget "undo". Remind them it is the safety net â€" cut boldly, undo freely.

Question 2: "What export settings did we use for vertical videos?"

- Expected answer: **1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4**.
- Common gap: learners say "1080p" without the height. Clarify 1080 Ã— 1920 is the vertical (9:16) form of 1080p.

Question 3: "Why must we correct auto-captions before publishing?"

- Expected answer: because they mis-hear names, places and local words (Adaeze, Ankara, Port Harcourt, naira).

- Common gap: some think captions only matter for the deaf. Clarify: most people watch with the **sound off**, so captions are for everyone.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Your first cut is solid â€" but it is still one face talking. Think of it like **egusi soup with only the soup**: it is good, but it is missing the meat and the fish that make it a real meal. B-roll and music are the meat and fish. And the thumbnail is the signboard outside the restaurant that makes people come in. Today we finish the meal and hang the signboard."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the five core actions, spend 5 extra minutes re-demonstrating them quickly on the projector before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 B-roll â€" what it is and why it works

The idea. B-roll is extra footage laid over the top of your main (talking) footage, so the viewer sees something relevant while they hear your voice.

Plain-English definition. The main footage â€" a person talking to camera â€" is called the **A-roll**. B-roll is everything else: hands, product, shop front, walking, scenery, an action. You show B-roll over the voice to illustrate what is being said.

Why it exists. The human eye gets bored quickly with the same picture. A face talking for 60 seconds, with nothing changing, makes viewers scroll away even if the words are useful. B-roll solves this: it gives the eye something to look at and the ear something to listen to **at the same time**.

What it does:

- **Holds attention** â€" the picture keeps changing.
- **Covers cuts** â€" when you cut out a pause or a stumble in the talking, B-roll hides the jump so it looks smooth.
- **Shows, not just tells** â€" instead of *saying* "our fabric is strong", you *show* hands stretching the fabric.
- **Adds feeling** â€" a slow close-up of a smiling customer feels warm; a quick shot of a busy shop feels energetic.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **commentator on radio versus television**. On radio, you only hear the voice. On television, the voice continues but you also see the players, the replay, the crowd. Television holds your attention because your eyes have something to do. B-roll turns your A-roll from radio into television.

How much B-roll? For a talking video, aim to cover a cut with a B-roll shot **every 5â€"7 seconds** or so. You do not need B-roll over every single second â€" sometimes the face and the emotion are the point. Balance.

Limitation / misconception. B-roll must **match what is being said**. If you are talking about the dress and you show a shot of a shoe, the viewer gets confused. Also, B-roll does not replace a clear message â€" it decorates it. A boring script with beautiful B-roll is still a boring video.

F.2 How to add B-roll in CapCut (overlay)

The idea. In CapCut, B-roll goes on an **overlay track** â€" a second video track that sits *above* your main video track. The overlay plays on top while the main footage continues underneath.

Steps (phone; wording may differ by version):

1. Open your Session 4 project.
2. Move the playhead to the moment where you want the B-roll to appear.
3. Tap **Overlay** (or the **ï¼‹ Add overlay / Add track** button).
4. Select your B-roll clip and add it.
5. The B-roll now sits on a track above the main video. Drag its edges to set exactly when it starts and ends â€" ideally it covers the words it illustrates.
6. Trim its start/end like any clip.
7. Repeat for your other B-roll shots.

Synchronising to the words. Place the B-roll so it appears just as the speaker mentions the thing. If Adaeze says "look at the fabric", the fabric close-up should appear on "fabric", not five seconds later.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion "look at the fabric" moment:

Time	A-roll (audio)	B-roll shown
0:00â€"0:04	"Stop! Before you buy that dressâ€¦"	Adaeze holding dress (A-roll)
0:04â€"0:10	"Reason one: the fabric does not fade."	Close-up: fabric being stretched
0:10â€"0:16	"Reason two: it fits all sizes."	Dress on mannequin
0:16â€"0:22	"Reason three: perfect for church."	Adaeze smiling (A-roll)
0:22â€"0:30	"DM 'FASHION' to order."	Shop front, then product

Important note on overlay audio. When you add B-roll, mute its own sound (set its **Volume** to 0) so we do not hear two audio tracks fighting. The voice should come from the A-roll. *You usually mute the overlay clip (volume 0) unless its natural sound is important.*

Common misconception. Learners think they need expensive extra footage. B-roll can be shot in **one minute** with the phone: hands with the product, the shop front, a close-up, a walking shot. Session 2 taught exactly these shots.

F.3 Music and sound effects

The idea. Music sets the mood and covers the silence; **sound effects (SFX)** are short sounds (a "whoosh", a "pop", a click) that add energy to a cut.

Why music matters:

- It makes the video feel professional and alive.
- It sets the emotion: calm for a testimonial, upbeat for a sale.
- It fills quiet gaps.

The copyright rule (teach this clearly):

- **Never** use a popular song you do not own. Recording a song playing on another phone and laying it over your video is still a copyright problem.
- Use the **CapCut built-in music library** â€" the tracks there are provided for use in CapCut. *(Availability and licence wording vary by track and version; check the track's label.)*
- Use **royalty-free** music (sources listed in the Lab Pack: CapCut library, YouTube Audio Library, Pixabay). "Royalty-free" means you can use it without paying per use.
- For a **business** video especially, staying legal protects the business from takedowns and complaints.

How to add music (phone; wording may differ):

1. Tap **Audio** on the toolbar.
2. Choose **Sounds** / **Music** (the library) or **Extract** / **Import** for your own file.
3. Search and tap a track â†' **Add** (or the plus/check). It drops onto an audio track.
4. Trim the music to the length of your video.

Volume balance â€" the most important setting.

- The **voice must always be the loudest thing.** Music is background.
- Lower the music volume so it sits *under* the voice. In CapCut, select the music clip â†' **Volume** and drag it down (a typical comfortable setting is well below the voice; the exact number differs by track â€" use your ears).
- Some versions offer **ducking** (auto-lowering music under speech, or "reduce background sound"). If available, it does this for you. *Wording differs by version.*

Sound effects. Add a short SFX (whoosh, pop) at a cut or a text pop-in for energy. Use them **sparingly** â€" one or two, not on every clip.

Worked example. Music set to a calm, low level under a testimonial voice; a single soft "whoosh" as the thumbnail-style text appears at the start. Voice clear, mood set, energy at the right moment.

Common misconception. "Loud music = professional." No. If the viewer cannot hear the words, they leave. **The words are the message; the music is the carpet under the words.**

F.4 Transitions â€” use sparingly

The idea. A **transition** is a short effect between two clips â€” a fade, a slide, a zoom â€” that moves the viewer from one shot to the next.

Why they exist. A transition can smooth a jump or add a little style.

The golden rule for beginners: Use few, and only where they help. The default and best cut is the plain **hard cut** (clip ends, next begins). Professional editors use simple **fades** or **cuts** far more than flashy effects.

How to add (phone; wording may differ):

1. Find the join between two clips on the timeline.
2. Tap the small **transition** icon/box at the join.
3. Choose a transition (e.g., **Fade** / **Dissolve**).
4. Adjust its duration (keep it short).

Worked example. Use a **fade from black** at the very start and a **fade to black** at the very end â€” clean and professional. Leave the joins in the middle as plain cuts.

Limitation / misconception. Loading every join with spinning, zooming, star-wipe effects makes the video look like a beginner's slideshow and distracts from the message. **When in doubt, use a cut.**

F.5 Text overlays and titles

The idea. A **text overlay** is words placed on top of the video â€” a title, the business name, a key point, a price, or an offer. A **title** is a text overlay used at the start to name the video or brand.

Why they matter:

- They make key information **unmissable** (business name, price, the "3 reasons").
- Like captions, they help viewers who watch with the **sound off**.
- They add branding and structure.

How to add (phone; wording may differ):

1. Move the playhead where the text should appear.
2. Tap **Text** â†' **Add text** (or a template).
3. Type the words.
4. Choose a **font**, **colour**, **size** and **position**.
5. Drag its edges on the timeline to set how long it stays.

Making text readable:

- **Big and bold** â€" readable at a glance on a small screen.
- **High contrast** â€" white text with a dark outline/stroke, or light text on a dark box.
- **Short** â€" a few words, not a paragraph.
- **On-brand** â€" use the business's colours and font where possible (we will set these in Canva).
- Keep it **clear of the platform's buttons** (top and bottom edges).

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion:

- 0:00â€"0:03: big title "3 reasons to love this dress" (white with dark stroke).
- 0:20â€"0:30: "DM 'FASHION' to order" (on-brand pink background box).

Common misconception. Learners pile text everywhere and the video becomes a poster that happens to move. Text should **punctuate** the video, not cover it.

F.6 Colour and tone basics

The idea. Colour/tone adjustment changes how the picture looks â€" how bright, how contrasty, how warm (orange) or cool (blue) it is. **Filters** are preset looks; **Adjust** lets you change values yourself.

Why it matters. Footage shot on different days, in different light, can look inconsistent â€" one clip bright-yellow, the next dark-blue. A small consistent adjustment makes the whole video feel like one professional piece.

The basic controls (phone; wording may differ):

Control	What it does	Beginner use
Brightness	Overall light/dark	Lift a slightly dark clip
Contrast	Difference between light and dark	Add a little "punch"
Saturation	Colour intensity	Slightly up for a lively feel; down for a calm one
Temperature	Warm (orange) â†" cool (blue)	Warm for cosy/food; cool for clean/minimal
Filter	A preset look applied to the whole clip	Pick one and keep it consistent across clips

Worked example. Two clips: one warm (shot in the evening), one cool (shot at noon). Apply the **same filter** to both so they match. Now the video feels like one piece.

Limitation. Over-editing colour makes skin look unnatural and food look fake. Small, consistent adjustments beat extreme ones. **Consistency across clips matters more than any single adjustment.**

F.7 Exporting the final video

Same as Session 4: **1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4**. Before exporting the final:

- Play the whole video once with sound **on** â€" voice clear above music? Captions correct?
- Play it once with sound **off** â€" does the story still make sense with captions and B-roll?
- Check the first 3 seconds (the hook) and the last 3 seconds (the CTA).
- Check no unwanted end card/watermark (see Session 4).

Then export, and confirm the file plays from the gallery.

F.8 Thumbnails â€" the signboard that drives clicks

The idea. A **thumbnail** is the single still image that represents your video before someone plays it â€" on YouTube it is the picture next to the title; on Reels/TikTok the "cover" serves the same job. It is your video's **signboard**.

Why it exists / why it matters. People scroll fast. Before they read your title or watch a second, they see the picture. A strong thumbnail makes them **stop and click**; a weak one makes them scroll past a great video. On YouTube, the thumbnail plus title are the biggest driver of whether anyone clicks. This is why serious creators spend real time on it.

What makes a thumbnail work:

1. **A face and emotion** â€" people click on faces, especially expressive ones (surprise, joy, curiosity). A clear face with feeling beats a plain product shot.
2. **Very few words** â€" **3â€"5 big words**. The thumbnail text is a hook, not a sentence.
3. **High contrast** â€" the subject stands out from the background; text is readable even at small size.
4. **Brand recognition** â€" consistent colours and fonts so followers recognise you instantly.
5. **Honesty** â€" the thumbnail must match the video. Clickbait that does not deliver makes viewers leave and stop trusting you.

Real-life comparison. A thumbnail is the **signboard outside a shop**. A bright, clear, inviting sign makes people enter. A faded, cluttered, unreadable sign makes them walk past â€" even if the shop inside is excellent.

Standard sizes:

- **YouTube thumbnail: 1280 Ã— 720 pixels** (16:9, landscape). This is what we design today.
- **Reels/TikTok cover: vertical 1080 Ã— 1920** (9:16). Same principles, tall shape. *(If you only make one today, make the 1280 Ã— 720; you can adapt it vertical later.)*

Common misconception. "Any picture from the video will do." No â€" a random paused frame is usually mid-blink or blurry. A designed thumbnail with a chosen expression, clean background and 3 words performs far better.

F.9 Canva â€" designing the thumbnail

The idea. Canva is a **free online design tool** with ready-made **templates**. You do not need to be an artist; you start from a template and change it.

Why Canva: it is free (there is a paid Pro tier, but the free tier is enough for everything today), works in a browser or app, and has thousands of templates â€" including YouTube thumbnail templates already sized at 1280 Ã— 720.

Key terms:

- **Template** â€" a ready-made design you edit.
- **Elements** â€" shapes, icons, photos, graphics you can add.
- **Text** â€" headings/subheadings you type.
- **Brand colours / fonts** â€" your business's consistent colours and fonts. *(Canva's saved "Brand Kit" is a paid Pro feature; on the free plan you can still keep your colours and fonts consistent by writing down their names/hex codes and reusing them, or by saving an example design and copying from it.)*

How to design a YouTube thumbnail in Canva (steps; wording may differ by version):

1. Sign in at **canva.com** (or the app).
2. Search templates for **"YouTube Thumbnail"** â€" these are pre-sized to 1280 Ã— 720. Choose one you like.
3. Or create a custom size: **Create a design â†' Custom size â†' 1280 Ã— 720 px**.
4. **Replace the photo:** upload or search for an image of your subject with a clear, expressive face (or your product). Drag it into the frame.
5. **Edit the text:** 3â€"5 big words (the hook). Use a bold, readable font.
6. **Add brand colour:** set the background or a shape to your brand colour so it matches your video and posts.
7. **High contrast:** put light text on a dark area (or vice versa); add a colour block or outline behind the text.
8. **Keep it clean:** remove clutter; make sure the face and the words are the two biggest things.
9. **Preview small:** zoom out so the design is small, like a real thumbnail in a feed. If you cannot read it, make the text bigger.
10. **Download:** tap **Share â†' Download**, choose **PNG** (best quality) or JPG. Save it to your gallery/desktop.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion thumbnail (1280 Ã— 720):

- Photo: Adaeze holding the Ankara dress, smiling, looking at camera.
- Big text (top-left): **"3 REASONS"**
- Smaller line under it: **"Why this dress sells out"**
- Brand colour: a pink block behind the text; Adaeze's face on the right, to the light.
- Result: readable at small size, on-brand, honest (the video really does give 3 reasons).

Limitation. A beautiful thumbnail cannot save a bad video. The thumbnail gets the click; the **content** keeps the viewer. Do both.

F.10 Summary of the session

- **B-roll** = extra shots laid over your voice; it holds attention and covers cuts. Place it every ~5â€"7 seconds and match it to the words.
- **Music** sets mood; lower it so the **voice stays loudest**; use **royalty-free/CapCut library** music, never copyrighted songs.
- **Transitions** â€" use few; usually a plain cut, with fades at the start/end.
- **Text overlays** â€" big, short, high-contrast, on-brand.
- **Colour** â€" small, consistent adjustments across clips.
- **Export** = 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4.
- **Thumbnails drive clicks**: face + emotion, 3â€"5 big words, high contrast, on-brand, honest.
- **Design the thumbnail in Canva** at **1280 Ã— 720**, download as PNG.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- The Adaeze Fashion Session 4 project open in CapCut on the projector.
- The B-roll pack loaded.
- Canva open in a browser, logged in, on the search page for "YouTube Thumbnail".
- An expressive photo of a person ready to drop into the thumbnail.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" B-roll overlay (5 minutes)

Say: "Watch where the B-roll goes â€" *above* the main video, on its own track."

Do this, narrating:

1. Move the playhead to "the fabric does not fade".
2. Tap **Overlay** â†' select the fabric close-up â†' **Add**.
3. Point at the new track above the main video.
4. Drag the B-roll's edges so it starts exactly on "fabric" and ends before the next sentence.
5. Select the B-roll â†' set its **Volume to 0** (mute the overlay so the voice stays clean).
6. Play the moment so the class sees the picture change while the voice continues.
7. Add a second B-roll over the next sentence to show the "every 5â€"7 seconds" rhythm.

Expected result: The talking continues but the picture switches to relevant shots. **Say:** "This is why people watch to the end."

Ask: "What would happen if I put the shoe shot here while she talks about the fabric?" â†' Confusion; B-roll must match the words.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" music, volume and a transition (4 minutes)

1. Tap **Audio â†' Sounds**, search a calm track, tap **Add**.
2. Select the music track â†' **Volume** â†' drag it down until it clearly sits *under* the voice.
3. Play and ask the class: "Can you still hear every word? Is the music just a carpet?" (Adjust live until it is right.)
4. At the very start of the video, tap the first clip's start â†' **transition** â†' **Fade**, short duration. Repeat a fade at the very end.
5. **Say:** "One fade at the start, one at the end. Everything in the middle is a plain cut. That is professional."

Errors to watch: music too loud (voice lost); a copyrighted song chosen (stop and pick a library track); ten flashy transitions added (remove them â€" show how messy it looks).

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" a text overlay (2 minutes)

1. Move playhead to 0:00. Tap **Text â†' Add text**. Type **"3 REASONS"**.
2. Choose a bold font, white with a dark stroke; place it in a clear area.
3. Build a second text at the end: **"DM 'FASHION'"** on an on-brand block.
4. Drag edges so each text stays for the right seconds.

Say: "Short, big, readable. Not a paragraph."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" the thumbnail in Canva (4 minutes)

1. In Canva, search **"YouTube Thumbnail"** and pick a template.
2. Delete the template's photo; drop in the expressive photo of your subject; resize.
3. Replace the text with **"3 REASONS"** + a short second line.
4. Change a shape/background to the brand colour.
5. Zoom out so it looks small; adjust so the face and the words are the biggest things.
6. **Share â†' Download â†' PNG**.

Ask: "Would you click this in a feed? What is the biggest word? Is the face obvious?" Point at the printed examples: "Notice the strong ones have a face and big words; the weak ones are crowded or have tiny text."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Why do we mute the B-roll's own sound?" (So the voice isn't drowned by two audio tracks.)
- "Why is the music quieter than the voice?" (The words are the message.)
- "Why only one or two transitions?" (Too many look amateurish and distract.)
- "What are the three things a clickable thumbnail needs?" (Face/emotion, 3â€“5 big words, high contrast.)
- "Why must the thumbnail match the video?" (Clickbait that doesn't deliver loses trust and viewers.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner finishes their Session 4 video by adding **B-roll**, **music at a low volume**, one or two **transitions**, a **text overlay**, basic **colour** adjustment, and exporting; then design a **1280 Ã— 720 thumbnail in Canva** and download it.

Starting materials: Your Session 4 CapCut project; your footage plus available B-roll; CapCut and Canva open.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open your CapCut project. Move the playhead through the video and note 3â€“4 places where the talking could be covered by B-roll. **Pause and predict:** "Which sentence needs a visual?"
2. Tap **Overlay** and add your first B-roll clip over the matching sentence. Trim its edges to fit. **Mute it** (Volume = 0).
3. Add a second and third B-roll over the other sentences. Aim for a visual change roughly **every 5â€“7 seconds**.
4. Play the video. **Pause and predict:** "Does each B-roll match what is being said?" Fix any mismatch.
5. Tap **Audio â†' Sounds**. Choose a **royalty-free / CapCut library** track (do **not** pick a popular song). Add it and trim to the video length.
6. Select the music track â†' **Volume** â†' lower it so the **voice is clearly the loudest**. Play and adjust with your ears.
7. Add **one fade** at the very start and **one fade** at the very end. Leave the middle joins as plain cuts.
8. Add a **text overlay** near the start (business name or a 3-word hook). Make it big, bold, high-contrast. Add a short CTA text near the end if you wish.
9. Apply a small, **consistent colour adjustment** or one filter across your clips so they match.
10. Play once with sound **on**, once with sound **off**. Check captions, voice, B-roll, text.
11. **Export** at **1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4**. Confirm it plays.
12. Open **Canva** â†' search **"YouTube Thumbnail"** â†' pick a template.
13. Swap the photo for your subject with an **expressive face**; type **3â€“5 big words**; apply your **brand colour**; zoom out to check readability.
14. **Download** the thumbnail as **PNG**.
15. **Pause and predict:** "Would a stranger click this? If not, what is the one change that would make them click?" Make that change.

Expected result: A finished 30â€“60s vertical video with B-roll, quiet legal music, a fade or two, a readable text overlay, matched colour â€" plus a 1280 Ã— 720 PNG thumbnail.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "Which B-roll is doing the most work for attention?"
- After step 6: "Cover the screen and listen â€" can you hear every word over the music?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- B-roll appears at the wrong time â†' trim/drag its edges on the overlay track.
- Two voices fighting â†' the B-roll's own audio is not muted; set it to 0.
- Music drowns the voice â†' lower the music volume.
- Video looks overdone â†' remove extra transitions/effects.
- Canva text unreadable â†' make it bigger, add a stroke or a colour block behind it.
- Canva download fails â†' check internet; try **PNG** and a smaller area.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- [ ] At least 3 B-roll overlays added and matched to the words
- [ ] B-roll audio muted
- [ ] Music added from the library (not copyrighted) and kept **below** the voice
- [ ] One or two transitions only (fades at start/end)
- [ ] A big, readable text overlay
- [ ] Colour/filter consistent across clips
- [ ] Exported 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4, plays correctly
- [ ] Thumbnail designed at 1280 Ã— 720 in Canva
- [ ] Thumbnail has a face, 3â€"5 big words, high contrast, brand colour
- [ ] Thumbnail downloaded as PNG

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Design a **different thumbnail** â€" this time for a *new* video â€" and choose the B-roll plan for it, without copying the instructor's demo.

Scenario. *Chinedu Electronics* (Port Harcourt) is posting a 40-second video titled **"The charger that never spoils."** They have supplied you:

- A photo and short clips of a phone charger on a table,
- a smiling shop attendant,
- the shop front. The video's value is that the charger is **durable** and **affordable (â‚¦2,500)**.

Requirements:

1. In Canva, design a **1280 Ã— 720** thumbnail for this video.
2. It must include: a **face with emotion (or a clear product hero shot)**, **3â€"5 big words**, **high contrast**, and a **brand colour**.
3. Write a short **B-roll plan**: list 3 shots and, next to each, the sentence it should cover.
4. The thumbnail and the B-roll plan must **match the video's promise** (durable, affordable â€" not misleading).
5. Download the thumbnail as PNG.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Thumbnail is exactly 1280 Ã— 720.
- 3â€"5 big words, readable when zoomed out.
- A face/emotion or strong product hero; high contrast; brand colour used.
- B-roll plan lists 3 matched shots.
- Thumbnail downloaded successfully.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: If you have no expressive face, use a **big, clean product shot** as the hero and let the words carry the hook.
- Hint 2: Write the words first ("NEVER SPOILS", "â‚¦2,500"), then build the picture around them.
- Hint 3: To check contrast, make the design small on screen â€" if the text disappears, add a colour block or stroke.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Model thumbnail:

- Background/brand colour block: deep blue (Chinedu Electronics brand).
- Hero image: the shop attendant smiling, holding the charger up, on the right; charger close-up faintly behind on the left.
- Big words (top-left, bold, white with dark stroke): **"THE CHARGER"** / next line **"THAT NEVER SPOILS"**.
- Small price badge (bottom-left, yellow): **"â‚¦2,500"**.
- Face + emotion (smiling attendant) âœ"; 4â€"5 big words âœ"; high contrast (white on blue) âœ"; brand colour âœ"; honest (video shows durability + price) âœ".

Model B-roll plan:

1. Close-up of the charger being **plugged in and working** â†' over "This charger does not spoil."
2. Shot of the **price tag / hand holding it** â†' over "And it is only â‚¦2,500."
3. Shot of the **smiling attendant handing it over** â†' over "Come to Chinedu Electronics today."

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Correct size 1280 Ã— 720 (1)
- Face/emotion or strong hero (2)
- 3â€"5 big readable words (2)
- High contrast + brand colour (2)
- Honest / matches promise (1)
- B-roll plan: 3 shots matched to sentences (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mama Chika's Kitchen*, a small restaurant in Port Harcourt, posts a video every day: a plate of food on a table with soft background music. The food is genuinely excellent, but the videos get very few views and almost no orders. Mama Chika is frustrated and is thinking of stopping the videos.

Relevant facts.

- The videos are just the plate, filmed from one angle, with no person and no movement.
- The captions say only "Delicious food ðŸ˜²" (plus an emoji).
- There is no B-roll of cooking, no steam, no hands serving, no customer tasting.
- The thumbnail/cover is a random frame where the plate is half out of shot.
- When a rival restaurant started posting short clips of **food sizzling in the pan, steam rising, a customer's first bite**, their views rose sharply.

Decision point. What should Mama Chika change â€" the content style, the thumbnail, or both?

Possible approaches.

1. Keep posting the same style and hope.
2. Change **both**: add **B-roll** (sizzling pan, steam, hands serving, customer tasting) and design a **clear, appetising thumbnail** with big words like **"HOT & FRESH"** and a price, in brand colours.
3. Only change the thumbnail and leave the video as it is.

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2. The rival's rise came from two things working together: **moving B-roll that makes the food feel alive**, and a **clickable thumbnail**. Approach 3 helps clicks but the video still fails to hold attention once played (the viewer sees a static plate). Approach 1 changes nothing.

Reasoning / workflow:

- Re-shoot 4â€"5 quick B-roll shots: pan sizzling, steam, rice being served, a customer smiling at the first bite.
- Lay B-roll over a short voice line ("Fresh jollof, ready in minutes â€" only â‚¦1,500").
- Keep music low; use the restaurant's colour (warm orange) consistently.
- Design a thumbnail: a big steaming plate (hero) + a happy customer face, 4 words **"FRESH JOLLOF DAILY"**, warm brand colour, high contrast.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 2 costs one afternoon of extra shooting and editing, but it directly addresses both problems (attention *and* clicks) and can be repeated for every dish.
- Approach 3 is faster but only fixes half the problem â€" a great thumbnail leading to a boring video loses trust.
- Approach 1 is free but keeps her exactly where she is.

Professional connection. Restaurants, salons and shops all hire content creators to do exactly this: capture **appetising B-roll** and design **clickable graphics**. A creator who can deliver both from a phone is directly employable â€" this is the core freelance skill this course builds.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the relevant row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Music is louder than the voice

Symptoms: You cannot hear the words over the music. **Likely cause:** Music volume too high, or the voice clip is quiet. **How to investigate:** Play the video; try to hear every word. **Corrective steps:** Select the music track â†' lower its **Volume**; if needed, raise the voice clip's volume slightly. If available, use **ducking** (auto lower music under speech). **How to confirm resolved:** Every word is clearly audible; music is a background "carpet". **Prevention:** Set music low *first*, then play-test before exporting.

K.2 Used a copyrighted song

Symptoms: A popular song plays; the platform may mute the video, block it, or strike the account. **Likely cause:** Music taken from the phone or another video instead of the library. **How to investigate:** Check where the track came from. **Corrective steps:** Delete it and add a **CapCut library / royalty-free** track instead. **How to confirm resolved:** The track is from a licensed/royalty-free source. **Prevention:** Only ever use the CapCut library or listed royalty-free sources.

K.3 B-roll does not match the words

Symptoms: A shoe appears while the speaker talks about a dress; viewers look confused. **Likely cause:** Overlay clip placed without checking the sentence. **How to investigate:** Play the join and read the caption at that moment. **Corrective steps:** Move the B-roll to the sentence it illustrates, or swap it for a matching shot. **How to confirm resolved:** The picture matches the words. **Prevention:** Plan the B-roll shot list per sentence before editing.

K.4 The video feels like a slideshow (too many effects/transitions)

Symptoms: Spinning/zooming between every clip; the message gets lost. **Likely cause:** A transition was added to every join. **How to investigate:** Watch the video; count the transition effects. **Corrective steps:** Remove most transitions; keep plain cuts, with a fade at start/end only. **How to confirm resolved:** The video flows smoothly without distraction. **Prevention:** Rule of thumb â€" "when in doubt, use a cut".

K.5 Text overlay is unreadable or covers the subject

Symptoms: Text is tiny, low-contrast, or sits over a face. **Likely cause:** Default size/placement, or too many words. **How to investigate:** Zoom the preview out to a phone size. **Corrective steps:** Use fewer words, bigger font, add a stroke/colour block, and move it to a clear area. **How to confirm resolved:** Visible and readable at a glance. **Prevention:** Check overlays on a small preview before export.

K.6 Colour looks inconsistent between clips

Symptoms: One clip yellow, the next blue; the video feels "patched". **Likely cause:** Clips shot in different light with no matching adjustment. **How to investigate:** Compare adjacent clips. **Corrective steps:** Apply the **same filter** or similar **Adjust** values to each clip (brightness/contrast/temperature). **How to confirm resolved:** Clips look like they belong together. **Prevention:** Shoot in similar light and apply one consistent look.

K.7 Canva thumbnail text is unreadable at small size

Symptoms: It looks fine big, but you cannot read it when zoomed out to feed size. **Likely cause:** Too many words, thin font, low contrast. **How to investigate:** Zoom the design down to thumbnail size on screen. **Corrective steps:** Cut to 3â€"5 words, use a bold font, add a colour block or outline, increase size. **How to confirm resolved:** Readable when small. **Prevention:** Design big, then **always check small** before downloading.

K.8 Canva download / account problems

Symptoms: Download button greyed out or file will not save. **Likely cause:** Certain template elements are Pro-only, or the internet dropped. **How to investigate:** Hover the element â€" Pro items are marked with a crown/Pro tag. **Corrective steps:** Replace Pro elements with free ones; reconnect to internet; try PNG; check storage. **How to confirm resolved:** The design downloads and opens. **Prevention:** On the free plan, prefer free templates and free elements; check before you spend time designing.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: Check before fixing â€" look at the volume number, read the caption at the join, hover the Canva element. Confirm the cause, then correct.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Polished Video + Clickable Thumbnail"

Purpose: To finish the capstone's first video deliverable to a publishable standard, and to create the first graphic (the thumbnail) â€" practising B-roll, legal music, transitions, text, colour and Canva design.

Realistic scenario. Adaeze Fashion is about to publish its first Reel. You are the editor and designer. Deliver a **finished 30â€"60 second vertical video** and a **matching thumbnail**, both ready for Adaeze to approve and post.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open your Session 4 project and add **B-roll** over at least three sentences, muting the B-roll audio.
2. Add **music** from the CapCut library (or a royalty-free source) and keep it **below** the voice.
3. Add **one or two transitions** only (fades at the start/end).
4. Add at least one **text overlay** (business name or a 3-word hook) and a **CTA text** near the end.
5. Apply a **consistent** colour adjustment/filter across clips.
6. **Export** at 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4.
7. In **Canva**, design a **1280 Ã— 720** thumbnail with a face/emotion, 3â€"5 big words, high contrast and a brand colour. Download as **PNG**.
8. Write one sentence in your workbook: "My hook words are _____ because _____."

Required deliverables:

- The finished video (30â€"60s, vertical, 1080p, MP4).
- The thumbnail (1280 Ã— 720 PNG).
- The one-sentence note in your workbook.

Submission format: Upload to `/Content-Creation/Week2/Polished/`. Name files `Polished_YourName.mp4` and `Thumbnail_YourName.png`.

Deadline: Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
B-roll used & matched	4	â‰¥3 overlays, each matching the words; audio muted
Music legal & balanced	3	Library/royalty-free; voice clearly on top
Transitions restrained	2	One or two only; cuts elsewhere
Text overlay readable	2	Big, short, high-contrast, on-brand
Colour consistent	2	Clips look like one piece
Export correct	2	1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4; plays
Thumbnail design	5	1280 Ã— 720; face/emotion; 3â€"5 big words; contrast; brand colour; honest

Common mistakes to avoid: copyrighted song; music louder than voice; B-roll that does not match; ten transitions; unreadable thumbnail text; Pro-only Canva elements on the free plan.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Video: Session 4 project + 3 B-roll overlays (fabric, mannequin, shop front) matched to sentences and muted; calm CapCut library track at low volume; fade-in/fade-out only; text overlay "3 REASONS" at start and "DM 'FASHION'" at end; warm filter across all clips; exported 1080 Ã— 1920, 30fps, MP4.

Thumbnail: Canva YouTube Thumbnail template; Adaeze smiling holding the dress; text "3 REASONS" + "Why this dress sells out"; pink brand block behind the text; high contrast; downloaded PNG at 1280 Ã— 720.

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key below.)

Q1. Short answer. What is B-roll, and name two reasons to use it.

Q2. True or false. You can lay any popular Nigerian song over your business video because it is on your phone already.

Q3. Multiple choice. Where should the music volume sit relative to the voice? a) Louder than the voice, for energy b) Equal to the voice c) Clearly below the voice, so every word is heard d) It does not matter

Q4. Explain. Why should transitions be used sparingly?

Q5. Label. Name three things that make a thumbnail clickable.

Q6. Practical. What size should a YouTube thumbnail be, and what file type should you download it as?

Q7. Scenario. Your two clips look different â€" one bright yellow, one dark blue. What is one simple fix?

Q8. Error detection. A learner's thumbnail has a paragraph of tiny text on a busy background. Name two changes to fix it.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. B-roll is extra footage laid over the main talking footage. Reasons (any two): holds attention, covers edits/cuts, shows instead of tells, adds feeling/mood. **A2.** False. Only use the CapCut library or royalty-free music; copyrighted songs can get the video blocked or the account struck. **A3.** (c) Clearly below the voice. **A4.** Because too many transitions look amateurish and distract from the message; the default hard cut is cleaner and more professional. Use only where they help (e.g., a fade at the start/end). **A5.** Any three: a face with emotion; few (3â€"5) big words; high contrast; brand colours/recognition; honesty/match with content. **A6.** 1280 Ã— 720 pixels; download as PNG (JPG also acceptable). **A7.** Apply the same filter or similar Adjust values (brightness/temperature) to both clips so they match. **A8.** Any two: use fewer words (3â€"5); make the font bigger/bolder; increase contrast (add a colour block or outline); simplify the background.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you finished your video and hung its signboard. You learned **B-roll** â€" extra shots laid over the voice â€" and how to add it as a muted overlay that matches the words. You added **music** from a legal source and kept it quietly under the voice, used **transitions sparingly**, added a readable **text overlay**, and made the clips **colour-consistent**. Then you learned what a **thumbnail** is and why it drives clicks, and you designed one in **Canva at 1280 Ã— 720** with a face, big words, high contrast and brand colour.

Five important takeaways:

1. **B-roll holds attention** â€" lay it over the voice every ~5â€"7 seconds and match it to the words.
2. **Music must sit below the voice** â€" and must be **royalty-free/CapCut library**, never a copyrighted song.
3. **Use transitions sparingly** â€" plain cuts, with a fade at the start/end.
4. **Colour consistency** across clips makes the video feel professional.
5. **The thumbnail drives clicks** â€" face + emotion, 3â€"5 big words, high contrast, on-brand, honest.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I add B-roll over the right sentence and mute its audio?
- Can I balance music under the voice and prove every word is heard?
- Can I explain why I must not use a popular song?
- Can I design and download a 1280 Ã— 720 thumbnail that reads clearly at small size?

Connection to the next session. Your video is finished and you have a thumbnail. But a great video with a weak **caption** still gets ignored. Next session we learn **copywriting**: hooks that stop the scroll, captions that sell, **CTAs** that tell people what to do,

and **hashtags** that reach the right audience â€" and how to turn one video into several posts. You will write the words that make people click, watch and act.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner adds B-roll over the *matching* sentence without being told which shot goes where.
- Learner mutes the B-roll audio automatically.
- Learner plays the video and *listens* to confirm the voice is above the music before exporting.
- Learner uses one or two transitions and can explain why not more.
- Learner designs a thumbnail, then **zooms out** to check readability before downloading.
- Learner chooses royalty-free/brand-safe assets without prompting.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Any music is fine." â†' No; copyrighted songs cause takedowns and strikes.
- "More effects = better." â†' No; simple and clean wins.
- "The thumbnail does not matter." â†' It is the single biggest driver of clicks.
- "Any frame from the video works as a thumbnail." â†' Random frames are usually blurry or mid-blink; design one.
- "Royalty-free means I must pay." â†' No; it means you may use it without paying per use (check each track's terms).

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **B-roll matching drill:** give three sentences and five shots; ask the learner to match each sentence to its shot (and say which two shots do not fit).
2. **Volume drill:** give a video with music too loud; ask them to make the voice clearly audible.
3. **Thumbnail triage drill:** show five thumbnails; ask learners to rank them and give one reason each using the three clickable rules.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a project with B-roll already imported and a near-finished thumbnail template; learner only places B-roll, adjusts music volume, and edits the text.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full B-roll, music, transitions, text, colour, and a from-scratch thumbnail.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** design a **second, vertical 1080 Ã— 1920 cover** for Reels/TikTok in the same brand style, and add a **sound effect** at a cut; explain how the vertical cover differs from the 1280 Ã— 720 thumbnail.

Timing guidance. The priority is finishing the **video** and producing the **thumbnail** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section J to a 3-minute mention and do the Canva demo (G.5) briefly, protecting learners' design time. Ensure every learner **downloads a thumbnail** â€" an undownloaded design is not a deliverable.

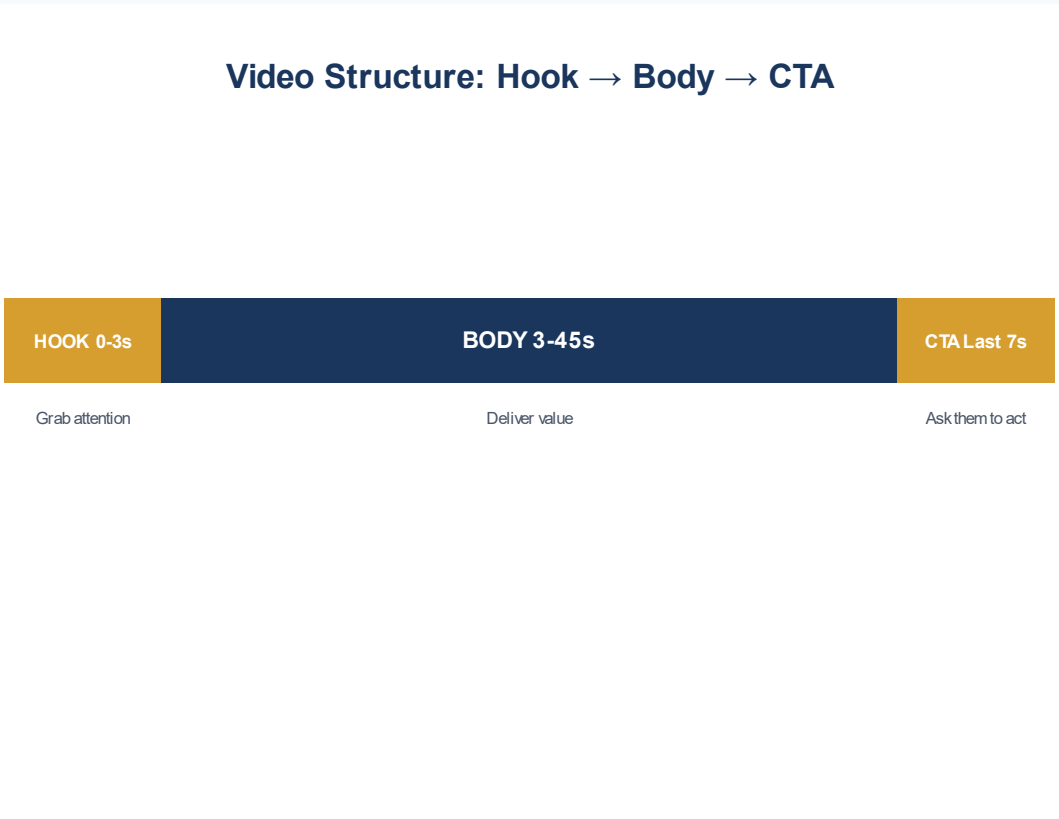
END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Copywriting: Hooks, Captions, CTAs and Hashtags.

SESSION 06 OF 9

Copywriting

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 06



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 6 â€" COPYWRITING: HOOKS, CAPTIONS, CTAs AND HASHTAGS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 9
Session title	Copywriting â€" Hooks, Captions, CTAs and Hashtags
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 4: Copywriting and Repurposing
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (writing, not software)
Prerequisite knowledge	The edited video from Session 5 (or any short video the learner has). Learners must be able to type (or dictate) a few sentences. No prior marketing knowledge required.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	You have a finished video and a thumbnail. A video with no caption is like a shop with no salesman â€" people walk past. Today you write the **words** that make people stop, watch and act: the **hook line**, the **caption**, the **CTA** and the **hashtags**.
Preparation before class	Print good/bad caption examples for the opening; a whiteboard or projector for live rewriting; the Session 5 Adaeze Fashion video ready to use as the running example; learners' phones with a notes app or Google Docs for typing; the Lab Pack "caption template" printed.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** the three parts of a caption: the **hook line**, the **value**, and the **CTA**.
2. **Write scroll-stopping hooks** using at least three formulas (question, bold claim, number/list, mistake, story).
3. **Write a complete caption** for their own video, following the hookâ€"valueâ€"CTA structure.
4. **Choose the right CTA** for a given goal (get comments, get orders, get DMs, get followers).
5. **Explain how hashtags work** and select **3â€"10 relevant hashtags** instead of stuffing 30.
6. **Adapt the same message** for different platforms â€" Instagram, TikTok, YouTube Shorts and WhatsApp Status.
7. **Repurpose one video into multiple posts** with different captions and formats.
8. **Use a reusable caption template** to speed up writing.
9. **Write three captions with hooks and CTAs** for their edited video, plus a hashtag set.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (with a notes app) or an academy computer with Google Docs / Notepad.
- Instructor device connected to the projector.

Software

- A simple text app: phone **Notes**, **Google Docs**, **Microsoft Word**, or Notepad. No special software needed â€" copywriting is words.
- Optional: access to Instagram/TikTok/YouTube to look at real captions (if internet is available).

Sample files

- Printed examples: **six captions** for the *same* video â€" three weak, three strong â€" for the opening activity.
- The **caption template** (below, in Section F) printed for each learner.
- A **hashtag list** for Port Harcourt / Nigerian small businesses (compiled by the instructor; see the Lab Pack).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 6.1 â€" "Hook Formula Bank" (a blank table for the five formulas).
- Worksheet 6.2 â€" "Caption Builder" (Hook / Value / CTA / Hashtags boxes).

Accounts

- None required. If learners wish to post, they use their own free social accounts, but posting is optional and not assessed today.

Internet

- Not required, but useful for looking at real examples and checking hashtags. The lesson works fully offline with printed examples.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any phone with a notes app works. A learner who cannot type quickly may write by hand or dictate to a classmate; the skill is the **writing**, not the typing.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show the **same 30-second video** (e.g., the Adaeze Fashion Reel) three times, each with a different caption underneath. Do not explain which is "right" yet.

- **Caption 1 (weak):** "Our new dress is available. Check our page. #fashion #dress #style #Naija #Ankara #PortHarcourt #trending #viral #fyp #love #instagood"
- **Caption 2 (weak):** "Hello everyone, welcome back to our page. Today we want to show you one of our new products. Please watch the video and let us know your thoughts in the comment section below. Thank you so much for watching."

Ask for a show of hands: "Which of these two captions would make you stop and watch?" Most pick neither enthusiastically. Then show:

- **Caption 3 (strong):** "Stop before you buy another ankara dress ðŸ'€ â€" here are 3 reasons ours never disappoints. Reason 3 will save you money at the tailor. ðŸ'‰ DM 'FASHION' to order yours today. #AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtFashion #AnkaraDress"

What the instructor says:

> *"The video was exactly the same in all three. The only thing that changed was the **words below it**. Caption one is a list of tags with no message. Caption two is polite but boring â€" nobody reads three lines of 'hello everyone'. Caption three has a **hook** ('stop before you buy'), gives **value** ('3 reasons'), and tells you exactly **what to do** ('DM FASHION'). That is copywriting."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point at caption three and say "it tells me to do something", "it is interesting", "it is short". Accept all answers and draw out the three parts: **hook, value, CTA**.

Then reveal the hook: Show the hashtag block in Caption 1 and ask, "Do you think ten random hashtags like #love and #instagood bring customers from Port Harcourt to this dress?" Explain that today they will learn which hashtags actually help.

Why this opener works: It isolates the *words* as the variable (same video, different captions), proving that copywriting â€" not the video â€" changes the result, and it introduces the three-part structure before any explanation.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the three parts of your Session 3 script, and what does each do?"

- Expected answer: **Hook (stops attention), Value (gives the reason/benefit), CTA (tells the viewer what to do)**.
- Common gap: learners separate the *video* script from the *caption* as if they were unrelated. Clarify: **the caption repeats and reinforces the script**, using the same three-part logic in words.

Question 2: "What is a thumbnail for, and name one thing that makes it clickable."

- Expected answer: a thumbnail drives clicks; a face/emotion, 3â€"5 big words, high contrast.
- Common gap: some learners think the thumbnail is the same as the caption. Clarify: the thumbnail is the **picture** that gets the click; the caption is the **words** that get the watch and the action. They work as a team.

Question 3: "Why do most people watch with the sound off, and how did we handle that in the video?"

- Expected answer: they watch in the bus, at work, in class; we handled it with **captions**.
- Common gap: learners forget captions are for everyone, not just the deaf.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Your video is the **meal**. The thumbnail is the **signboard**. The caption is the **salesman at the door** â€" the one who says 'come in, taste this, and here is how to order'. Today you become that salesman, in writing. A businessman with a good product and no salesman will still be hungry. Let us learn to sell with words."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the three parts of a caption, spend 5 extra minutes writing one caption together on the board, labelling Hook / Value / CTA, before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What copywriting is

The idea. Copywriting is writing words that persuade someone to **stop, watch, and take an action**. In content creation, the "copy" is your caption, your hook, your CTA and your hashtags.

Plain-English definition. Copywriting is **selling with words** â€" making a person want to click, watch, buy, comment, or follow, by choosing the right words in the right order.

Why it exists. You can have the best video in Port Harcourt, but nobody will watch it if the first words do not grab them and the last words do not tell them what to do. Copywriting exists because attention is scarce and choices are many: people scroll past hundreds of posts a day. Words are how you win one of those moments.

What it does:

- **Stops the scroll** (the hook).
- **Keeps them watching** (the value).
- **Tells them what to do next** (the CTA).
- **Reaches the right people** (the hashtags).

Real-life comparison. Think of a **market trader in Port Harcourt**. She does not stand silently behind her tomatoes. She calls out: "Fresh tomatoes! Ripe ones! Five hundred naira! Come and buy!" That is a hook ("fresh tomatoes"), value ("ripe"), and a CTA ("come and buy"). Copywriting is doing exactly that â€" but in writing, on a phone screen.

Important limitation / misconception. Copywriting cannot sell a bad product or a misleading video. **The words must be honest** â€" they should promise what the video and product actually deliver. Exaggeration that fails to deliver burns trust and reduces future reach.

How a learner recognises good copy. Read a caption and ask three questions: Did it make me want to stop? Did it tell me something useful? Did it tell me what to do? If yes to all three, it is good copy.

F.2 The anatomy of a caption

The idea. A caption is not a random paragraph. It has three jobs, usually in this order:

Part	Job	Example (Adaeze Fashion)
1. Hook line	The first line â€" stop the scroll	"Stop before you buy another ankara dress ðŸ˜€"
2. Value	Give the reason/benefit â€" why keep watching/reading	"Here are 3 reasons ours never disappointsâ€¦"
3. CTA	Tell them exactly what to do	"ðŸ‘‰ DM 'FASHION' to order yours today."
4. Hashtags	Help the right people find you	"#AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtFashion"

The first line is the most important. On most platforms, the caption is **cut off after the first line or two** with a "more" button. That means your **hook line is the only line many people will ever read**. If the first line is weak, the rest does not matter.

Length guidance for beginners: aim for roughly **40â€“80 words** for a short video. Short enough to be read in a few seconds, long enough to give real value. Use **line breaks** (blank lines) to make it easy to scan â€" nobody reads a solid block of text on a phone.

Real-life comparison. A caption is like the **back of a product packet**. The first line is the big claim ("Whitens in 7 days"), the middle is the benefits, the end is the instruction ("Use morning and night"). You read it top to bottom because each part earns the next.

Common misconception. Learners write captions that describe the *video* ("In this video I will show youâ€¦"). Do not describe the video â€" **speak to the viewer and give them a reason to care.** Nobody is moved by "in this video I will show you"; many are moved by "this one mistake is costing you money".

F.3 Writing scroll-stopping hooks

The idea. A **hook** is the very first thing the viewer reads or hears â€" the line that decides whether they stop scrolling or keep going. You have about **1â€"3 seconds** to win them.

Why it matters. On TikTok, Reels and Shorts, the hook is the difference between 200 views and 200,000 views. The hook is the "market trader's shout" that makes a passer-by stop.

Five beginner-friendly hook formulas (with Nigerian examples):

1. The Question Hook. Ask a question the viewer wants answered.

- "Still buying cheap ankara that fades after two washes?"
- "Do you know why your food business is not getting orders?"
- "Want your hair to still look fresh on Sunday evening?"

2. The Bold Claim Hook. State a strong, honest claim.

- "This is the only charger you need in Port Harcourt."
- "One caption changed my shop's sales. Here is the exact one."
- "This is the best jollof on the east side â€" come and prove me wrong."

3. The Number / List Hook. Promise a specific count.

- "3 reasons our dresses never disappoint."
- "5 things to check before you buy a phone charger."
- "2 mistakes that kill your church flyer."

4. The Mistake / Warning Hook. Warn them about a common error.

- "Stop making this mistake before you send money to a tailor."
- "Do not post another video until you fix this."

5. The Story Hook. Open a small story that makes them curious.

- "I lost â‚¦18,000 on one cake order â€" learn from my mistake."
- "A customer walked in for one dressâ€¦ and left with five."

How to test a hook: Read it and imagine a Port Harcourt stranger scrolling. Would *they* stop? If the first line could appear on any post from any brand, it is too generic. Make it specific.

Limitation / misconception. Do not make false claims to hook people. "This will make you a millionaire in one day" is a lie and will damage your account. **Hook with truth, not tricks.**

F.4 CTAs â€" telling people what to do

The idea. A **CTA** = **Call To Action**. It is the line that tells the viewer the exact next step. Without a CTA, people who enjoyed your video often do nothing â€" because you never asked.

Why it exists. People are busy and unsure. A clear CTA removes the decision: it tells them precisely what to do, and where to do it. A video with no CTA is a shop with the door closed.

Match the CTA to your goal:

Goal	CTA examples
Get **orders**	"ðŸ‘‰ DM 'FASHION' to order." / "Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order."
Get **comments**	"Comment 'AVOCADO' if you have done this before."

Goal	CTA examples
Get **followers**	"Follow for more Port Harcourt food spots."
Get **DMs / enquiries**	"Send 'PRICE' to our DM for the price list."
Get **shares/saves**	"Save this post before you forget."
Get **visits**	"Visit us at 24/26 Ebony Road, Port Harcourt."

Rules for strong CTAs:

1. **Make it specific.** "DM 'FASHION'" is better than "Message us." A single word is easy to obey.
2. **Make it easy.** One clear action, not three.
3. **Make it urgent (honestly).** "Only a few left this week" â€" only if it is true.
4. **Put it where they are.** For DMs, the CTA says DM; for calls, give the number; for a shop, give the address.

Worked example. Weak: "Hope you like it. Thanks for watching." Strong: "ðŸ‘‰ DM 'FASHION' to order yours today â€" same-day delivery in Port Harcourt."

Common misconception. A strong video does **not automatically** produce action. Even happy viewers need to be told what to do. **Always end with a CTA.**

F.5 Hashtags â€" how they work and how many

The idea. A **hashtag** is a word or phrase with a `#` in front of it (e.g., `#PortHarcourt`). On Instagram and TikTok, hashtags help **group content** and help people **discover** posts. On YouTube Shorts, hashtags also appear with the video and can help discovery.

How they work (simple understanding). When someone taps or searches a hashtag, they see posts using it. If your post uses a relevant hashtag, it can be shown to those interested people. Hashtags **help discovery**; they do **not** guarantee views. Relevance matters far more than quantity.

Relevance over volume â€" the key lesson:

- **3â€"10 good, relevant tags** beat 30 random tags. *(Some creators use more; for beginners, 3â€"10 focused tags is the safe, honest rule.)*
- Good tags are **specific** to your location, niche and audience.
- Bad tags are generic **#love #instagood #photooftheday #fyp #viral** â€" they bring random traffic that will never buy, and some platforms even warn against them.

A good hashtag set for a Port Harcourt small business (example):

- **Location:** `#PortHarcourt` `#PortHarcourtFashion` `#PHFood`
- **Niche:** `#AnkaraStyle` `#NaijaFashion` `#MadeInNaija`
- **Business/brand:** `#AdaezeFashion`
- That is a focused, relevant set of around **5â€"8 tags.** Much better than 30.

The business (brand) hashtag tip. Create a hashtag for your own business (like `#AdaezeFashion`) and use it on every post. Over time, it becomes a gallery of your work that customers can browse.

Common misconception. "More hashtags = more views." No. Random hashtag stuffing can look spammy, attract the wrong audience (who never buy), and on some platforms hurt your credibility. **Focused and relevant wins.**

Limitation. Hashtags are only **one** discovery tool. Strong hooks, watchable content and a clear CTA matter more.

F.6 Writing for different platforms

The idea. The **same video and message** can be posted on Instagram, TikTok, YouTube Shorts and WhatsApp Status â€" but each platform has a slightly different style. Learning to adapt is called **optimising for the platform**.

Platform	Style of caption	CTA style
Instagram (Reels/Feed)	Can be a little longer (2â€"3 short paragraphs); line breaks; hashtags at the end or in the first comment	DM / link in bio / save / comment
TikTok	Short, punchy, casual, often playful; on-screen text matters a lot; few hashtags	Follow / comment a word / "link in bio" (if available)
YouTube Shorts	Short, clear; the title matters; descriptive words help search	Subscribe / watch the full video / visit link
WhatsApp Status	Very short â€" one or two lines; no hashtags needed; a link or phone number	Call / reply / visit the shop / click a link

Worked example â€" same message, four platforms (Adaeze Fashion):

- **Instagram:** "Stop before you buy another ankara dress ðŸ'€ â€" 3 reasons ours never disappoints. ðŸ'‰ DM 'FASHION' to order. #AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtFashion"
- **TikTok:** "wait till reason 3 ðŸ˜³ | DM FASHION to order #ankara #nigeriantiktok"
- **YouTube Shorts (title):** "3 Reasons Our Ankara Dress Never Disappoints #shorts"
- **WhatsApp Status:** "New ankara dresses just landed âœ¨ DM or call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order. Same-day delivery in PH."

Why this matters. A caption perfect for Instagram may be too long for WhatsApp Status and too formal for TikTok. Adapting shows professionalism and reaches more people from the same video.

Common misconception. Learners think they must create brand-new content for each platform. They do not â€" they **repurpose** the same video with adapted words (see F.7).

F.7 Repurposing â€" one video, many posts

The idea. Repurposing is using one piece of content (a video) to make **several posts** across platforms and formats, instead of creating from scratch every time.

Why it exists. Content is hard work. A small business cannot shoot and edit a new video every day. Repurposing multiplies the value of one video, saves time, and keeps you consistent.

Ways to repurpose one 30-second video:

1. **Post the video to Instagram Reels**, **TikTok** and **YouTube Shorts** with adapted captions.
2. **Take 3 screenshots** from the video to make **3 photo posts** (Carousel) with the same message.
3. **Write a short text status** (WhatsApp) summarising the video's tip.
4. **Turn one B-roll shot** into a standalone teaser with a different hook.
5. **Save the best-performing clip** and reuse it next month with a new hook.

Worked example. Adaeze's one "3 reasons" video becomes: a Reel, a TikTok, a Short, a WhatsApp Status text, and a 3-image carousel â€" **five posts from one shoot**.

Limitation / misconception. Repurposing does not mean posting the *identical* caption everywhere. It means **adapting the message** to each platform (see F.6). Identical copy-paste is lazy and performs worse.

F.8 A reusable caption template

The idea. A **template** is a fill-in-the-blank structure you can reuse for every post, so you never face a blank screen. Here is a simple, proven one.

The CEA Caption Template:

```
[HOOK LINE â€" stops the scroll. A question, bold claim, number or warning.]
[blank line]
[VALUE â€" 2â€"4 short lines. Give the reason, benefit or tip. Use a list if helpful.]
[blank line]
[CTA â€" one clear action: DM 'WORD' / Comment / Call / Visit / Follow.]
[blank line]
[HASHTAGS â€" 3â€"10 relevant tags: location + niche + brand.]
```

Filled example (Adaeze Fashion):

```
Stop before you buy another ankara dress ðŸ‘€

Here are 3 reasons ours never disappoints:
1. The fabric does not fade after washing.
2. It fits all sizes, XS to XXL.
3. It is perfect for church and weddings.

ðŸ‘‰ DM 'FASHION' to order yours â€” same-day delivery in Port Harcourt.

#AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtFashion #AnkaraStyle #NaijaFashion
```

How to use it: copy the template into your notes, fill in the blanks for each video, then adapt slightly per platform. In time, the structure becomes automatic.

Common misconception. A template is a starting point, not a cage. Change the wording to fit the video. The **structure** stays; the **words** stay fresh.

F.9 Summary of the session

- **Copywriting** = selling with words: stop, watch, act.
- **A caption has three parts**: hook line, value, CTA â€” plus 3â€“10 relevant hashtags.
- **Hooks** use formulas: question, bold claim, number/list, mistake/warning, story.
- **CTAs** must be specific, easy and match your goal (DM 'WORD', comment, call, follow).
- **Hashtags**: relevance over volume; 3â€“10 focused tags (location + niche + brand), not 30 random ones.
- **Adapt for each platform** (Instagram, TikTok, Shorts, WhatsApp Status).
- **Repurpose** one video into several posts.
- Use the **reusable caption template** to write faster.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: a weak caption for the Adaeze Fashion video (from the opening activity).
- A blank caption template on the board/screen.
- A notes/Docs document open for live writing.
- The Session 5 video playing so the class can see what they are writing about.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€” dissect and label (4 minutes)

Say: "Before we write, let us see why the weak one fails."

Show the weak caption:

> *"Hello everyone, welcome back to our page. Today we want to show you one of our new products. Please watch the video and let us know your thoughts in the comment section below. Thank you so much for watching."*

Label it on the board out loud:

- **Hook?** "Hello everyone" â€” weak; it does not stop anyone.
- **Value?** "one of our new products" â€” vague; no reason to care.
- **CTA?** "let us know your thoughts" â€” weak and vague.
- **Hashtags?** None, or random.

Say: "This caption does not know what it wants. It is polite, but it does not sell and does not help. Now watch me rebuild it."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€” write a hook live (4 minutes)

Say: "The video gives 3 reasons to love the dress. So what is our hook?"

Write several options on the board and discuss each:

- Question: "Still buying ankara that fades?"
- Bold claim: "This is the only dress you need this season."
- Number: "3 reasons our ankara dress never disappoints."
- Warning: "Stop buying ankara until you watch this."

Ask the class to vote on the strongest hook, and explain why the number + "stop" combination usually works: it promises value and creates urgency honestly.

Expected result: The class chooses a hook (usually the number or warning). Write the winner at the top of the blank template.

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" build the full caption live (5 minutes)

Fill the template on the projector, narrating each choice:

```
Stop before you buy another ankara dress ðŸ‘€

Here are 3 reasons ours never disappoints:
1. The fabric does not fade after washing.
2. It fits all sizes, XS to XXL.
3. It is perfect for church and weddings.

ðŸ‘‰ DM 'FASHION' to order yours â€" same-day delivery in Port Harcourt.

#AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtFashion #AnkaraStyle #NaijaFashion
```

Point out each part:

- Hook: first line.
- Value: the numbered list (the reasons match the video).
- CTA: specific ("DM 'FASHION'"), easy (one word), with a true benefit (same-day delivery).
- Hashtags: 4 relevant tags (brand + location + niche). **Say:** "Four focused tags, not thirty random ones."

Ask: "Is this caption honest? Does the video really give 3 reasons?" â†' Yes. **Say:** "The words must match the video, or trust dies."

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" adapt for two platforms (2 minutes)

Take the same caption and adapt it on the spot:

- **TikTok:** "wait till reason 3 ðŸ˜³ | DM FASHION to order #ankara #nigeriantiktok"
- **WhatsApp Status:** "New ankara dresses landed âœ¨ Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order. Same-day delivery in PH."

Say: "Same video. Same message. Different clothes for different platforms."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Which line is the hook?" (The first line.)
- "Why is 'DM FASHION' better than 'message us'?" (Specific and easy to obey.)
- "Why only four hashtags?" (Relevant beats random; 3â€"10 focused tags.)
- "What would make this caption dishonest?" (Claiming 3 reasons if the video gave fewer, or promising something undelivered.)
- "Can we post this same caption on WhatsApp Status?" (No â€" adapt it; too long, hashtags not needed there.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner writes **one complete caption** (hook + value + CTA + hashtags) for their own Session 5 video, using the template, then adapts it for a second platform.

Starting materials: Your edited video; a notes app or Google Docs; the printed caption template.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open your notes app. Copy the **caption template** (Hook / Value / CTA / Hashtags).
2. Watch your own video once. **Pause and predict:** "What is the single best reason someone should care about this video?" Write that as the **value**.
3. Write **three different hooks** for the same video â€" one question, one number/list, one warning. (Worksheet 6.1.)
4. Choose your strongest hook and put it on the first line. **Pause and predict:** "Would a Port Harcourt stranger stop for this line?"
5. Write the **value** in 2â€"4 short lines. Use a list if you have reasons.
6. Write a **specific CTA** that matches your goal (order? comments? follow?). Use a single word in quotes if you want DMs (e.g., DM 'FASHION').
7. Add **3â€"10 relevant hashtags**: location + niche + your brand.
8. Read the whole caption aloud, slowly. Fix anything vague, dishonest or long.
9. **Pause and predict:** "Which platform is this caption best for?" Now **adapt it for a different platform** (e.g., WhatsApp Status â€" shorten it and drop hashtags).
10. Save both versions.

Expected result: One complete caption (hook + value + CTA + 3â€"10 hashtags) plus one adapted version for a second platform.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "Which of your three hooks would you personally stop for, and why?"
- After step 6: "If a viewer follows your CTA, what exactly happens next?"

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Caption is a solid block â†' add blank lines; split into hook / value / CTA.
- Hook is "hello everyone" â†' replace with a question, number or warning.
- No CTA â†' add one specific action.
- 20+ hashtags â†' cut to 3â€"10 relevant ones.
- CTA and value disagree â†' align them (if you ask for a DM, make sure the value makes the DM worth it).
- Caption promises something the video does not show â†' fix the words or the video.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Hook line is a question, number, claim or warning (not a greeting)
- ☐ Value section gives 2â€"4 clear reasons/benefits
- ☐ CTA is specific and matches a goal
- ☐ 3â€"10 relevant hashtags (location + niche + brand)
- ☐ Blank lines used for easy reading
- ☐ Caption is honest (matches the video)
- ☐ A second, platform-adapted version written

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Write a full caption for a **different business and video** than your own, and a **hashtag set**, without copying the instructor's Adaeze example.

Scenario. *Mama Chika's Kitchen* (from Session 5) has a 30-second video showing **jollof rice frying, steam rising, and a customer smiling at the first bite**. The business is in Port Harcourt, sells **fresh jollof daily at â‚¦1,500**, and delivers within the city. Their goal is **more orders by phone call**.

Requirements:

1. Write a **caption** with all four parts: hook, value, CTA, hashtags.
2. The hook must use one of the **five formulas** (question, bold claim, number, warning, story).
3. The **CTA must match the goal** â€" more orders by phone.
4. Include **3â€"10 relevant hashtags** (location + niche + brand).
5. Write **one adapted version** for **WhatsApp Status** (shorter, no hashtags, with the phone number).

6. State in one line **which hook formula** you used and why.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Caption has all four parts clearly.
- Hook uses a named formula and is not a greeting.
- CTA gives a phone-call action.
- Hashtags are relevant and 3â€"10 in number.
- A WhatsApp Status version is written and clearly shorter.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the hook, start with the words "Stillâ€¦" (question) or "3 reasonsâ€¦" (number) or "Stopâ€¦" (warning).
- Hint 2: The CTA is easiest if you name the exact action and number: "Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order."
- Hint 3: For WhatsApp, remove hashtags and keep only one or two lines plus the phone number.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

Caption (Instagram/TikTok):

```
Still queuing for jollof that is not fresh? ðŸ²

Mama Chika's jollof is cooked fresh every morning â€"
hot, smoky, and only â‚¦1,500 a plate.
Free delivery within Port Harcourt.

ðŸ‘‰ Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order yours today.

#MamaChikasKitchen #PortHarcourtFood #PHJollof #NaijaFood
```

(Hook formula: Question â€" "Still queuing for jollof that is not fresh?" Chosen because it speaks directly to the pain of cold/old food and pulls the reader in.)

WhatsApp Status version:

```
Fresh smoky jollof, â‚¦1,500 a plate ðŸ²
Free delivery in PH. Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order.
```

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Hook uses a named formula & is not a greeting (3)
- Value gives clear reasons/benefit (2)
- CTA matches goal (phone order) and is specific (2)
- 3â€"10 relevant hashtags (2)
- WhatsApp Status adapted & shorter (1)
- *(Bonus acknowledgement)* honesty â€" words match the video (included in value marks)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Emeka* runs a small phone-accessory shop in Port Harcourt. He posts the **same video** to Instagram and TikTok every week, always with the caption: **"Quality phones and accessories. Call us."** His videos get a few views, and he rarely gets orders from social media. Meanwhile, a competitor, *Blessing*, posts similar videos but with captions like **"Your phone dies by 2pm? This power bank fixes that â€" DM 'CHARGE' to order"** and gets steady DMs.

Relevant facts.

- Emeka's videos are actually fine â€" clear product shots and good light.
- Emeka's caption never changes and gives no reason to care, no specific action, and no hashtags.
- Blessing's caption uses a **question hook** (pain point: phone dying), a **value** (the power bank solves it), a **specific CTA** (DM 'CHARGE'), and a few **relevant hashtags**.

- Emeka has the same products and similar prices.

Decision point. What should Emeka change â€” his videos, his products, or his captions?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy new equipment and reshoot better videos.
2. Rewrite his captions using hookâ€”valueâ€”CTA and relevant hashtags.
3. Copy Blessing's exact captions word for word.

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2. The problem is not the video or the product â€” it is the **words**. Emeka's videos are already fine; his caption does no selling. Rewriting the caption is free, immediate, and directly addresses the gap.

Reasoning / example rewrite for Emeka's power-bank video:

- **Hook (question):** "Does your phone die before 2pm?"
- **Value:** "This 20,000mAh power bank charges your phone 4 times â€” take it anywhere in PH."
- **CTA (matches goal â€” DMs):** "DM 'CHARGE' for the price."
- **Hashtags:** "#EmekaGadgets #PortHarcourtPhones #PowerBank"

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 costs money and time, and the videos are already good â€” it solves a problem he does not have.
- Approach 2 is free and can be done in minutes; it directly fixes the actual weakness. It also scales â€” he can reuse the template forever.
- Approach 3 is dishonest copying and will not fit Emeka's products or brand; it also risks looking identical to a competitor.

Professional connection. Brands and agencies pay **copywriters** specifically to write captions, hooks and CTAs â€” sometimes more than they pay editors. A creator who can both edit *and* write converting captions is far more valuable, and can charge more or handle the whole job for a small business. This session's skill is a paid skill on its own.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 The hook is a greeting ("Hello everyone, welcome back")

Symptoms: Very few people stop; view counts stay low. **Likely cause:** The first line is polite but not interesting; it gives no reason to stop. **How to investigate:** Read only the first line. Would a stranger stop? **Corrective steps:** Replace it with a question, number, bold claim or warning. **How to confirm resolved:** The first line raises a question or promise. **Prevention:** Never start a caption with a greeting; start with the hook.

K.2 No CTA (or a vague one)

Symptoms: People watch but do not order, comment or follow. **Likely cause:** The caption never told them what to do, or said "message us" with no specifics. **How to investigate:** Find the last line. Is there one clear action? **Corrective steps:** Add a specific CTA matching the goal â€” "DM 'FASHION'", "Call 0803-XXX-XXXX", "Comment 'YES'". **How to confirm resolved:** There is exactly one clear action. **Prevention:** End every caption with a CTA.

K.3 Hashtag stuffing (20â€“30 random tags)

Symptoms: Random traffic, wrong audience, sometimes reduced reach; looks spammy. **Likely cause:** A belief that more hashtags = more views. **How to investigate:** Count the tags and ask if each relates to the post. **Corrective steps:** Cut to **3â€“10 relevant** tags: location + niche + brand. **How to confirm resolved:** Every remaining tag is relevant. **Prevention:** Save a small set of proven relevant hashtags and reuse it.

K.4 Caption is an essay (a solid block of text)

Symptoms: Nobody reads past the first line; the message is buried. **Likely cause:** No line breaks, too many words. **How to investigate:** Look at it on a phone â€” is it scannable? **Corrective steps:** Break into hook / value / CTA with blank lines; cut to ~40â€“80 words. **How to confirm resolved:** It reads easily in a few seconds. **Prevention:** Use the template; keep short lines.

K.5 Caption does not match the video (clickbait)

Symptoms: Viewers leave quickly; comments accuse you of misleading them; trust drops. **Likely cause:** The hook promises something the video does not deliver. **How to investigate:** Watch the video, then re-read the hook. **Corrective steps:** Change the words to match the video, or re-edit the video to deliver the promise. **How to confirm resolved:** The caption and video tell the same story. **Prevention:** Write the caption after watching the final video.

K.6 Same caption copy-pasted on every platform

Symptoms: It feels off â€” too long for WhatsApp, too formal for TikTok. **Likely cause:** No adaptation. **How to investigate:** Check the platform's style (length, tone, hashtags). **Corrective steps:** Adapt length and tone per platform; drop hashtags on WhatsApp Status. **How to confirm resolved:** The caption fits the platform. **Prevention:** Keep one master caption, then tailor a short version per platform.

K.7 The value is vague

Symptoms: "Quality products", "Best service" â€” no one is moved. **Likely cause:** Generic words instead of specific benefits. **How to investigate:** Ask "so what?" after each line. **Corrective steps:** Replace vague claims with specifics: "charges your phone 4 times", "delivery in 2 hours", "â‚¦1,500 a plate". **How to confirm resolved:** Each value line gives a concrete reason. **Prevention:** Always answer "what is the benefit for the viewer?"

K.8 CTA and value contradict

Symptoms: You ask for a phone call but the video is about a free tip; or you ask for a DM but give no detail to DM about. **Likely cause:** The CTA was chosen before the message. **How to investigate:** Read the value then the CTA. **Corrective steps:** Align them â€” the CTA should be the natural next step after the value. **How to confirm resolved:** The action makes sense right after the value. **Prevention:** Decide the value first, then choose the CTA that follows from it.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: Check before fixing â€” count the hashtags, find the CTA line, watch the video against the hook. Confirm the cause, then correct.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Copy Pack â€” 3 Captions, Hooks and Hashtags"

Purpose: To practise writing scroll-stopping hooks, complete captions, goal-matched CTAs and relevant hashtag sets â€” the words that turn views into customers â€” and to build part of the capstone's captions document.

Realistic scenario. Adaeze Fashion is planning three posts from the same shoot: (1) the main "3 reasons" video, (2) a behind-the-scenes clip of the shop, and (3) a customer testimonial clip. You are the copywriter. Write a complete caption pack for all three.

Detailed instructions:

1. Watch your finished Session 5 video.
2. Write **three different captions**, one for each of the three post ideas (main video, behind-the-scenes, testimonial).
3. Each caption must contain: a **hook**, **value**, a **CTA** and **3â€“10 relevant hashtags**.
4. Use a **different hook formula** for each caption (question, number, warning, etc.).
5. Choose the CTA to match the goal: post 1 = **orders (DM 'FASHION')**, post 2 = **followers (follow)**, post 3 = **comments/testimonials (comment)**.
6. Add **one WhatsApp Status version** of your strongest caption (shorter, no hashtags, with a phone number).
7. Write one line at the end: "My strongest hook is _____ because _____."

Required deliverables:

- A captions document with 3 captions + 1 WhatsApp Status version.
- The one-line reflection on the strongest hook.

Submission format: Save as `Captions_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`) and upload to `/Content-Creation/Week2/Captions/`. You may also copy the text into your workbook.

Deadline: Before Session 7.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Hooks stop the scroll	5	Each is a question/claim/number/warning/story; none is a greeting
Value is clear & specific	4	2â€“4 concrete reasons/benefits per caption
CTA matches goal	4	Specific, easy, aligned with the stated goal per post
Hashtags relevant (3â€“10)	3	Location + niche + brand; no random stuffing
Platform adaptation	2	WhatsApp Status version shorter, no hashtags, phone number
Honesty & clarity	2	Words match the videos; easy to read (line breaks)

Common mistakes to avoid: greeting hooks; missing/vague CTAs; hashtag stuffing; essay captions; clickbait that does not match the video; copy-pasting the same caption everywhere.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Post 1 â€" main "3 reasons" video (goal: orders):

```
Stop before you buy another ankara dress ðŸ‘€

Here are 3 reasons ours never disappoints:
1. The fabric does not fade after washing.
2. It fits all sizes, XS to XXL.
3. It is perfect for church and weddings.

ðŸ‘‰ DM 'FASHION' to order yours â€" same-day delivery in Port Harcourt.

#AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtFashion #AnkaraStyle #NaijaFashion
```

Post 2 â€" behind-the-scenes (goal: followers):

```
Ever wonder how a new dress arrives at Adaeze Fashion? ðŸ§µ

We handpick every fabric ourselves in Port Harcourt â€"
that is why our colours stay rich and our prices stay fair.

ðŸ‘‰ Follow @AdaezeFashion for more behind-the-scenes.

#AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtBusiness #NaijaStyle
```

Post 3 â€" customer testimonial (goal: comments):

```
She came in for one dress â€" and left with three. ðŸ˜„

Our customers keep coming back because the fit is right
and the fabric lasts. Now we want to hear from you.

ðŸ‘‰ Comment your favourite Adaeze dress style below!

#AdaezeFashion #CustomerLove #PortHarcourtFashion
```

WhatsApp Status version (post 1):

```
New ankara dresses just landed âœ¨ 3 reasons you will love them.
DM 'FASHION' or call 0803-XXX-XXXX. Same-day delivery in PH.
```

A strong learner solution differs in content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key below.)

Q1. Short answer. Name the three parts of a caption, in order.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the strongest hook line? a) "Hello everyone, welcome back." b) "We sell quality products." c) "Stop buying ankara that fades after two washes." d) "Please watch the video."

Q3. Match the goal to the CTA. Match each goal to a suitable CTA. *(order / followers / comments / calls)* a) "Follow for more PH food spots." b) "DM 'FASHION' to order." c) "Comment 'YES' if you agree." d) "Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to book."

Q4. True or false. Using 30 hashtags is always better than using 5.

Q5. Explain. Why is the first line of a caption the most important?

Q6. Practical. Give 4 relevant hashtags for Adaeze Fashion (Port Harcourt ankara business).

Q7. Scenario. Your CTA is "Message us" but nobody messages. Rewrite it to be specific, for a dress shop that wants orders by DM.

Q8. Repurposing. List two ways to turn one finished 30-second video into more than one post.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q8)

A1. Hook line, Value, CTA (then hashtags). **A2.** (c) "Stop buying ankara that fades after two washes." (It is a specific warning that stops the scroll.) **A3.** a) followers, b) order, c) comments, d) calls. **A4.** False. Relevance matters more than volume; 3â€"10 focused tags beat 30 random ones. **A5.** Because captions are usually cut off after the first line or two, so for many people the first line is the only line they read â€" it decides whether they read/watch more. **A6.** Any four relevant, e.g.: #AdaezeFashion #PortHarcourtFashion #AnkaraStyle #NaijaFashion #PortHarcourtBusiness #MadeInNaija. **A7.** "ðŸ'‰ DM 'FASHION' to order yours â€" same-day delivery in Port Harcourt." **A8.** Any two: post to multiple platforms with adapted captions; take screenshots for a carousel; write a WhatsApp Status text version; use a B-roll shot as a teaser; repost later with a new hook.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to sell with words. You learned that a caption has three parts â€" **hook, value, CTA** â€" plus **3â€"10 relevant hashtags**. You learned five hook formulas (question, bold claim, number/list, warning, story), how to write CTAs that match your goal, why **relevance beats volume** with hashtags, how to adapt one message for Instagram, TikTok, YouTube Shorts and WhatsApp Status, and how to **repurpose** one video into several posts using a reusable caption template. You wrote a full caption pack for your finished video.

Five important takeaways:

1. **A caption = hook + value + CTA + hashtags.**
2. **The hook is the most important line** â€" never start with a greeting.
3. **Every post needs a specific CTA** that matches your goal.
4. **Hashtags: relevance over volume** â€" 3â€"10 focused tags (location + niche + brand).
5. **Repurpose and adapt** â€" one video, many posts, tailored per platform.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I write three different hooks for one video?
- Can I build a caption using the template without help?
- Can I choose a CTA that matches an order, a comment or a follow?
- Can I pick 3â€"10 hashtags that are actually relevant?
- Can I turn one video into a caption pack for several platforms?

Connection to the next session. You now have a finished video, a thumbnail and your copy. But posting randomly â€" "whenever I feel like it" â€" is why most businesses stay invisible. Next session we plan a **one-week content calendar**, batch our work, and lock down **brand consistency** (colours, fonts, voice) so your whole page looks and sounds like one professional business. You will turn your single video into a **planned week**.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner's hook line is a question/claim/number/warning, not a greeting, without being told.
- Learner's CTA is specific ("DM 'FASHION'") rather than vague ("message us").
- Learner selects a **small, relevant** hashtag set instead of stuffing.
- Learner adapts the caption for a second platform (shorter for WhatsApp Status).
- Learner checks the caption against the video for honesty.
- Learner uses line breaks to make the caption scannable.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "More hashtags = more views." â†' No; relevance beats volume.
- "A good video sells itself; no caption needed." â†' Even happy viewers need a hook and a CTA.
- "I should write whatever I feel." â†' Write for the viewer's benefit, not your mood.
- "I can copy my competitor's caption." â†' Adapt the structure, not the content; copying is dishonest and off-brand.
- "Exaggerating gets more clicks." â†' Clickbait that fails to deliver destroys trust and reach.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Hook rewrite drill:** give five weak first lines ("Hello everyone", "We sell quality") and ask the learner to rewrite each as a question/number/warning.
2. **CTA matching drill:** give four goals and four CTAs; ask the learner to match and justify.
3. **Hashtag sort drill:** give 20 hashtags (some relevant, some random) and ask the learner to keep only the 5â€"8 relevant ones.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a caption template with the value already filled in; learner writes only the hook and the CTA.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full caption pack for three posts.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** write a **second hook version** for each post as an A/B test (two hooks for the same video), and add a short **carousel caption** that turns the video's 3 reasons into 3 slides; explain which hook you expect to perform better and why.

Timing guidance. The priority is **learners writing their own captions** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten Section J to a 3-minute mention and limit the platform-adaptation demo (G.5). Protect writing time â€" a learner who leaves without a written caption has no copy deliverable.

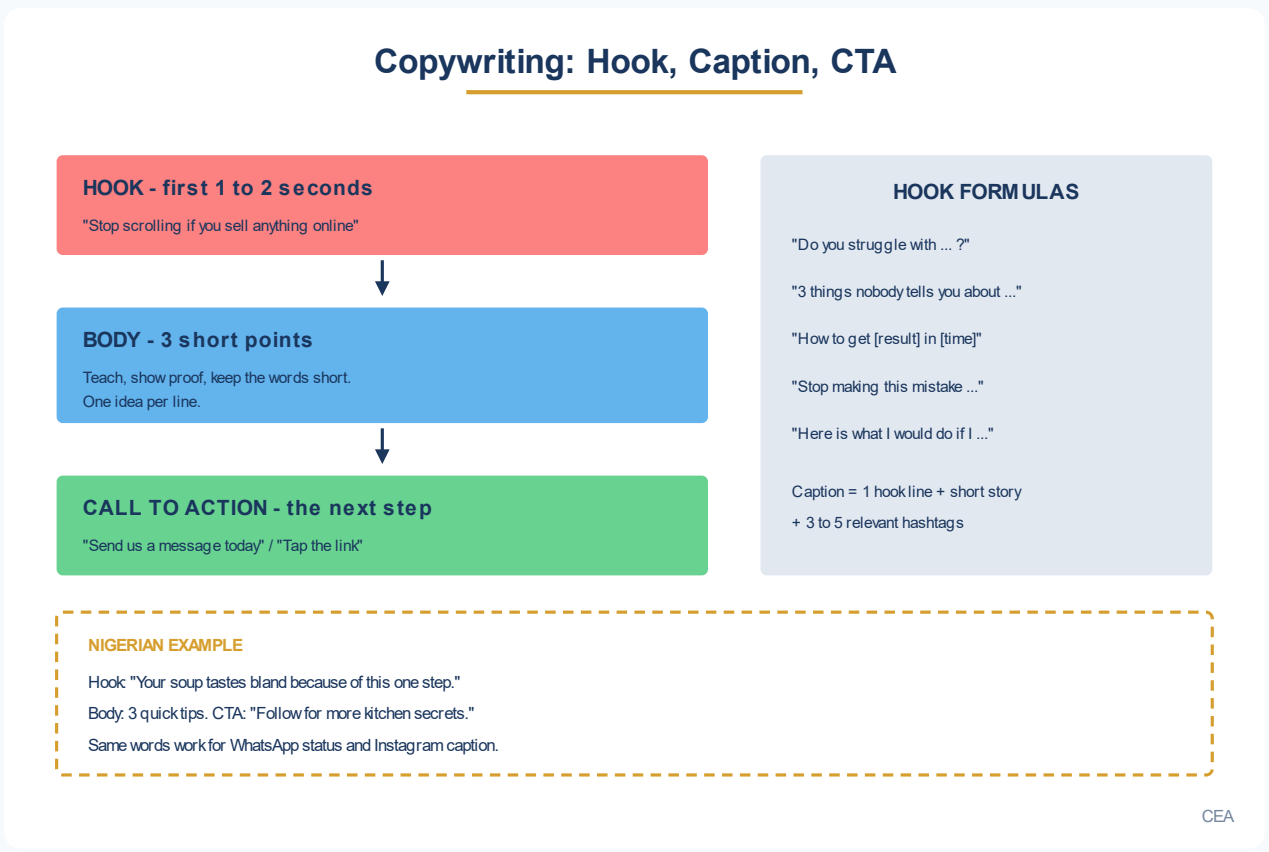
END OF SESSION 6

Next: Session 7 â€" One-Week Content Calendar, Batch Workflow and Brand Consistency.

SESSION 07 OF 9

Calendar Branding

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 07



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 7 â€" ONE-WEEK CALENDAR AND BRANDING CONSISTENCY

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	7 of 9
Session title	One-Week Calendar and Branding Consistency
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Publish, Measure and Package
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (planning and design, not advanced software)
Prerequisite knowledge	Everything from Sessions 1â€"6: niche, avatar, pillars and hooks (S1); stable, well-lit shooting (S2); clear audio and a simple script (S3); a first CapCut cut (S4); B-roll, music and a Canva

Item	Detail
	thumbnail (S5); hooks, captions, CTAs and hashtags (S6). A free Canva account must exist.
Connection to previous session	In Session 6 you wrote the *words* for one video. But one good post is not a business. Posting "whenever you feel like it" is exactly why most small pages stay invisible. Today you turn your single video and copy into a **planned week**: a one-week content calendar, a simple **batch workflow**, and a locked-in **brand look** (colours, fonts, logo placement, tone) so every post looks and sounds like one professional business.
Preparation before class	Print the **blank one-week calendar** (Worksheet 7.1) and the **brand-kit worksheet** (Worksheet 7.2), one set per learner. Have the Adaeze Fashion example week on the projector and the Adaeze Canva brand colours on the board. Open Canva with a simple post and a 1280 Ã— 720 thumbnail ready. Confirm every learner has their Session 6 video, thumbnail and captions. Whiteboard and markers ready; Wi-Fi on for Canva.
Assessment link	This session delivers **LO9** (plan and publish consistently). It is assessed through the Session 7 practical, **Assignment 7** (build a one-week calendar), and the capstone â€" specifically **Criterion 8 "One-week content calendar" (2 marks)** and **Criterion 7 "Graphics â€" 2 posts + 1 thumbnail" (5 marks)**. **Checkpoint (end of S7):** every learner must have a **working calendar draft, Video 1 finished and one thumbnail**.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why a planned content calendar beats random posting, in their own words.
2. **Build a realistic one-week content calendar** with all seven columns filled: date, platform, format, pillar, hook, caption and status.
3. **Choose a varied content-pillar mix** for the week (educate / promote / entertain / proof), avoiding an all-promo page, and include **at least one lighter or rest day**.
4. **Explain and apply a batch workflow** â€" shooting several clips in one session, editing in another, writing captions in another â€" and say why it saves time.
5. **Define a simple brand look** â€" one primary colour and one secondary colour (with hex codes), one or two fonts, a logo placement rule, and a tone of voice.
6. **Assemble a brand kit** in a simple, free way (a saved Canva design, or a written brand sheet with hex codes) without a paid subscription.
7. **Check posts for consistency** using a short checklist, and correct off-brand colours, fonts, logo placement or tone.
8. **Plan a week that is realistic for one person** who has a job or business, rather than an impossible "three posts a day" schedule.
9. **Produce a one-week content calendar and a brand kit** for their chosen business, ready to feed the capstone.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (to type the calendar, write captions, and open Canva). Learners who prefer to work on paper may use the printed worksheets.
- One computer or a phone with a browser for Canva.
- Instructor device connected to the projector with screen mirroring.
- Whiteboard and markers.

Software

- **Canva** (free tier) â€" for the brand kit and for checking that posts reuse the same colours and fonts. A saved Canva design can serve as a free "brand kit".
- A notes app, **Google Docs**, **Word**, or a spreadsheet for the calendar (a printed calendar is fine).

- **CapCut** (free) â€" only to confirm Video 1 is finished; no new editing is required today.

Sample files / examples

- The **Adaeze Fashion example week** (a completed calendar) on the projector.
- Two example **brand sheets**: one strong (consistent colours, fonts, logo rule, tone) and one weak (different colour and font on every post) for the opening activity.
- The **Session 5 thumbnail** and the Adaeze brand colours for the consistency check.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 7.1 â€" "My One-Week Content Calendar" (the seven-column table, printed, 1 page).
- Worksheet 7.2 â€" "My Brand Kit" (primary colour + hex, secondary colour + hex, heading font, body font, logo placement, tone-of-voice note).
- Worksheet 7.3 â€" "Batch Plan and Consistency Checker" (batch days + the six-point brand check).

Accounts

- Free Canva account (already created in Session 5). No paid subscription is needed â€" the free plan is enough, which is why the brand-kit worksheet exists.

Internet

- Needed for Canva; the calendar and brand sheet can be done on paper if the internet fails.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A learner who cannot use Canva can complete today's work on paper: draw the calendar, write the hex codes, name the fonts, and write the logo-placement and tone rules. The **planning and consistency thinking** is the skill, not the software.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show **two small business Instagram grids** side by side (printed screenshots or prepared mock grids).

- **Grid A ("Uche's Boutique"):** every post is a pink sale flyer â€" same pink, same font, every day â€" but all of them say "BUY NOW".
- **Grid B ("Tega's Boutique"):** the posts look like they belong to different businesses â€" red font on white today, blue on green tomorrow, a different logo size in each. The content itself is good.

Ask for a show of hands: "Which page looks more professional?" Most pick Grid A (the consistent one). Then say:

> *"Grid A looks tidy â€" but every post is shouting 'BUY!', so it tires fast. Grid B has variety but looks like five different shops on one page. The perfect page is the **middle path**: one clear look on every post and a mix of content that is not all selling. Today you build both â€" a **one-week plan** that varies your content, and a **brand look** that stays the same."*

Expected learner response: Learners will point out the mismatched colours and fonts in Grid B and the repetition in Grid A. Accept all answers and draw out the two ideas: **consistency** (look the same) and **variety** (say different things).

Then reveal the hook. Ask, "How many posts would you need to keep this up for one week?" Then show Adaeze's completed week and say:

> *"Seven posts. Not thirty. Not zero. A real plan, made in one sitting. By the end of today, each of you will have a week like this â€" and a brand kit so your whole page looks like one business, not seven."*

Why this opener works: It creates the exact tension of the session â€" consistency versus variety â€" before any explanation, and shows the finished deliverable immediately, so learners know what they are building.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the three parts of your Session 3 script, and what does each do?"

- Expected answer: **Hook (stops attention), Value (gives the reason/benefit), CTA (tells the viewer what to do)**. The calendar schedules these same parts across the week; the structure does not change, it is just planned ahead.

Question 2: "Name three parts of a strong caption, and say how many hashtags a beginner should use."

- Expected answer: **hook line, value, CTA** (plus hashtags); **3â€“10 relevant hashtags**, not 30. Today's calendar will hold these captions, so they must already be right.

Question 3: "You made one finished video and one thumbnail. Is that enough to grow a page?"

- Expected answer: No. One post is not a plan; reach grows from **showing up regularly and consistently**, not from one perfect post.

Question 4: "What are the four content pillars, and give one example of each for Adaeze Fashion."

- Expected answer: **educate** (a care tip), **promote** (a new-arrival offer), **entertain** (a light skit), **proof** (a customer testimonial). Forgetting that not every post should sell is exactly the mistake today's pillar mix fixes.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Your video is the meal, your caption is the salesman, your thumbnail is the signboard. But a restaurant that opens only when the cook feels like it still starves. Today you become the **restaurant manager**: you plan the menu for the whole week, decide which days to serve what, and make sure every plate comes out looking like it came from the same kitchen. That is a calendar and a brand."*

If more than a third of the class cannot name the four pillars, spend 4 extra minutes listing them on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why a calendar beats random posting

The idea. A **content calendar** is a simple plan that shows **what you will post, on which day, in what format, about what, with which hook and caption, and whether it is done yet**. It turns "posting" from a daily panic into a settled decision made once a week.

Plain-English definition. A calendar is your **posting timetable**. Instead of waking up each morning asking "what do I post today?", you open your plan and execute. The thinking is already finished.

Why it exists. Random posting fails for three predictable reasons:

1. **Inconsistency.** You post three days in a row, then disappear for two weeks. The audience never learns to expect you, so they stop looking.
2. **Decision fatigue.** Making a fresh decision every day is tiring, so you either skip posting or post low-effort content.
3. **Imbalance.** Without a plan, you post whatever mood you are in â€” usually all sales posts, which wear the audience out.

A calendar removes all three problems at once. The plan decides; you simply do.

What a calendar does for a small business:

- **Keeps you consistent** â€” you post on set days, not on mood.
- **Balances your content** â€” you can see, at a glance, that you are not selling every day.
- **Saves mental energy** â€” one planning sitting replaces a week of daily stress.
- **Lets you batch** â€” because you know the whole week, you can shoot, edit and write in blocks (see F.4).
- **Shows progress** â€” the "status" column lets you see what is done, edited, shot or still an idea.

Worked example. Two Port Harcourt tailors with the same skill: Tailor A posts by ear â€” five days, then ten days' silence, almost all "come and sew" adverts, and his follower count barely moves. Tailor B posts every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, teaches, shows work, promotes and shares customer proof, and grows steadily. Same tailoring skill. The difference is the **plan**.

Common misconception. "Planning makes me rigid and boring." The opposite is true. Once the week is planned, you are free to be spontaneous *on top of it* â€" a plan is a floor, not a ceiling.

Limitation. A calendar is only useful if it is **realistic**. A beautiful plan that you cannot execute is worse than no plan, because it teaches you that planning fails. Section F.7 fixes this.

F.2 The seven columns of a one-week calendar

The idea. Every row in your calendar is one post. Every column answers one question about that post. Fill all seven columns and you never face a blank screen again.

The CEA one-week calendar columns:

Column	What it answers	Example (Adaeze Fashion, Monday)
1. Date	When will it go out?	Monday
2. Platform	Where does it go?	Instagram Reel
3. Format	What kind of post is it?	40-second video
4. Pillar	Which content theme is it?	Educate
5. Hook	What is the first line / first idea?	"How to care for your Ankara"
6. Caption	The short caption idea (full copy lives in the captions document)	Cold water, inside out, dry in shade â€" DM 'ANKARA' for the guide
7. Status	How far along is it?	Posted / Edited / Shot / Draft / Idea

Why all seven columns matter. An empty column is a hole you will fall into later. If "Format" is empty, you will not know whether you need to shoot or just design a graphic. If "Status" is empty, you will not know what is actually done. A calendar with empty columns is not a plan; it is a wish.

The status words (use these exactly so the team is aligned):

- **Idea** â€" a thought, nothing made yet.
- **Draft** â€" the caption or design is started.
- **Shot** â€" the footage or photo exists.
- **Edited** â€" the video/graphic is finished but not out.
- **Posted** â€" it is live.

Platform and format choices. You do not need to be everywhere â€" choose **one or two** platforms you can maintain. Formats at this level are just four: **video** (Reel/TikTok/Short, 30â€"60s, vertical), **graphic** (a Canva post), **carousel** (several images people swipe), and **text + still** (for WhatsApp Status).

Worked example â€" the shape of a strong week (Adaeze Fashion):

Date	Platform	Format	Pillar	Hook	Caption (short)	Status
Mon	Instagram Reel	40s video	Educate	"How to care for Ankara"	Cold water, inside out, dry in shade	Posted
Tue	TikTok	40s video	Promote	"The Ankara shop PH talks about"	New arrivals + price range, DM ORDER	Edited
Wed	Instagram Post	Graphic	Proof	"Customer love"	Real review + thank you	Shot
Thu	Instagram Reel	30s video	Entertain	"When the customer saysâ€¦"	Fun skit + follow CTA	Draft
Fri	TikTok + Shorts	45s video	Promote	"Weekend special"	Discount this weekend, DM ORDER	Draft
Sat	Instagram Post	Graphic	Proof	"She almost did not buy this"	Transformation + testimonial	Idea

Date	Platform	Format	Pillar	Hook	Caption (short)	Status
Sun	WhatsApp Status	Text + still	Rest	"Behind the scenes"	Light post, shop closed	Idea

Notice: seven days, four pillars, only two promo days, one light rest day, and every column filled.

Common misconception. "I must post every single day or the platform punishes me." No platform punishes a missed day. What hurts you is **disappearing**. A realistic, consistent rhythm (even three to four posts a week) beats a burst of seven followed by silence. Consistency over intensity. The calendar is a **plan, not a contract**: if a customer request or a festival appears, you may swap a row.

F.3 The content-pillar mix â€" variety that still sells

The idea. Your **content pillars** are the two to four themes you rotate. The **pillar mix** is the balance of those themes across the week. A good mix teaches, promotes, entertains and proves â€" it does not only sell.

Why the mix matters. Imagine walking into a shop where the shopkeeper shouts "BUY! BUY! BUY!" the moment you enter, every time. You would leave. An all-promo page does the same to followers: they feel used and unfollow. Content that **gives** (teaches, entertains, proves) earns the right to **ask** (promote).

The four beginner pillar types (the CEA set):

Pillar	Job	Adaeze Fashion example	Roughly how often
Educate	Teach something useful; build authority	"How to stop your Ankara fading"	1â€"2 per week
Promote	Show products, prices, offers; ask for the sale	"New arrivals: â‚¦8,000â€"â‚¦15,000, DM 'ORDER'"	1â€"2 per week
Entertain	Light, human, funny content that builds warmth	"Types of customers at a boutique ðŸ˜,"	1 per week
Proof	Real customers, reviews, before/after, behind-the-scenes	"She came for one dress and left with three"	1â€"2 per week

The rule of thumb for beginners: for every **one promote** post, aim for at least **one or two posts that give value** (educate, entertain or proof). A common healthy ratio is **1 promote : 3 value**. This keeps the page warm enough that the promo posts actually land.

Common misconception. "If I do not sell every day, I waste a post." No â€" a post that teaches or entertains keeps followers interested enough to see the posts that *do* sell. Value posts are not wasted; they are the reason the promo posts work.

Limitation. Pillars should not be so rigid that you miss a golden moment (a viral trend, a festival). Pillars guide the balance; they do not forbid an opportunistic post.

F.4 The batch workflow â€" how to make a week without burning out

The idea. A **batch workflow** means you group similar tasks together instead of doing a little of each every day. Instead of shooting, editing and writing captions all in one exhausting day, you **shoot on one day, edit on another, and write captions on another**.

Why it exists. Switching between different kinds of work is slow. Every time you change task â€" from shooting to editing to writing â€" your brain has to "warm up" again. Batching removes those warm-ups and the constant switching, so the same amount of work takes far less time.

Why one shoot day works so well. Setting up light, a tripod and a clean background is most of the effort. If you set up once and shoot five clips, you pay that setup cost once instead of five times. The same clothes, the same light, the same background also make the videos look **consistent** â€" which feeds straight into branding (F.5).

A worked Adaeze batch plan:

Day	Batch task	Time	Output
Sunday evening	Plan the week	45 min	Calendar with all seven rows filled
Monday evening	Shoot	60 min	4 video clips + 6 photos for the week
Tuesday evening	Edit	90 min	3â€“4 finished videos (captions, B-roll, music)
Wednesday evening	Write	45 min	All captions for the week
Thursday evening	Design	60 min	2 posts + 1 thumbnail in Canva
Then	Publish	a few min/day	Post on the set days

That is about **5 hours spread across a week** â€” realistic for someone with a job, and far better than a panic on each posting day.

Common misconception. "Batching means I must spend one whole day on content." No â€” you can batch across **evenings**, as the example shows; the point is grouping, not a marathon. Not every business can shoot a week ahead (a restaurant's "today's special" changes daily): batch everything that *can* be pre-made, and leave only the daily item to a quick phone shot.

F.5 Branding consistency â€” the brand kit

The idea. Your **brand** is how your business looks, sounds and feels everywhere â€” the same colours, the same fonts, the same logo position, and the same tone of voice. A **brand kit** is a short list of these decisions, written down so you reuse them every time.

Why branding exists. People recognise things by their look long before they read a word. You recognise a Coca-Cola bottle, an MTN yellow, a particular shop's signboard. If every one of your posts uses different colours and fonts, no one ever learns to recognise you â€” you look like a different business each day. Consistency builds recognition; recognition builds trust; trust builds customers.

The key parts of a beginner brand kit:

1. **Primary colour** â€” the main colour of your brand (with its **hex code**, e.g., `#7B1E3A`, a deep burgundy). This is the colour people will learn to associate with you.
2. **Secondary colour** â€” a supporting colour (e.g., cream `#F5EFE0`) used for backgrounds or text, so the primary does not overwhelm.
3. **An accent colour (optional)** â€” a small pop of colour for buttons or highlights (e.g., gold `#D4A017`).
4. **Heading font** â€” the font for big words and titles (e.g., *Playfair Display*, a font available free in Canva).
5. **Body font** â€” the font for smaller text (e.g., *Montserrat*, also free in Canva). Beginners should use **one or two fonts only**.
6. **Logo placement** â€” one rule for where your logo or business name always sits (e.g., "bottom-centre on every post, top-left on stories").
7. **Tone of voice** â€” a short note on how you speak (e.g., "warm, encouraging, honest, simple English; speaks to young working women as 'you'; never exaggerates").

Hex codes in plain English. A **hex code** is a six-character label for an exact colour (`#7B1E3A`). Using the exact code â€” instead of "that reddish colour" â€” guarantees the colour is **identical** on every post, on every device. You can find a colour's hex code in Canva by clicking the colour swatch.

Worked example â€” the Adaeze Fashion brand kit:

Element	Decision
Primary colour	Deep burgundy â€” `#7B1E3A`
Secondary colour	Cream â€” `#F5EFE0`
Accent colour	Gold â€” `#D4A017` (small highlights only)
Heading font	Playfair Display (elegant serif â€” matches a fashion brand)
Body font	Montserrat (clean and readable)

Element	Decision
Logo placement	Business name bottom-centre on every feed post; top-left on stories
Tone of voice	Warm, honest, encouraging; simple English; never overpromise

Now every Adaeze post â€" a Reel caption, a Canva graphic, a WhatsApp Status â€" uses burgundy and cream, Playfair Display for headings and Montserrat for text, and the same friendly tone. The page looks like **one business**. A brand kit is like a **school uniform**: the same colours and badge, so anyone can tell in a crowd which school (or business) someone belongs to.

How to keep a free brand kit (no paid subscription). Canva's saved "Brand Kit" is a **paid Pro** feature. On the free plan you stay consistent by writing your hex codes and font names on **Worksheet 7.2** and reusing them, or by keeping **one saved Canva design** and duplicating it for every new post.

Common misconception. "A brand needs a fancy logo and a designer." No â€" for a beginner, a **consistent name in a consistent colour and font** is already a brand. Branding is consistency, not sameness: every post can be about something different and still be on-brand.

F.6 Checking posts for consistency

The idea. Before you post, you run a **consistency check**: a quick scan to confirm that this post looks and sounds like the rest of your page.

Why it matters. Consistency is easy in a plan and easy to break at the moment of posting, especially under time pressure. A 30-second check before each post protects the whole page.

The six-point brand consistency check (Worksheet 7.3):

1. **Colours** â€" Are the colours exactly my brand colours (same hex codes)?
2. **Fonts** â€" Did I use only my chosen heading and body fonts?
3. **Logo** â€" Is my logo/business name in the same place as always?
4. **Tone** â€" Does the caption sound like me (same warmth, same honesty, same simple English)?
5. **Readability** â€" Is the text big, short and readable at small size?
6. **Honesty** â€" Do the words and image match the actual video/product?

If all six are "yes", the post is on-brand.

Common misconception. "Consistency means every post must look identical." No â€" the *system* is identical (colours, fonts, logo, tone); the *content* varies. Same uniform, different students. Consistency is a habit, not a one-time fix: it only holds if you run the check **every time**.

F.7 Realistic planning for one person with a real job

The idea. A plan that ignores your real life will fail. **Realistic planning** means building a week you can actually complete as **one person** â€" with a job, a family and limited time.

Why it exists. The biggest reason small businesses stop posting is not laziness â€" it is that they planned something impossible. "Three posts a day, every day" is a plan for a team of six, not for one tailor with a shop to run. When the plan collapses, the owner blames themselves and gives up.

How to plan realistically:

- **Start smaller than you think.** If you are new, plan **3 posts a week** (e.g., Monday, Wednesday, Friday), not 15.
- **Choose platforms you can maintain.** One or two â€" not four. Every extra platform doubles the work.
- **Use a batch plan** (F.4) so the week fits into a few evenings.
- **Include a lighter or rest day** â€" one easy Status post, or a genuine day off.
- **Reuse what you have** and match the plan to your free time (if evenings are yours, batch in the evenings).

Worked example â€" the wrong plan vs the right plan.

	Unrealistic plan	Realistic plan
Posts per week	21 (three a day)	4â€"5 across the week

	Unrealistic plan	Realistic plan
Platforms	Instagram + TikTok + YouTube + Facebook daily	Instagram + WhatsApp Status
Batch	None; shot daily	One shoot evening, one edit evening
Rest	None	Sunday (a light Status post only)
Result	Burnout in two weeks	Keeps going for months

Common misconception. "More posts always means faster growth." Volume without quality or consistency does not help; a smaller, steady, well-made week grows a page far better than a frantic burst that stops. **Content is a marathon, not a sprint.**

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- The projector showing **Worksheet 7.1** (blank calendar) and **Worksheet 7.2** (blank brand kit).
- The Adaeze Fashion details on the board: niche "affordable ready-to-wear for young working women in Port Harcourt", avatar Blessing, pillars (educate/promote/entertain/proof).
- A spreadsheet or a table on screen for the live calendar.
- Canva open, logged in, on the free plan, ready to show a brand-coloured post.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" build the Adaeze one-week calendar live (8 minutes)

Say: "Watch me fill a whole week in one sitting. I will think out loud so you can copy the thinking, not just the result."

Step by step, on the projector:

1. **Choose the rhythm.** "It is a launch week, so I will post once most days and keep Sunday light."
2. **Set the platform mix.** "Instagram and TikTok for videos, Instagram for graphics, WhatsApp Status for the light day."
3. **Rotate the pillars.** "I will not put promote on more than two days: Mon educate, Tue promote, Wed proof, Thu entertain, Fri promote, Sat proof, Sun rest."
4. **Write the hooks** (spoken lines, from Session 6).
5. **Sketch the captions** (short; the full copy lives in the captions document).
6. **Mark the status honestly** â€" most are drafts or ideas at planning time.

Fill the table row by row. Expected finished result:

Date	Platform	Format	Pillar	Hook	Caption (short)	Status
Mon	Instagram Reel	40s video	Educate	"How to care for Ankara"	Cold water, inside out, dry in shade	Posted
Tue	TikTok	40s video	Promote	"The Ankara shop PH talks about"	New arrivals + price range, DM ORDER	Edited
Wed	Instagram Post	Graphic	Proof	"Customer love"	Real review + thank you	Shot
Thu	Instagram Reel	30s video	Entertain	"When the customer saysâ€¦"	Fun skit + follow CTA	Draft
Fri	TikTok + Shorts	45s video	Promote	"Weekend special"	Discount this weekend, DM ORDER	Draft
Sat	Instagram Post	Graphic	Proof	"She almost did not buy this"	Transformation + testimonial	Idea
Sun	WhatsApp Status	Text + still	Rest	"Behind the scenes"	Light post, shop closed	Idea

Point out while filling: "Count the pillars â€" educate 1, promote 2, entertain 1, proof 2, rest 1: only two promo days. Every column is filled, no holes. And Sunday is light â€" nobody runs at full speed seven days." **Ask:** "If I swapped Wednesday and Thursday, would the week break?" (No â€" the plan is flexible.)

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" assemble the Adaeze brand kit (5 minutes)

Say: "Now the uniform. I will write down six decisions and then prove they hold across two posts."

On the board, fill Worksheet 7.2 live:

Element	Decision
Primary colour	Deep burgundy `#7B1E3A`
Secondary colour	Cream `#F5EFE0`
Accent colour	Gold `#D4A017` (small touches)
Heading font	Playfair Display (elegant serif â€" fits fashion)
Body font	Montserrat (clean, readable)
Logo placement	Name bottom-centre on feed posts; top-left on stories
Tone of voice	Warm, honest, encouraging, simple English; never overpromises

Then open Canva and prove it:

1. Show the **Session 5 thumbnail** (burgundy block, cream text, Playfair Display heading, Adaeze name in a corner).
2. Open a **new post**; set the background to `#7B1E3A`, text to `#F5EFE0`, heading in Playfair Display, body in Montserrat, name bottom-centre. Put it beside the thumbnail. **Say:** "Same colours, same fonts, same logo position. Two different posts, one clear business."
3. **Deliberately break it:** change the new post to bright green with a comic font. Ask, "Does this belong to Adaeze?" (No.) "That is what a missing brand kit does to a page."

Expected finished result: a completed brand kit with hex codes and fonts, and two Canva designs that visibly match.

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" the batch plan (2 minutes)

Say: "This week is not a week of work if I batch it." Show the Adaeze batch plan â€" Sun evening: plan (45 min); Mon evening: shoot all clips (60 min); Tue evening: edit all videos (90 min); Wed evening: write all captions (45 min); Thu evening: design all graphics (60 min); then post on the set days. **Ask:** "How long would this take one post at a time, with setup each time?" (Much longer.) "So which plan will a busy person actually finish?"

G.5 Questions to ask during the demo

- "How many promote days did I use, and why not seven?" (Two â€" an all-promo page wears people out.)
- "What is the difference between the pillar and the hook in a row?" (Pillar = the *theme*; hook = the *first line*.)
- "Why does the status column matter?" (It shows what is actually done, so nothing is forgotten.)
- "Why write down hex codes instead of colour names?" (An exact code gives the identical colour every time, on every device.)
- "Which two things make a page look like one business?" (A consistent brand look, and a planned, balanced mix.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner produces their **own one-week content calendar** (all seven columns) and a **one-page brand kit** for a business of their choice, using the free tools available.

Starting materials: Worksheet 7.1 ("My One-Week Content Calendar"), Worksheet 7.2 ("My Brand Kit"), Worksheet 7.3 ("Batch Plan and Consistency Checker"); a phone/notes app or the printed sheets; Canva for the brand colours (optional at this step).

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. **Name your business.** Write the business or personal brand you will plan for. It may be your own, a family business, a church, or Adaeze Fashion. (Example: *"Chisom's Salon, Port Harcourt."*)
2. **Restate the plan basics.** Write your niche, your avatar's biggest worry, and your three or four pillars (from Sessions 1 and 6).
3. **Choose your rhythm.** Decide how many posts you will make this week â€" **recommend 4 to 7 for the capstone**, but for your own business pick a number you can honestly keep. Write it at the top of the calendar.
4. **Pick your platforms.** Choose **one or two** you can maintain (e.g., Instagram + WhatsApp Status). Write them in the "Platform" column as you go.
5. **Fill the seven columns** for each day: date, platform, format, pillar, hook, caption idea, status. **Pause and predict:** "Is any day all-promo? Do I have at least one educate, one proof, and one lighter/rest day?"
6. **Balance the pillars.** Check your mix. If more than two days are "promote", change some to educate, entertain or proof.
7. **Verify every column is filled.** No empty cells.
8. **Build the brand kit** on Worksheet 7.2: primary colour + hex, secondary colour + hex, accent (optional), heading font, body font, logo placement rule, tone-of-voice note. Use Canva's colour picker to get a real hex code if you can.
9. **Run the consistency check** on Worksheet 7.3 against your existing Session 5 thumbnail: does it use your brand colours and fonts? Note any change you would make.
10. **Write the batch plan.** List which evening(s) you will plan, shoot, edit, write and design. **Pause and predict:** "Can I really do this in these evenings? If not, which single item do I move?"
11. Save everything and keep it â€" this becomes part of your capstone planning folder.

Expected result: a completed Worksheet 7.1 (seven days, all columns, varied pillars, a rest day) plus Worksheet 7.2 (a full brand kit) and a batch plan.

Pause and predict: after step 5 â€" "If a stranger read only your 'Pillar' column, what kind of page would they think you are?" After step 8 â€" "Could you hand your brand kit to another creator and let them post for you? If not, what is still unclear?"

Scanning/observation checklist (instructor uses while walking the room):

- ☐ Every row has all seven columns filled
- ☐ At least three different pillars appear across the week
- ☐ No more than about two "promote" days
- ☐ At least one lighter/rest day
- ☐ Platform count is realistic (one or two main platforms)
- ☐ Brand kit has real colour hex codes and named fonts
- ☐ A logo-placement rule and a tone note are written
- ☐ Batch plan names specific days/times

Success criteria:

- The week is **complete** (all columns) and **balanced** (varied pillars).
- The rhythm is **realistic for one person** and includes a rest/lighter day.
- The brand kit is **specific** (hex codes, font names, one logo rule, a tone line).
- The batch plan is **concrete** (which day, which task).

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- All-promo calendar â†' force one educate, one entertain and one proof row.
- Empty "Caption" or "Status" cells â†' fill them; a blank cell is a plan you cannot execute.
- "Three posts a day" â†' ask, "Who is doing the other 20 posts?" and cut to a realistic number.
- No brand colours â†' open Canva, pick a swatch, read the hex code, and write it down.
- Three or four fonts â†' cut to one heading and one body font.
- No batch plan â†' ask which single evening is most free and start there.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Seven days planned with all seven columns filled
- ☐ Pillars varied; at most two promote days
- ☐ One lighter or rest day included
- ☐ Brand kit complete (colours + hex, fonts, logo rule, tone)
- ☐ Consistency check run against an existing post

- [ ] Batch plan written with specific days

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (new task, done alone): Build a **complete one-week calendar** and a **brand kit** for a business brief you have not used before, without copying the instructor's Adaeze week.

Scenario. *Grandma Zainab's Bakery*, Port Harcourt, makes **fresh bread, meat pies and small chops**. It sells from a small shop on Ada George Road and also takes orders for parties and church events (birthday cakes on request). The owner, Zainab, is a busy widow who bakes from 5 a.m. to 6 p.m. and **posts only when she remembers**. Her goal is **more party and church-event orders**, and she admires pages that look "clean and welcoming". She can commit to posting **five times a week** and has only a phone. Her two best-selling ideas are **freshness** (baked that morning) and **affordable party trays**.

Requirements:

1. Build a **one-week calendar** (Monâ€“Sun) with all **seven columns**: date, platform, format, pillar, hook, caption idea, status.
2. Use **at least three different pillars**; include **at least one educate, one proof and one promote**. No more than **two promote days**.
3. Include **one lighter/rest day** (for Zainab, a light WhatsApp Status post).
4. Choose **one or two realistic platforms** only (a busy one-person business).
5. Write a **brand kit**: primary colour + hex, secondary colour + hex, heading font, body font, logo placement rule, and a **tone-of-voice** note that fits a warm neighbourhood bakery.
6. Add a **one-line batch plan** saying which day(s) she plans, shoots, bakes-and-photographs, edits and writes.
7. State in one line **why** your pillar mix is balanced.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: For a bakery, **educate** = "How to keep bread soft for 3 days"; **proof** = "A church ordered 200 meat pies â€” look at the smiles"; **promote** = "Party trays from â¦X".
- Hint 2: For brand colours, think warm and welcoming: bread brown or soft yellow as primary, cream as secondary. Pick the exact hex in Canva.
- Hint 3: For tone, write: "Warm, homey, honest â€” like a neighbour who bakes for your family; simple English; never exaggerates."

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€” do not show learners):

Model one-week calendar (Grandma Zainab's Bakery):

Date	Platform	Format	Pillar	Hook	Caption (short)	Status
Mon	Instagram Post	Graphic	Promote	"Fresh from the oven"	Today's bread + meat pies, price + call	Posted
Tue	TikTok	35s video	Educate	"How to keep bread fresh for 3 days"	3 simple tips + follow	Edited
Wed	Instagram Post	Graphic	Proof	"A church ordered 200 meat pies"	Photo of trays + thank you	Shot
Thu	Instagram Reel	40s video	Entertain	"When the aroma hits you at the door ðŸ˜„"	Light, funny clip + follow CTA	Draft
Fri	Instagram + WhatsApp	Graphic	Promote	"Party trays for your weekend event"	Sizes + prices, DM 'PARTY'	Draft
Sat	Instagram Reel	40s video	Proof	"Why our bread sells out by 10am"	Behind-the-scenes of the 5am bake	Idea
Sun	WhatsApp Status	Text + still	Rest	"Thank you, Port Harcourt"	Light thank-you; shop hours	Idea

Pillars used: promote 2, educate 1, proof 2, entertain 1, rest 1 â†' **balanced** (only two promote days; value and proof fill the rest).

Model brand kit: primary warm bread brown `#8B5E34`; secondary soft cream `#FFF3E0`; accent warm gold `#E0A800`; heading Playfair Display; body Montserrat; logo bottom-centre on feed posts, top-left on stories; tone warm, homey and honest â€" simple English, never exaggerates.

Model batch plan: Sunday evening â€" plan + write captions; Monday evening â€" photograph and film all shots; Tuesday evening â€" edit videos; Wednesday evening â€" design graphics; then post on the set days.

Why the mix is balanced: only two of seven days ask for a sale; the other days teach, entertain and prove, which earns the right to promote.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- All seven days, all seven columns (2)
- Varied pillars; â‰¤2 promote; one rest day (2)
- Realistic platforms for one person (1)
- Brand kit complete with hex codes + fonts (2)
- Logo placement rule and tone note (1)
- Batch plan present (1)
- Balance justified and honest (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Obi* runs a small barbershop in Port Harcourt. He cuts well and his shop is neat, but for two years he posted "whenever he remembered". His page was a jumble â€" a red poster one day, blue the next, sometimes a random photo with no logo, sometimes "Back soon, come and cut". He had about 150 followers and almost no bookings from the page; all his customers came by word of mouth. His neighbour *Jide* posts **every Monday, Wednesday and Friday**, always with the same look â€" navy background, white bold text, shop name always at the bottom â€" and a varied plan: one before/after cut, one tip, one happy-customer post each week. Jide grew to 1,200 local followers in a year and now gets bookings almost every day from people who found him online.

Relevant facts.

- Obi and Jide have **similar cutting skill**, similar prices, and neither pays for ads.
- Obi posted more often on some weeks than Jide â€" but **irregularly**, and every post looked different.
- Obi's content was **almost all selling** ("come and cut"); Jide's was **balanced** (proof, tip, and a gentle promo).
- Jide did his week in **one batch** each Sunday evening; Obi did each post separately and often gave up.

Decision point. What should Obi change â€" his barbering, his camera, his posting plan, or his brand look?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy a better phone and a light, hoping better pictures fix the problem.
2. Copy Jide's exact colours and captions word for word.
3. Build his **own** realistic three-day-a-week calendar with a **balanced pillar mix**, and lock down **his own** simple brand kit (one colour, one font, one logo position, one tone) â€" then batch the work on one evening a week.

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 3. Obi's barbering and prices are already fine; his camera is adequate. The real problems are **inconsistency**, an **all-promo page**, and **no recognisable look**. A simple, balanced plan plus a consistent brand fixes all three for free.

Reasoning / example plan for Obi.

- **Brand kit:** primary black `#111111`, secondary white `#FFFFFF`, one bold heading font, shop name always bottom-centre, tone "sharp, friendly, confidence-building".
- **Weekly calendar (3 posts):** Monday â€" proof (before/after cut); Wednesday â€" educate ("How to describe the cut you want"); Friday â€" promote ("Fresh cut for the weekend, â¦X").
- **Batch plan:** shoot and edit all three on Sunday evening; write captions in the same sitting.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 costs money and time but does not fix inconsistency â€” a better camera on a mismatched page still looks scattered.
- Approach 2 is dishonest copying and will not fit Obi's shop or voice.
- Approach 3 is free, quick to start, and directly fixes the three real problems. It also repeats forever with almost no new effort.

Professional connection. Social media managers are paid **specifically** to build calendars and brand kits for businesses like Obi's. Planning a balanced, consistent week is one of the most hireable skills in this course â€” exactly what the capstone's calendar and graphics criteria measure.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the relevant row rather than giving the answer.| Mistake | Why it happens | The fix | |---|---|---| | **All-promo calendar** (every day says "buy") | Belief that every post must sell | Keep at most two promote days; add educate, entertain and proof rows (about 1 promote : 3 value) | | **Unrealistic plan** (three posts a day) | Planning with excitement, not honesty about time | Cut to 3â€“5 posts a week; name the evenings you will actually work | | **Inconsistent colours and fonts** | Each post designed from scratch, with no brand kit | Fill the brand-kit worksheet; fix the hex codes and two fonts and reuse them | | **No batch plan** | Thinking each post needs its own day | Group tasks â€” one shoot day, one edit day, one writing day, one design day | | **Empty columns in the calendar** | Rushed planning; some columns seen as optional | Fill every cell â€” even a rough caption idea and a status word | | **Copying another business's brand** | Liking a popular page and cloning it | Build an original look that fits your own business and audience | | **No rest or lighter day** | Equating rest with laziness | Build in one lighter day (a Status text or throwback) first, then fill around it | | **Brand colours not written down** | Relying on memory or a colour name ("that red") | Read the hex code from Canva's colour picker and write it on the brand sheet |

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: Check before fixing â€” count the promo days, scan for empty cells, lay two posts side by side, ask for the hex code. Confirm the cause, then correct.---

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Assignment 7 â€” My One-Week Content Calendar and Brand Kit"

Purpose: To plan a realistic, balanced one-week content calendar and define a simple brand look, so the learner can post consistently and on-brand â€” producing the calendar and branding components of the capstone's Week 3 brand package.

Realistic scenario. Adaeze Fashion (or the learner's own chosen business) is opening for a launch week. As the content planner, you must deliver a **one-week posting calendar** that the owner can actually keep, plus a **brand kit** so every post looks like the same business.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose your business (Adaeze Fashion or your own, with instructor approval) and write its niche and avatar's biggest worry in one line.
2. Build a **one-week calendar (Monday to Sunday)** with all **seven columns**: date, platform, format, pillar, hook, caption idea, status.
3. Use **at least three different pillars** (educate / promote / entertain / proof), with **no more than two promote days**, and include **at least one lighter/rest day**.
4. Choose **one or two platforms** you can realistically maintain.
5. Create a **brand kit** (Worksheet 7.2): primary colour + hex code, secondary colour + hex code, accent colour (optional), heading font, body font, logo placement rule, and a tone-of-voice note.
6. Write a **batch plan** (Worksheet 7.3): which day(s) you will plan, shoot, edit, write captions and design.
7. Run the **six-point consistency check** on your existing Session 5 thumbnail and note any change you will make.
8. Write a short paragraph: *"Why is my week realistic for one person, and how is it balanced?"*

Required deliverables:

- One completed **one-week calendar** (all seven columns) â€” typed, in a spreadsheet, or a clear photo of the printed sheet.
- One completed **brand kit** worksheet (colours with hex codes, fonts, logo rule, tone).
- A **batch plan** and the consistency-check note.
- The short reflection paragraph.

Submission format: Save as `Calendar_BrandKit_YourName` (a document, spreadsheet, or clear photo). Upload to `/Content-Creation/Week3/Planning/`. Keep a copy â€" it becomes capstone planning evidence and feeds the one-week calendar and graphics deliverables.

Deadline: Before Session 8.

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Complete seven-day calendar	2	Seven days; all seven columns filled; no empty cells
Varied pillar mix	2	At least three pillars; no more than two promote days; balanced
Realistic for one person	1	Sensible post count (about 4â€"7), one or two platforms, a rest/lighter day
Brand kit â€" colours & fonts	2	Primary + secondary with real hex codes; one or two named fonts
Brand kit â€" logo rule & tone	1	One clear logo-placement rule and a specific tone-of-voice note
Batch plan	1	Concrete days/tasks for plan, shoot, edit, write and design
Consistency check & reflection	1	Check run on a real post; honest, specific reasoning

Bonus (acknowledgement, not extra marks): whether the calendar is something the business could genuinely use next week.

Common mistakes to avoid: all-promo calendars; unrealistic "three posts a day"; inconsistent colours/fonts with no hex codes; no batch plan; empty columns; copying another business's brand; forgetting the rest day.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Business: Adaeze Fashion â€" affordable ready-to-wear for young working women in Port Harcourt (or an equivalent learner business that ticks every rubric row).

Calendar: the Adaeze launch week shown in the demonstration (Mon educate Reel, Tue promote TikTok, Wed proof graphic, Thu entertain Reel, Fri promote TikTok+Shorts, Sat proof graphic, Sun rest Status).

Brand kit: burgundy `#7B1E3A`, cream `#F5EFE0`, gold `#D4A017`, Playfair Display + Montserrat, logo bottom-centre on feed posts / top-left on stories, tone "warm, honest, encouraging, simple English".

Batch plan: Sunday plan + captions; Monday shoot all clips; Tuesday edit all videos; Wednesday design graphics; post on the set days.

Consistency check note: "My Session 5 thumbnail already uses burgundy, cream and Playfair Display. Change needed: add the Adaeze name bottom-centre to follow the logo rule."

A strong learner solution differs in business and content but ticks every rubric row.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers are in the Instructor Key below. Do not show learners the key until they have attempted all questions.)

Q1. Short answer. List the seven columns of a one-week content calendar.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which weekly plan is the most balanced? a) Seven days of "buy now" promotions b) Three posts a day on four different platforms c) Two promote days plus educate, entertain and proof posts, with one rest day d) One post every three weeks when you remember

Q3. Explain. In your own words, what is a **batch workflow**, and name two reasons it saves time.

Q4. Practical. Give the primary and secondary colour (with hex codes) and the two fonts you would write in a simple brand kit for a warm neighbourhood bakery. *(Any sensible, specific answer is acceptable.)*

Q5. Error detection. A learner's week is: Mon promo, Tue promo, Wed promo, Thu promo, Fri promo, Sat promo, Sun promo. Name two problems and one fix.

Q6. Scenario. A learner plans eight video posts a week across Instagram, TikTok, YouTube and Facebook, on top of a full-time job, with no batch plan. Explain why this plan will likely fail and give two changes to make it realistic.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6, INSTRUCTOR ONLY)

A1. Date, platform, format, pillar, hook, caption, status. *(All seven required for full marks.)*

A2. (c) Two promote days plus educate, entertain and proof posts, with one rest day. *(Varied pillars, only a little selling, and a rest day = balanced.)*

A3. A batch workflow groups similar tasks together â€” shooting several clips in one session, editing in another, writing captions in another. Reasons it saves time (any two): you set up light and background once instead of daily; you stay "warm" in one type of task instead of switching constantly; batching also makes the videos look more consistent.

A4. Any sensible, specific answer, e.g.: primary warm brown `#8B5E34`, secondary cream `#FFF3E0`; heading font Playfair Display, body font Montserrat. *(Award for specific hex codes and two named fonts that suit a warm bakery.)*

A5. Problems: (1) it is an **all-promo** week â€” the audience will feel used and unfollow; (2) there is **no variety and no rest** â€” it is unrealistic and will burn out the creator. Fix: keep only two promote days and replace the others with educate, entertain and proof, and add one lighter/rest day.

A6. It will likely fail because it is **unrealistic for one person** (eight video posts across four platforms is a team's workload), it has **no rest**, and with **no batch plan** every post needs its own setup time, so the creator will fall behind and stop. Two changes (any two): reduce to about 3â€“5 posts a week; choose only one or two platforms; add a batch plan with set days; add a lighter/rest day.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned to plan like a business, not like a mood. You built a **one-week content calendar** with seven columns and learned why a planned week beats random posting. You learned to balance your **content pillars** (educate, promote, entertain, proof) so the page is not all selling, and to include a **lighter or rest day**. You learned the **batch workflow** â€” shoot in one session, edit in another, write captions in another. Then you built a simple **brand kit** (two colours with hex codes, one or two fonts, a logo rule, a tone of voice) and learned to run a **six-point consistency check** so every post looks like the same business. And you learned to plan **realistically for one person** with a real job.

Five important takeaways:

1. **A calendar beats random posting** â€” plan the week once, then just execute.
2. **Balance your pillars** â€” about one promote to every two or three value posts, plus a rest day.
3. **Batch the work** â€” one shoot day, one edit day, one writing day, one design day.
4. **A brand kit = colours + fonts + logo rule + tone** â€” consistency makes you recognisable.
5. **Be realistic** â€” a smaller week you finish beats a huge week you abandon.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I fill a full seven-day calendar with no empty columns?
- Can I balance my week so it is not all promotions?
- Can I explain and write a batch plan in my own words?
- Can I state my brand colours as hex codes and name my fonts?
- Can I check any post against my brand and fix what is off?

Connection to the next session. You now have a plan and a look. Next session, **Session 8 â€” Publishing and Basic Analytics**, you put the plan into action: publishing or scheduling your content, then **reading the numbers** â€” views, watch time, saves, shares and comments â€” to understand what actually worked, and practising polite, professional **comment handling**. Your calendar tells you *when* to post; next time you learn how to read *how it went*.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner fills **all seven columns** of the calendar without being reminded.
- Learner's week shows a **varied pillar mix** and no more than two promote days, unprompted.

- Learner includes a **lighter/rest day** and can explain why.
- Learner states brand colours as **hex codes** and names **one or two fonts**.
- Learner writes a **specific tone-of-voice note** and a **logo-placement rule**.
- Learner can run the **six-point consistency check** on a real post and find at least one issue.
- Learner's batch plan names **concrete days and tasks**, and the week is honestly achievable.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Every post should sell." â†' No; value posts (educate, entertain, proof) earn the right to promote.
- "More posts = faster growth." â†' Consistency and quality beat volume; a smaller finished week wins.
- "Posting every day is mandatory." â†' No; disappearing is the real problem, not a missed day.
- "Consistency means every post looks identical." â†' The *system* is identical; the *content* varies.
- "My brand needs a professional logo first." â†' A consistent name, colour and font already is a brand.
- "I can copy a popular page's look." â†' Build your own look for your own audience; copying confuses customers.
- "Batching means one exhausting day." â†' You can batch across evenings; the point is grouping, not a marathon.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Pillar sort drill:** give eight example posts and ask the learner to label each educate / promote / entertain / proof, then rebalance an all-promo page.
2. **Column-fill drill:** give a blank calendar row and have the learner fill all seven columns for one known post (e.g., their Session 6 video).
3. **Brand colour drill:** open Canva, pick two swatches, read the hex codes, and name a heading and body font that fit the business; then write a four-evening batch plan.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a calendar with dates, platforms and pillars pre-filled and three rows already done; the learner completes the rest and fills colours/fonts from a shortlist.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" a full one-week calendar and brand kit from scratch.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** plan a **two-week** story arc (e.g., a launch sequence), add a fourth pillar, create a **second brand variant** for a sub-audience, and write a note on how the brand kit keeps a page consistent when two people post from it.

Links to the capstone rubric:

- This session directly produces **Criterion 8 â€" "One-week content calendar" (/2)** (full 7 days, varied pillars, all columns, realistic with a rest day and a batch plan) and supports **Criterion 7 â€" "Graphics â€" 2 posts + 1 thumbnail" (/5)** through the brand kit (consistent colours and fonts across posts and the thumbnail).
- **Checkpoint at the end of Session 7:** every learner must have a **working calendar draft, Video 1 finished, and one thumbnail**. Catch any learner missing these now â€" arriving at Session 8 without them is the most common cause of a failed capstone.

Timing guidance. The priority is the learner's **own calendar and brand kit** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a two-minute mention and reduce the independent exercise to five days instead of seven â€" but never skip the guided practical, because it produces the calendar and brand kit that the capstone requires. Ensure every learner leaves with a written brand kit they can hand to another person.

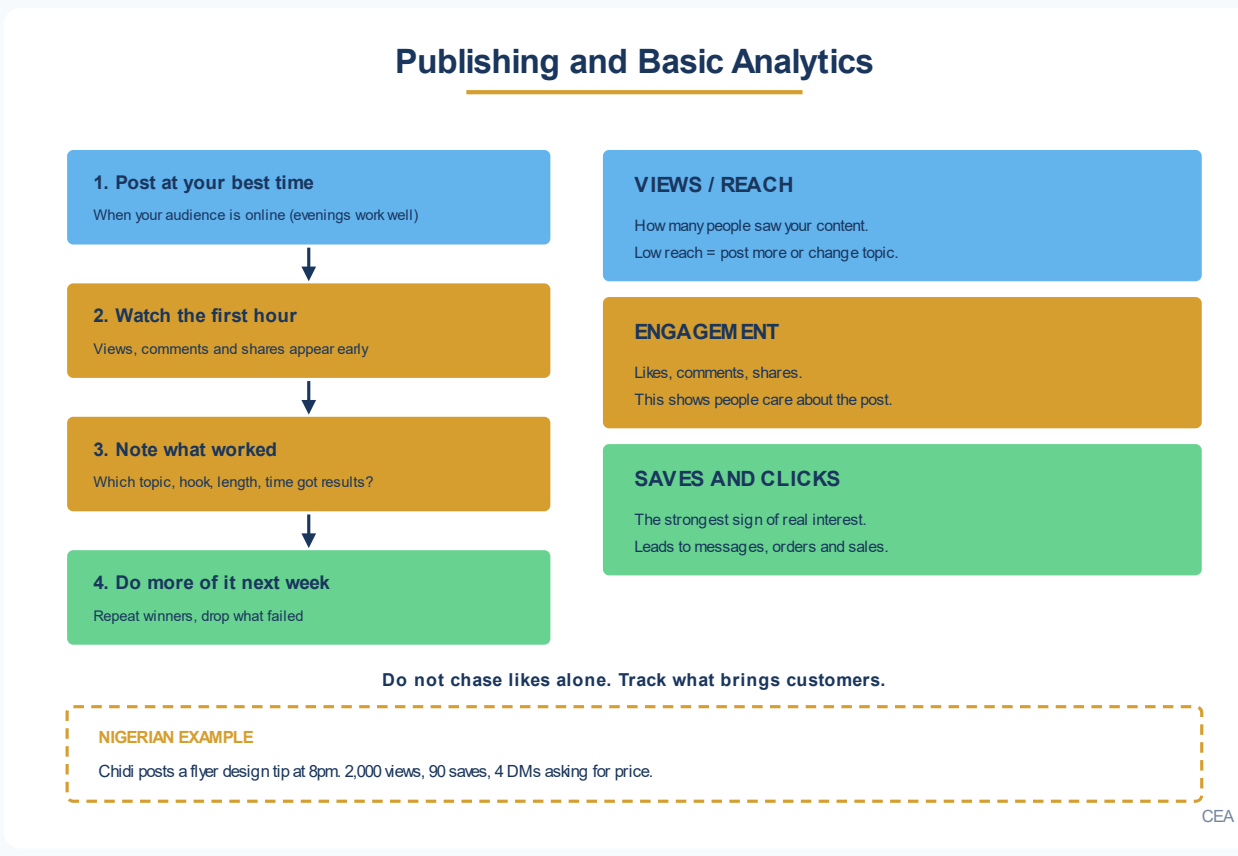
END OF SESSION 7

Next: Session 8 â€" Publishing and Basic Analytics.

SESSION 08 OF 9

Publish Analytics

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 08



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 8 â€" PUBLISHING AND BASIC ANALYTICS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	8 of 9
Session title	Publishing and Basic Analytics
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Publish, Measure and Package
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (phone use; no software skill assumed)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"7: a niche and audience avatar (S1); a finished edited video (S4â€"S5); a thumbnail (S5); captions with hook and CTA (S6); a one-week calendar with brand choices

Item	Detail
	(S7). A learner without a finished video may follow with a classmate's or the instructor's sample.
Connection to previous session	In Session 7 you planned **what** to post, **when**, and made your posts look like one consistent brand. Today you **put the plan into action**: you publish (or schedule, or keep a private draft) and then **read the numbers** that come back. The S7 calendar is the map; today you drive the road and read the dashboard.
Preparation before class	Have ready: (1) the **Adaeze Fashion** video and thumbnail (S5â€"S6) to upload; (2) a free **TikTok/Instagram/YouTube** account logged in on the projector device with **working internet**; (3) **two sample analytics screenshots** (one "many views, no action", one "fewer views, strong action"); (4) **three sample comments** (praising, complaining, price); (5) the **analytics-note template** and **Simulation brief** (I.4) printed per learner; (6) tested Wi-Fi â€" publishing needs a live connection.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** what "publishing" means across TikTok, Instagram, YouTube Shorts and WhatsApp Status, and how it differs from editing or exporting.
2. **Publish**, **schedule**, or prepare a **ready-to-publish draft / unlisted link** when they prefer to keep content private.
3. **Choose a sensible posting time** using general guidance and their own audience habits, knowing no time guarantees success.
4. **Write a good first (pinned) comment** that adds value, repeats a CTA, or starts a conversation.
5. **Explain the basic analytics terms** in their own words: views, reach, watch time, average view duration, retention, saves, shares, comments, follows.
6. **Read a retention graph** and say what an early drop (weak hook) and a mid-video drop (slow pacing) mean, then name one specific change.
7. **Handle comments politely and professionally** â€" praise, questions and complaints.
8. **Apply the ethics of engagement**: no fake likes, no bought followers, no fake reviews, respect privacy, keep replies professional.
9. **Complete a short analytics note** that names real numbers and what they suggest.
10. **Publish or prepare one item and record its first-day numbers** (Assignment 8 and part of the capstone evidence).

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone per learner (the one used in S2â€"S7), or an academy computer with the exported video.
- Instructor device on the projector, logged into a social account, with working internet.
- Whiteboard and markers.

Software

- The **free** TikTok, Instagram or YouTube app the learner already uses.
- **CapCut** (to export, if needed) and **Canva** (the S5 thumbnail) â€" both free.
- No paid tool required. Scheduling, where offered, is free; if unavailable, post live or keep a draft.

Accounts

- At least one free account (TikTok, Instagram or YouTube). The learner may post **publicly**, post a **draft/unlisted link**, or post to **WhatsApp Status** â€" all are accepted today.

Sample files / examples

- Two instructor-made **analytics screenshots** for the opener.
- Three printed **discussion comments** (praising, complaining, price) â€" see G and I.
- The **Adaeze Fashion** sample video ready to publish or draft live.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 8.1 â€" "Publish & Record" (first-day numbers sheet; see H).
- Worksheet 8.2 â€" "Analytics-Note Template" (see F.10 and L).
- Worksheet 8.3 â€" "Simulation Task Card" (see I.4).

Internet

- **Required today.** Publishing and analytics need a live connection. If Wi-Fi fails, the learner completes a **ready-to-publish draft** offline and reads analytics from the screen or printed samples. Never let a weak connection stop the lesson â€" the *thinking* is the assessed skill.

Alternatives for learners who lack a facility

- No social account? Use **WhatsApp Status** and read the "viewed by" list as simple analytics.
- Unwilling to post publicly? Keep a **draft/unlisted** and record the same numbers from the demo. Privacy is always respected.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: Show **two analytics screenshots** side by side. Cover the numbers at first. Do **not** say which is "better" yet.

- **Post A:** 1,200 views, 0 saves, 0 shares, 1 comment ("Nice").
- **Post B:** 210 views, 14 saves, 6 shares, 9 comments (people asking "how much?" and "where is your shop?").

What the instructor says:

> *"Both are posts from small Port Harcourt businesses. One looks like a winner because its number is bigger. Show of hands: **which post actually brought the business more customers?**"*

Take a quick vote. Most point at Post A (1,200 is bigger than 210). Then correct gently:

> *"The big number is **views** â€" how many times the video was seen. But Post B: people **saved** it, **shared** it, and **commented asking the price and address** â€" those are buying signals. Post A was seen a lot and moved nobody; Post B moved many. Today you will learn to read **all** the numbers, not just the loud one."*

Expected learner response: Many argue views matter. Accept it â€" it is the misconception the session corrects.

Then reveal the theme on the board:

> ***"It is not how many people saw it. It is what they did next."***

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run as a fast oral round-robin with the questions on the projector. The goal: every learner is **ready to publish their own work**.

Q1 â€" "What is on today's row of your S7 calendar â€" platform, format and hook?" Expected: a concrete post (e.g., "Monday, Instagram Reel, the '3 reasons' hook"). Common gap: no finished calendar. Handling: pair with a classmate; they publish their draft or the class sample.

Q2 â€" "Where is your finished video and thumbnail, with captions, a hook and a CTA?" Expected: on the phone / in the gallery. Common gap: not **exported**. Clarify: a draft inside CapCut is not publishable â€" it must be **exported** so the gallery and social apps can see it.

Q3 â€" "What is the exact CTA in your caption?" Expected: something specific like "DM 'FASHION'", "Comment your style", "Call to order". Common gap: vague or no CTA. Clarify: a CTA turns a view into a measurable action today.

Q4 â€" "Name one thing that makes your page look like one brand." Expected: same colours, fonts, logo, tone, brand hashtag. Common gap: inconsistent style. Clarify: consistency builds trust â€" and trust is what makes people save, share and buy.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"For seven sessions you planned, shot, recorded, edited, designed and wrote. Today the work finally **leaves your phone** and meets the real world â€" the morning you **open the door**. Once the door is open, **watch the shop floor**: how many came in, how long they stayed, what they asked. That is analytics."*

If more than a third of the class has no finished video, spend 5 extra minutes publishing the Adaeze sample as a whole-class activity â€" these skills can be taught from any content.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What "publishing" actually means

The idea. Publishing is the moment your content becomes visible to other people on a platform â€" when the video you made in CapCut moves from your phone to where a stranger can find it. Editing and exporting are private; **publishing is shared.**

Plain-English definition. To **publish** is to **put your content out where an audience can see it.** The button may be **Post**, **Share**, **Upload** or **Publish** â€" the word changes by app and version.

What publishing is NOT. It is **not editing** (cutting/captioning in CapCut), **exporting** (saving the file to the gallery) or **designing** (the Canva thumbnail). Those produce a **file**; publishing **shares the file**. Many beginners stop at the file and wonder why nothing happens.

Limitation. Publishing does not guarantee views or make content good; it only **makes your work available**. Whether people watch, save and buy depends on the hook, value and CTA you built earlier â€" and how you **read the numbers and improve**.

F.2 Public vs draft / unlisted vs scheduled

The idea. Publishing is not one single act. Depending on the platform, you can put content out in **three main ways**.

Way	What it means	Who can see it	When to use it (Adaeze Fashion)
Public	The post appears on your page/feed; anyone may find it in searches/recommendations.	Everyone	Launch day, when the week's content is ready and you want reach.
Draft / Unlisted / Private	Saved but **not visible to the public**. A draft is not posted; an unlisted link works only for those with the link; a private post is visible only to the owner. Wording varies.	Only you, or those with the link	Practising, awaiting owner approval, or not ready to go public. **Analytics can often still be read** â€" useful for practice.
Scheduled	You set the post to go live automatically at a chosen future time.	Everyone, but later	Batching a week's work so posts appear at good times. Not all free versions offer it; if not, post manually or set a reminder.

Worked example â€" Adaeze's launch. Adaeze finishes all seven posts on Sunday. She **schedules** Monday and Wednesday, keeps Thursday's skit as a **draft** until she checks the audio, and **publishes** Monday's reel **publicly**. One afternoon gives her a whole week of content.

Common misconception. "If I do not post publicly, I am cheating." No. A **ready-to-publish draft** and an **unlisted link** are honest, professional ways to work â€" agencies send clients unlisted links **for approval** before a public launch. What matters is that your content is genuinely **finished and shareable**.

F.3 Best posting times â€" general guidance, not guarantees

The idea. "Best time to post" means the time your audience is most likely to be online. There is **general guidance**, but **no magic minute** guarantees success.

Time window (WAT)	Why it often works
Early morning (6â€"8am)	People wake and scroll before work or school.
Lunch break (12â€"1pm)	People relax and check phones at midday.
Evening (6â€"9pm)	The strongest window for most Nigerian audiences; people are home and scrolling.
Weekends	More free time; often good for entertainment and shopping content.

Why it is only guidance. Your audience is not "everybody" â€" it is a specific group (for Adaeze: *young working women in Port Harcourt*). A worker who sleeps early may watch at 1pm; a church audience may be busiest on Sunday. Most apps show **when your followers are active** â€" use it as a hint.

The more important lesson. For a beginner, **consistency beats perfect timing.** Posting three times a week at a "good-enough" time beats posting once a month at the "perfect" time. Do not let the hunt for the perfect hour stop you from posting.

Common misconception. "8pm will blow up; 3pm will fail." Timing is a **small dial**, not the main switch. Hook, value, CTA and consistency matter far more.

F.4 The first comment and the pinned comment

The idea. The **first comment** is a comment you leave on your own post right after publishing; a **pinned comment** stays at the top. The caption may be long and the CTA buried; a first/pinned comment puts a short, useful message right where people look.

What goes in a good first / pinned comment:

1. **Extra value** â€" a tip or small bonus ("Tip: wash ankara inside-out to keep the colour").
2. **A repeat of the CTA** â€" "DM the word 'FASHION' for the price list."
3. **A question to start conversation** â€" "Which colour would you wear to church: burgundy or navy?"
4. **Hashtags** â€" on Instagram many creators put them in the first comment to keep the caption clean.
5. **Important details** â€" a WhatsApp number, shop address or link not in the caption.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion. After publishing the "3 reasons" reel, she pins:

> *"Colour shown is burgundy (also in navy and forest green). ðŸ'‰ DM 'FASHION' for this week's price list. Which colour is your favourite â€" comment below. ðŸ'¬"*

Common misconception. "The first comment is only for hashtags." It can hold hashtags, but it is most powerful when it **adds value or starts a conversation.** Never use it to make **false claims**.

F.5 What analytics are and why they matter

The idea. Analytics are the numbers a platform shows about how your content performed â€" how many saw it, how long they watched, what they saved, shared and said. They are your **dashboard.**

Plain-English definition. Analytics = "what happened after I posted" â€" the platform's honest report of how people reacted.

Why they exist. Without numbers you are guessing. You cannot tell whether the hook worked, whether people stayed, or whether the CTA moved anyone. Analytics replace guessing with **evidence**, so you can decide **what to change**.

Limitation. Analytics are **not a score of your worth** nor a **direct measure of money**. A 5,000-view video might earn nothing; a 150-view video from the right local audience might earn ten orders. Read the numbers as **clues**, never verdicts â€" read a **handful**, say honestly what they **suggest**, and name **one change**.

F.6 The basic analytics terms, explained

(Exact menu names vary by platform and version.)

Term	What it means (plain English)	What it tells you	Adaeze example
Views / Plays	How many times the video started playing.	How many gave it a chance â€" **loud but shallow**.	**214 views.**
Reach / Impressions	Reach = how many **different** people saw it; impressions = how many times it appeared on a screen. Not all apps show both.	How far it spread.	Reached **180 people.**
Watch time	The **total** time people spent watching.	How much attention you earned in total.	Total **4 min 20 sec.**
Average view duration	The **average** time each viewer watched (watch time Ã· views).	Whether people stayed; 5s of a 30s video is weak.	Average **5 seconds** of 30 â€" weak.
Retention	A **graph** of the percentage still watching at each moment.	**Where people left** â€" the most useful graph for a beginner.	Sharp drop at **second 2.**
Saves	People tapped "save" to watch again later.	**Strong interest** â€" a deliberate choice to keep your content.	**9 saves.**
Shares	People sent the post to someone else.	**Very strong interest** â€" they put their own name behind it.	**3 shares.**
Comments	People wrote a reply.	Engagement and a chance to build trust by replying.	**4 comments**, all answered.
Likes	Heart taps.	A light signal â€" weaker than saves/shares/comments.	**37 likes.**
Follows gained	How many followed after watching.	Whether your content made people want **more**.	**5 new followers.**
Profile visits / link taps	How many opened your profile or tapped a link.	Interest in the business beyond one video.	**22 profile visits.**

The beginner's ranking. From weakest to strongest in **real interest**:

> ***Views â†' Likes â†' Comments â†' Shares â†' Saves â†' DMs / Calls / Orders***

A view is easy; a save or a DM takes effort â€" and effort from a viewer is a much better sign of a real customer. **Chase the actions, not the noise.**

Common misconception. "Views are everything." No â€" views count how many *started*. **Saves, shares, comments and DMs** show how many *cared*; and if you see no numbers yet, analytics simply take time.

Worked comparison. Post A (dance trend): **1,200 views, 0 saves, 0 shares, 1 comment, 0 DMs.** Post B (3-reasons dress): **214 views, 9 saves, 3 shares, 4 price-question comments, 3 DMs.** Post A earned **attention**; Post B earned **interest** â€" for a business, interest is worth more.

F.7 Reading the retention graph and what to change

The idea. The **retention graph** (audience retention) is a line from the **start** of your video to the **end**, showing the **percentage of viewers still watching** at each moment. Where the line **falls**, people left; where it **stays flat**, people stayed; a **spike** often means people rewatched that moment.

How to read it: the start is always high (near 100%) because most who click watch the very start; read left to right (down = leaving, flat = staying); the end tells you how many reached the finish.

Shape of the graph	What it means	What to change next time
Big drop in the first few seconds	The **hook was weak** â€" people gave up immediately.	Change the **first 3 seconds**: stronger hook, clearer text, a face or the product moving at once.
Steep drop in the middle	**Slow pacing** â€" the video dragged or got boring.	**Tighten the middle:** cut pauses, shorten talk, add B-roll, get to the point faster.
A small bump/spike upward	People **rewound** â€" a high-value moment (price, result, reveal).	Do **more of that**; put that style in the hook.
Steep drop at the very end	Normal â€" people finished. Fine, unless almost everyone leaves before the CTA.	Put the **CTA earlier or repeat it** on screen at the end.
Line stays fairly flat and high	Strong content â€" people watched to the end.	Keep this style; make more like it.

Worked example â€" Adaeze's reel. The graph stays high for one second, then **plunges at second 2** when the video shows a **still hanger** with no movement, then flattens when she talks about the dress. **Diagnosis:** the hook lost people. **Change:** open with **a person wearing the dress and moving**, text hook on screen at once. This is the situation in capstone **viva question 7** and the sample analytics note.

Common misconception. "A drop at the end means it was bad." No â€" some end-drop is **normal**. Worry about **early** drops (weak hook) and **middle** drops (weak pacing).

F.8 Community management â€" handling comments politely

The idea. Community management is how you behave in comments and messages after publishing: replying, thanking, answering, defusing. It is the **human** side of publishing, where small businesses win trust â€" a comment is a person talking in public, so **the comments are the front desk.**

Rules for polite, professional replies:

1. **Reply quickly**, ideally within a few hours.
2. **Thank praise simply** and warmly â€" never argue with a compliment.
3. **Answer questions fully** â€" price, size, location, or exactly where to find it.
4. **Stay calm and non-personal with complaints.** Never trade insults. Move serious details to a **private DM**.
5. **Never share private customer information** â€" no full names, phone numbers, addresses or order details of another customer in public.
6. **Turn negatives into service.** Apologise honestly if wrong and offer a real next step.
7. **Delete/report only spam and abuse** â€" never delete honest criticism just because it stings.
8. **Heart/thank good comments** to show appreciation.

Worked examples â€" three comments (Adaeze Fashion):

Comment type	Example	A good, professional reply
Praising	"This dress is so beautiful! ðŸ˜□"	"Thank you so much! ðŸ› It is one of our favourites too. DM 'FASHION' if you would like the price."
Asking price	"How much is this one?"	"Hi! This style is â‚¦18,500 and comes in Sâ€"XL. ðŸ‘‰ DM 'FASHION' and we will send the full price list today."

Comment type	Example	A good, professional reply
Complaining	"I ordered last week and there is still no delivery!"	"Hello, I am so sorry for the delay â€" that is not the service we want you to have. ðŸ™ Please send me your order name in a DM and I will sort it out personally today."

Common misconception. "I should only reply to positive comments." No â€" the **complaint** is often the most important, because everyone watches your reaction. You control how you respond and how you protect privacy.

F.9 The ethics of engagement â€" grow honestly

The idea. There is a right and a wrong way to grow. The wrong way â€" buying followers, fake likes, fake reviews â€" is dishonest, breaks platform rules and builds nothing real. The right way â€" good content, honest claims, real engagement â€" builds a business that lasts. Your reputation in Port Harcourt is your real asset; platforms also **remove fake followers and can restrict or ban accounts** that cheat.

Do this âœ…	Never do this â□Œ
Reply honestly to comments and DMs.	Buy followers, likes, views or comments.
Use real customer comments (with permission) as testimonials.	Write fake reviews or fake testimonials.
Show products as they really are.	Use a filter or claim that misleads buyers.
Ask happy customers to leave an honest review.	Pay for a *positive-only* fake review.
Ask friends to share content they genuinely like.	Run engagement pods that mass-like dishonestly.
Respect privacy â€" never post a customer's details without permission.	Screenshot private chats or customer data publicly.
Take responsibility for mistakes.	Delete honest criticism or insult a complaining customer.

Worked example. A competitor offers to "add 5,000 real Nigerian followers" for â‚¦5,000. Adaeze refuses â€" those followers would never buy, would make her posts look empty of real engagement, and could get her flagged. Instead she spends the â‚¦5,000 promoting her best reel honestly.

Common misconception. "Everyone buys followers; it is normal." Common is not correct. It cheats the numbers, not customers. Honest growth is **slower**, but a slow, real audience is worth far more than a fast, fake one.

F.10 A simple analytics-note template

The idea. An **analytics note** is a short written record of what happened to a post and what you learned. It proves you can read your own numbers, turns a glance into a **lesson**, and is **capstone evidence** for the viva.

The CEA Analytics-Note Template:

```
CONTENT ANALYTICS NOTE
Business / brand: _____
Post title or short description: _____
Platform: _____   Date posted (or scheduled): _____
Status: public / unlisted / draft

FIRST-DAY NUMBERS (or first 48 hours):
Views: _____
Watch time (total): _____
Average view duration: _____
Retention: where did it drop? _____
Saves: _____   Shares: _____   Comments: _____   Likes: _____
Follows gained: _____

WHAT THE NUMBERS SUGGEST (1â€"3 sentences):
_____

ONE CHANGE I WILL MAKE NEXT TIME:
```

```
_____________________________________________

COMMENTS HANDLED: how many, and how? _____________________

ETHICS CHECK: All engagement is real. No bought likes, followers,
reviews, or fake comments. â˜ Confirmed
```

Filled example (Adaeze Fashion). The complete model note is the Instructor Reference Solution in Section L. In short: **214 views**, average view duration **5s of 30**, retention **drops at second 2**, **9 saves, 3 shares, 4 comments** â€" a **weak hook but strong product interest** â€" with one change: **open on a person wearing the dress, moving, text on screen from second one.**

Common misconception. "My numbers are too small to write down." Small numbers are still **real data**, and honesty about them is exactly what the viva rewards. "214 views, drop at second 2, changing my hook" is a strong answer.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- The **Adaeze Fashion** finished video (exported) and thumbnail on the projector device; a social account logged in with a **live connection**.
- The **three sample comments** on the board/printed; a blank **analytics-note template** on screen; a retention graph of a sample post.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" publish or draft live (4 minutes)

Say: "Watch a video leave my phone â€" I will narrate every tap." Select the **Adaeze video**; paste the **caption** (hook, value, CTA, hashtags) â€" *"Reusing my Session 6 copy."*; choose the **privacy setting**, showing the **draft/unlisted** option; set the **cover/thumbnail**; add and **pin** the **first comment**; then **Publish** (or save as draft).

Point out: "The caption, hashtags and cover were ready from earlier sessions. Publishing day is **not writing day** â€" it is **press day**."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" read the analytics screen live (5 minutes)

Say: "Now the most important habit: after I post, I **look**. I do not guess." Open the **analytics / insights** screen (names vary â€" point out where it is) and read aloud, in order:

- **Views:** "214 people started watching."
- **Average view duration:** "On average 5 seconds of a 30-second video â€" that is short."
- **Retention graph:** "High for one second, then it **drops off a cliff at second 2**. That tells me the opening was weak."
- **Saves and shares:** "But 9 saved and 3 shared â€" so the **content** was good; only the **start** let it down."
- **Comments:** "4 comments, 2 asking price â€" real interest."

Think aloud: "So the still hanger lost people, but the product kept the right ones. Next reel, I open with a person wearing the dress, moving, text on screen at second one. One change."

Ask: "If I only looked at views, would I know any of this?" *(No.)* "Which number told me people were interested?" *(Saves, shares, price questions.)*

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" reply to a comment politely (3 minutes)

Show the complaint on the board: *"I ordered last week and there is still no delivery!"* Type the reply live:

> *"Hello, I am so sorry for the delay â€" that is not the service we want you to have. ðŸ™ Please send me your order name in a DM and I will sort it out personally today."*

Point out: acknowledged the problem; apologised honestly; did not argue or blame; moved private details to a **DM**; offered a real next step. Then reply to the price question: *"Hi! This style is â‚¦18,500 and comes in Sâ€"XL. ðŸ'‰ DM 'FASHION' and we will send the price list today."*

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" fill the analytics note (3 minutes)

Fill the **analytics-note template** live, narrating: real views, average view duration, where retention dropped, saves, shares, comments. Write one sentence: *"People left at second 2, so my hook was weak, but saves and price questions show real interest."* Write one change: *"Open with a person wearing the dress, moving, from second one."* Tick the **ethics check**.

Say: "This half-page is worth real marks in your capstone and viva. It is honest, it names real numbers, and it says what you will change."

G.6 Questions to ask during the demo

- "Is publishing the same as exporting?" *(No â€" exporting makes a file; publishing shares it.)*
- "Can we publish privately and still practise analytics?" *(Yes â€" draft/unlisted still gives numbers.)*
- "Why does a save matter more than a like?" *(Deliberate effort â€" a stronger sign of interest.)*
- "What does a drop at second 2 tell us?" *(The hook was weak.)*
- "Which number shows people were ready to buy?" *(Price-question comments and DMs.)*

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner **publishes (or drafts/unlists) one item** from their S7 calendar and **records its first-day numbers** on Worksheet 8.1, then reads retention and writes one sentence about what the numbers suggest.

Starting materials: your exported video and thumbnail; your caption; your calendar; a phone with a free social app and internet; Worksheet 8.1 ("Publish & Record"); the template (Worksheet 8.2).

Procedure (instructor calls each step; learners work; instructor walks the room):

1. Open the app you will publish to. Confirm you are signed in and internet works.
2. **Choose your privacy setting** â€" public, draft/unlisted, or WhatsApp Status. Say aloud which and why.
3. Add the **caption** from Session 6 (hook, value, CTA, hashtags).
4. Add the **cover/thumbnail** from Session 5.
5. Add a **first comment** (a tip, the CTA, a question) and **pin** it. *Predict: "Will this comment start a conversation?"*
6. **Publish** (or save as draft / post to Status).
7. Open the **analytics / insights** screen. If numbers are not showing yet, remember they take time â€" record what you see and check later.
8. On **Worksheet 8.1**, record: views, watch time (if shown), average view duration, where retention dropped (if shown), saves, shares, comments, likes, follows gained.
9. Write **one sentence** on what the numbers **suggest** (or "too early â€" will check tomorrow").
10. Write **one change** you would make next time.
11. If a comment exists, **reply politely** using the rules in F.8.

Expected result: one published/drafted item; a completed first-day record; one sentence of interpretation; one planned change.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Which privacy choice fits your comfort today â€" and does it still count for your capstone?" *(It does â€" drafts count.)*
- After step 7: "If views are low after ten minutes, has the post failed?" *(No â€" analytics take time; judge nothing on the first minutes.)*
- After step 9: "Is this number a verdict on me, or a clue about my content?" *(A clue.)*

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- **"No views yet."** Normal in the first minutes. Record the timestamp, check again in 1â€"2 hours and the next day. Do **not** delete the post; use the demo numbers for interpretation practice.
- **Internet too slow to publish.** Save as a **draft**; analytics practice continues from the demo.
- **Learner refuses to post publicly.** Praise the choice; use **draft/unlisted/Status**. Privacy is respected.
- **Blank number fields.** Write "not shown yet" and use **views + comments** as the data.

- **Caption missing.** Paste it from the Session 6 captions document first.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ I chose a privacy setting deliberately (public / draft / Status)
- ☐ Caption, cover and first comment are in place
- ☐ The item is published, scheduled or saved as a draft/unlisted link
- ☐ I recorded real first-day numbers on Worksheet 8.1
- ☐ I wrote one sentence on what the numbers suggest
- ☐ I wrote one change I will make next time
- ☐ I replied politely to any comment that exists
- ☐ I did not delete a post just because views were low

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (done alone): Read **two sample analytics scenarios** and write the correct interpretation plus **one improvement** for each; then write **polite professional replies** to **three sample comments** (praising, complaining, asking price).

Scenario A â€" "Vera's Hair Studio" (braiding salon, Port Harcourt). A 25-second reel of a finished braided style. First-day numbers: **860 views**, average view duration **3 seconds**, retention **drops sharply at second 2**, **1 save**, **0 shares**, **1 comment** ("Nice hair"), **0 price questions**.

Scenario B â€" "Mama Nkechi's Soup Palace" (local restaurant, Port Harcourt). A 20-second video of a steaming bowl of pepper soup. First-day numbers: **140 views**, average view duration **11 seconds**, retention **high until the last 3 seconds**, **12 saves**, **4 shares**, **6 comments** (3 "Where is your shop?", 2 "How much?").

Sample comments (for the reply task):

1. **(Praising)** "This is the neatest braids I have seen in PH! ðŸ˜□"
2. **(Complaining)** "You people did my sister's hair and it started loosening in two days. Very disappointing."
3. **(Asking price)** "How much for this style?"

Requirements:

1. For **Scenario A**, write the interpretation and **one specific improvement**.
2. For **Scenario B**, write the interpretation and **one specific improvement**.
3. State which scenario is the **stronger post for the business** and why, in one line.
4. Write a **polite, professional reply** to each of the three comments (label 1, 2, 3).
5. For the complaint (comment 2), show that you **a) do not argue, b) protect privacy, c) offer a next step**.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria: A names the **weak hook** (early drop) and low saves/shares; B names **strong retention**, high saves/shares and buying questions; each improvement is **specific**; replies are warm and professional; the complaint reply does not argue and moves details to a DM.

Hints if stuck: compare average view duration to video length (3s of 25 is weak; 11 of 20 is strong); for A, the drop "at second 2" points to the **hook**; a good complaint reply starts "I am sorryâ€¦" and ends "please send meâ€¦ in a DM."

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners until time is up):

Scenario A â€" interpretation and improvement:

> *A **weak hook**: 860 people started but left in the first two seconds, so almost nobody saw the finished style. Very low saves (1) and shares (0) mean it did not make people care, and no price questions mean it did not sell. "Nice hair" is a bare compliment, not buying interest.*
>
> ***One improvement:** Open with the **finished braid already on screen and moving** (or a before/after flash), text hook on screen from second one, and a CTA like "DM 'BRAIDS' for prices".*

Scenario B â€" interpretation and improvement:

*A **strong post**. 140 views is small, but viewers stayed an average of **11 seconds of 20**, and retention held almost to the end. **12 saves and 4 shares** are strong signals, and the comments are **buying questions** (location, price) â€" the best kind.*

***One improvement:** Put the **shop location and price clearly in the caption and pinned comment** so the people already asking can act, and lightly promote the post to reach more local food lovers.*

Stronger post: **Scenario B.** Fewer views but far higher interest â€" high retention, many saves/shares, and real buying questions. Views are noise; these are customers.

Model replies:

1. "Thank you so much, Precious! ðŸ˜ It means a lot. DM 'BRAIDS' and we will send this week's styles and prices. ðŸ›"
2. "Hello, I am really sorry to hear that â€" loose braids in two days is not the standard we want for you. ðŸ™ Please send me your sister's order name in a DM and I will look into it personally and fix it today."
3. "Hi! This style is â¦15,000 and takes about 4 hours. We are at Vera's Hair Studio, Port Harcourt. ðŸ‘‰ DM 'BRAIDS' to book a slot this week."

Learner marking guidance (out of 10): A names the weak hook (2) + specific improvement (1); B names strong retention/saves/buying questions (2) + specific improvement (1); correct stronger-post judgment + reason (1); praise reply warm/action (1); complaint reply calm, moves to DM, offers next step (1); price reply gives concrete info + CTA (1).

I.4 THE SESSION 8 SIMULATION (ASSESSED â€" 15% of the course)

What it is. A **realistic end-to-end scenario under mild time pressure** (course design, Section 10.4): the learner receives a brief and runs the **full workflow â€" plan â† shoot â† edit â† caption â† "publish" â† record numbers** â€" in one sitting. It combines Sessions 1â€"8 and is worth **15%** of the final score.

How to run it. Run it **within this session if time allows**, or as a dedicated ~35â€"40 minute block in Session 8 week (recommended). Run learners **individually or in pairs**, on a timer so the "mild time pressure" is fair.

Simulation brief (read aloud / display):

***BRIEF:** You have been hired by **Oluchi's Beauty Hub**, a small cosmetic and skincare shop in Port Harcourt, to create and publish **one short video** for their page. **Topic:** "3 things to check before you buy any skincare product." **You have 35 minutes** to: **plan** (hook + 3 points), **shoot** (a simple 3-shot video on your phone), **edit** in CapCut (trim + captions), write a **caption** (hook, value, CTA, hashtags), and **"publish"** it â€" publicly, as a draft/unlisted link, or to WhatsApp Status. Then **record the first-day numbers you expect to watch**, and write **one sentence** on what you would change if retention dropped at second 3. **Rules:** Own footage and free/licensed music only. No fake engagement. Respect privacy. Maximum **two hints**, and a hint is a question, not an answer.*

Time budget (â‰ˆ35 minutes; scale to 40 if the class is slow):

Stage	Time	What is produced
Plan	5 min	Written hook + 3 skincare checks
Shoot	8 min	3 simple shots (hook, main points, CTA/sign-off)
Edit	10 min	Trimmed clip with captions in CapCut
Caption + publish	7 min	Caption (hook/value/CTA/hashtags) + published/draft item
Record + note	5 min	First-day numbers record + one-sentence improvement

What is handed in: the **published/draft link or Status** (or screenshot proof), and a one-page **Simulation sheet**: the hook, the caption, the numbers to watch, and the one-sentence improvement.

Simulation marking key / rubric (out of 20):

Criterion	Marks	Descriptor of a strong answer
Hook is specific and honest (first 3 seconds)	4	A spoken/on-screen line naming a real skincare worry; not a greeting
Content delivers the promise (3 points)	3	The three checks are shown or clearly said
Video shot and edited acceptably	4	Stable, decently lit, trimmed, captioned (3â€"5 words per line)
Caption has hook/value/CTA/3â€"5 relevant hashtags	4	Matches the Session 6 structure; CTA is clear
Published or drafted correctly	2	Genuinely published, scheduled, or saved as draft/unlisted
Recorded numbers + honest one-sentence improvement	2	Names what to watch and a specific change if retention drops early
Ethics and professionalism	1	No fake engagement; respectful; own footage/legal audio

Pass mark: 12/20 (60%), or adjust to the academy's band. A learner who runs out of time is marked on what is **complete and honest**. **Instructor note:** watch **time discipline** â€" the most common failure is **not publishing at all**. Protect the "publish/draft" step above polish, and record each learner's link/draft path before they leave.

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ebere* runs a small restaurant, **"Ebere's Pot,"** on a busy road in Port Harcourt. Her food is popular, but her social page barely moves. She posts about once a week, whenever she remembers, never looks at the numbers, and assumes social media "just does not work for food businesses."

Relevant facts.

- Her food is good â€" the shop is busy at lunch â€" but her videos always open with **five seconds of a still pot**, and she posts at random times (4am, midnight).
- She has never opened her analytics, never replied to a comment, and once **deleted a video after one day** because it "only had 40 views."
- A competitor, *De Sauce Place*, posts consistently in the evening, replies to every comment, and shows the **first bite** right at the start.

Decision point. Should Ebere (a) stop posting, (b) keep posting exactly as she does and hope, or (c) **look at her analytics, fix her opening, post at better times, and reply to comments**?

Possible approaches.

1. **Stop posting.** Free, protects her from disappointment â€" but keeps her invisible to new customers.
2. **Keep the same habits.** No change, so the same result.
3. **Read the numbers and adjust.** Ebere opens her analytics: most videos lose half their viewers **in the first three seconds**, during the still-pot opening. She changes to a **spoon lifting steaming jollof with the first bite** from second one, posts in the **evening**, **replies to every comment** and pins one with address and price, and checks numbers after **three days**, not one day.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Ebere's problem was never the food or the camera â€" it was **the hook, the timing, the silence in the comments, and never reading her own numbers**. All four are fixable for free in one weekend.

Illustrative result. Before: still-pot opening; retention dropped at **second 3**; average view duration **3 seconds** of 30; about **40 saves** a month; almost no comments. After a month of evening posting, first-bite hooks and replies: retention stayed high through the first **8 seconds**; average view duration rose to **9 seconds**; saves reached about **110**; and "Where is your shop?" came weekly, with the address pinned. Ebere did not "go viral" â€" she became **visible and trusted** to the people near her, and lunchtime got busier.

Professional connection. Social media managers are paid to do exactly what Ebere learned: **post consistently, read analytics, adjust the hook, and manage the community.** A creator who can publish and then **explain what the numbers mean and**

what to change is far more valuable than one who can only edit. This session's skill â€" reading the dashboard â€" separates a hobby poster from a paid manager.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

#	Mistake	Why it happens	The fix
K.1	**Posting and ignoring the comments**	Treating publishing as the finish line.	Reply within a few hours; thank praise, answer questions, pin a comment with the CTA. No unanswered question older than a day.
K.2	**Deleting a post when first-day views are low**	Misreading early, small numbers as failure.	Leave it up; check again after **3 days**. Low initial views do not mean a bad post.
K.3	**Treating views as the only measure of success**	Views are the loudest, easiest number to see.	Read the whole set; rank saves/shares/DMs above views. A smaller-view post can be stronger.
K.4	**Buying followers, likes or fake reviews**	A belief that big numbers attract customers fast.	Refuse and remove bought engagement; grow with real content. Cheating â€" not real growth.
K.5	**Replying rudely or sharing private details**	Reacting emotionally, or defending without thinking about privacy.	Reply calmly: acknowledge, apologise if fair, move details to a DM, offer a next step. Never post customer names, numbers or order details publicly.
K.6	**No CTA in the video or caption**	The content entertains but never tells people what to do.	Add one CTA (DM 'WORD', call, comment) in the caption, the pinned comment and on screen.
K.7	**Expecting overnight results**	Comparing a beginner's page to viral or celebrity accounts.	Commit to **weeks** of steady, on-topic posting; adjust one thing at a time; track progress weekly.
K.8	**"The algorithm shadowbanned me"**	Looking for an external excuse instead of reading the data.	Fix the hook/pacing/CTA and post consistently before blaming the platform.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed. Do not "fix" a problem until you have checked it â€" open the analytics, look at retention, count the unanswered comments, read your reply aloud. Confirm the cause, then correct.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Assignment 8 â€" Publish and Report"

Purpose: To practise the full publish step and read basic analytics honestly â€" real numbers and what they suggest â€" building the capstone's **published/draft link** and **analytics note** evidence (checkpoint end of S8: at least one link).

Realistic scenario. Adaeze Fashion's launch week has begun; you are responsible for one post. After publishing it (or preparing a ready-to-publish draft/unlisted link), report back to Adaeze â€" not with feelings, but with **numbers** â€" and tell her **one thing you will change next time**. She does not care about "likes"; she cares what the numbers mean for her shop.

Detailed instructions:

1. Publish **one item** from your S7 calendar â€" **or** prepare it as a **ready-to-publish draft / unlisted link** (or WhatsApp Status). Either is accepted.
2. Add the **caption**, the **cover/thumbnail**, and a **first comment** (value + CTA + a question) and pin it.
3. Read your **analytics / insights** after publishing and take a **screenshot**.
4. Complete the **Analytics-Note Template** (Worksheet 8.2) with **real numbers**: views, watch time (if shown), average view duration, retention drops, saves, shares, comments, likes, follows.

5. Write **1â€“3 sentences** on what the numbers **suggest**.
6. Write **one change** you will make next time.
7. Record any **comments you handled** and how.
8. Tick the **ethics check** (all engagement real; no bought likes/followers/reviews).

Required deliverables:

- A **published link, draft/unlisted link, or Status screenshot** (proof the item is finished and shareable).
- The completed **Analytics-Note Template**.
- A **screenshot of the analytics/insights screen** (or a clear photo of the numbers).

Submission format: Save as `Analytics_YourName.docx` (or `.txt`), include the link(s) and screenshot, and upload to `/Content-Creation/Week3/Analytics/`. Keep a copy in your capstone folder â€" it is required evidence.

Deadline: Before Session 9 (bring the link and note to the capstone session).

Marking rubric (10 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Item is genuinely published or drafted	2	A working public link, unlisted link, or draft/Status is shown and is complete
Real numbers recorded (not invented)	2	Views, saves, shares, comments (and retention if shown) with real values
Interpretation is honest and correct	2	Says clearly what the numbers suggest (e.g., weak hook early; strong interest via saves)
One specific change identified	2	Concrete and content-related (e.g., "open with a person wearing the dress"), not vague
Comments handled / ethics check	1	Any comment handled politely; ethics box ticked honestly
Clarity and completeness	1	Neat, legible, all template fields addressed

Common mistakes to avoid: inventing numbers; recording only views; deleting a post instead of reporting honestly; a vague "it did okay" with no change; arguing with a comment; and (never) buying engagement to make numbers look better.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

Evidence: Adaeze "3 reasons" reel â€" public Instagram link (or unlisted), screenshot attached.

Analytics note (model â€" matches the capstone sample note, Instructor Guide line ~177):

```
CONTENT ANALYTICS NOTE
Business / brand: Adaeze Fashion
Post title: "3 reasons our ankara never disappoints"
Platform: Instagram Reels   Date posted: Monday
Status: public

FIRST-DAY NUMBERS (24 hours):
Views: 214
Watch time (total): 4 min 20 sec
Average view duration: 5 seconds (of a 30s reel)
Retention: dropped sharply at second 2
Saves: 9   Shares: 3   Comments: 4   Likes: 37
Follows gained: 5

WHAT THE NUMBERS SUGGEST:
Views were modest, and the retention graph shows people left at
second 2 â€" the still hanger shot was a weak hook. But the high
saves (9) and the price questions in the comments show the product
and message interest the right local audience.

ONE CHANGE I WILL MAKE NEXT TIME:
Open with a person wearing the dress and moving, with the text
hook on screen from second one.

COMMENTS HANDLED: 4 â€" 1 thank-you, 2 price questions answered,
1 complaint moved to DM.
```

```
ETHICS CHECK: All engagement is real. No bought likes, followers,
reviews, or fake comments. â˜‘ Confirmed
```

A strong learner solution differs in numbers and topic but ticks every rubric row and is **honest about small numbers**.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers are in the Instructor Key below. Do not show learners the key until they have attempted all six questions.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what does "publishing" mean, and name **two** privacy-friendly alternatives to posting publicly.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which number is the **best** sign that people found your video genuinely worth keeping? a) Views b) Likes c) Saves d) Video length

Q3. Match the term to its meaning. *(terms: retention Â· average view duration Â· shares Â· reach)* a) How many different people saw the post. b) How long, on average, each viewer watched. c) A graph showing the percentage still watching at each moment. d) How many people sent your post to others.

Q4. True or false. Buying followers is a quick, acceptable way for a small business to look popular and get more sales.

Q5. Explain. Your retention graph drops sharply at **second 2**. What does this tell you, and name **one specific change** you would make.

Q6. Scenario. A customer comments publicly: "*You delivered my order three days late. Very bad service.*" Write a short **polite, professional reply**. Show that you do not argue and that you protect the customer's privacy.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. Publishing means putting your finished content out where an audience can see it. Two privacy-friendly alternatives: a **draft / unlisted link**, and **WhatsApp Status** (or keeping the post private/only-me). Scheduling is also acceptable. *(Accept any two.)*

A2. (c) **Saves.** A save is a deliberate action â€" the viewer decided your content was worth keeping â€" so it signals stronger interest than a view or a like.

A3. a) reach; b) average view duration; c) retention; d) shares. *(Watch for the common mix-up between "shares" and "reach".)*

A4. False. Buying followers is dishonest, breaks platform rules, and does not build real customers; platforms often remove fake followers and can restrict the account.

A5. A drop at second 2 means people **left in the first few seconds**, so the **hook was weak**. *One specific change, any of:* open with a person/product moving from second one; put the text hook on screen immediately; start with the most interesting moment instead of a still shot; make the first line a stronger question/claim. **Key:** be **specific and about the opening**, not "make better videos".

A6. A strong reply, e.g.:

> *"Hello, I am so sorry your order arrived late â€" that is not the service we want you to have. ðŸ™ Please send me your order name in a DM and I will sort it out personally today."*
>
> ***Why it scores:*** *it acknowledges and apologises honestly, **does not argue**, **does not reveal private details publicly**, moves the matter to a **DM**, and offers a **next step**. (Accept any reply with these qualities.)*

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today your work left your phone and met the world. You learned what **publishing** means (making content visible â€" not editing or exporting), and the three honest ways to do it: **public**, **draft/unlisted**, or **scheduled** (and WhatsApp Status). Good posting times help, but **consistency matters more**. You wrote a **first/pinned comment**, read your **analytics** (views, reach, watch time, average view duration, **retention**, saves, shares, comments, follows), read the **retention**

graph (early drop = weak hook, mid drop = slow pacing) and named **one specific change**. You practised **polite** comment handling, the **ethics** of honest engagement, and completed a short **analytics note** with real numbers.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Publishing = making content visible.** Editing and exporting make a file; publishing shares it. A draft/unlisted link counts.
2. **Views are noisy; saves, shares, comments and DMs are the real signals** of interest.
3. **Read the retention graph:** early drop = weak hook; mid drop = slow pacing. Name one change.
4. **Handle every comment politely and protect privacy.** Move complaints to a DM; never argue.
5. **Grow honestly.** Never buy followers, likes or fake reviews. Read your numbers, adjust, post consistently.

Connection to the next session. You now have a finished video, a thumbnail, captions, a calendar, a brand, published/draft link(s) and an analytics note. That is almost the whole package. Next session â€" **Session 9 â€" is the Capstone.** You will **assemble the complete package**, organise your folder, and **present and defend it in a short viva**: explaining your niche, audience, hooks, shot choices, edits and **results**. Bring your links, your analytics note and your best energy â€" this is where you prove "From Zero to Expert, Together."

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner **actually publishes, schedules or drafts** an item â€" not just talks about it.
- Learner reads the **whole** analytics set, not only views, and can say what saves/shares/comments mean.
- Learner looks at a retention graph and names a **weak hook** (early drop) or **slow pacing** (mid drop), then proposes a **specific** change.
- Learner replies **politely and professionally**, moving a complaint to a DM without arguing or exposing private details.
- Learner's analytics note contains **real numbers** and an honest conclusion, even when small.
- Learner refuses fake engagement and explains **why**; and can explain **public vs draft/unlisted vs scheduled** publishing.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Publishing is the same as exporting." â†' Exporting makes a file; publishing shares it.
- "Views are everything." â†' Saves, shares, comments and DMs show real interest; low day-one views are data, not failure.
- "If I do not post publicly, it does not count." â†' Draft/unlisted links are legitimate; do not delete a post that flops.
- "The algorithm is against me." â†' Fix the hook, pacing and consistency first.
- "Buying followers is normal." â†' It is cheating, breaks rules, and builds nothing real.
- "I can reply to a rude comment with fire." â†' Always stay calm and professional in public.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Analytics-term drill:** match the eight terms to eight meanings on slips; explain two aloud.
2. **Retention storytelling drill:** show three curves (early drop, mid drop, flat) and name the problem and fix for each.
3. **Publish-once drill:** have the learner publish a single draft today, screenshot the analytics, and fill one analytics note with support.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a **pre-filled caption and first comment**; the learner chooses the privacy setting, publishes/drafts, and records the numbers with help. A draft/unlisted link with a completed note is fully acceptable.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" publish/draft one item, read analytics, complete the note, and run the Simulation.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** publish **two** items and **compare** their analytics in one note â€" explain which hook retained better and why; or read the retention graph, identify **two** drop points, and propose **two** distinct changes.

Capstone links (what this session feeds):

- The **published/draft link(s)** become capstone deliverable 5 ("Published links or ready-to-publish drafts").
- The **analytics note** is capstone evidence (Instructor Guide: checkpoint end of S8 = at least one link; sample note, line ~177).
- The **retention-reading skill** is tested by **viva question 7** (early drop = weak hook; mid drop = slow pacing; name a specific change).

- **Ethics and comment handling** support the capstone's "Legal, privacy and honesty" checklist and viva question 11 (fake followers/reviews).

Timing guidance. The priority is that **every learner publishes, schedules or drafts something and records real numbers** â€" Sections H and the Simulation. If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a two-minute mention and run the Simulation as a dedicated block in the same week. Protect the publish step above polish: a learner who leaves without a link or draft has no capstone evidence from today.

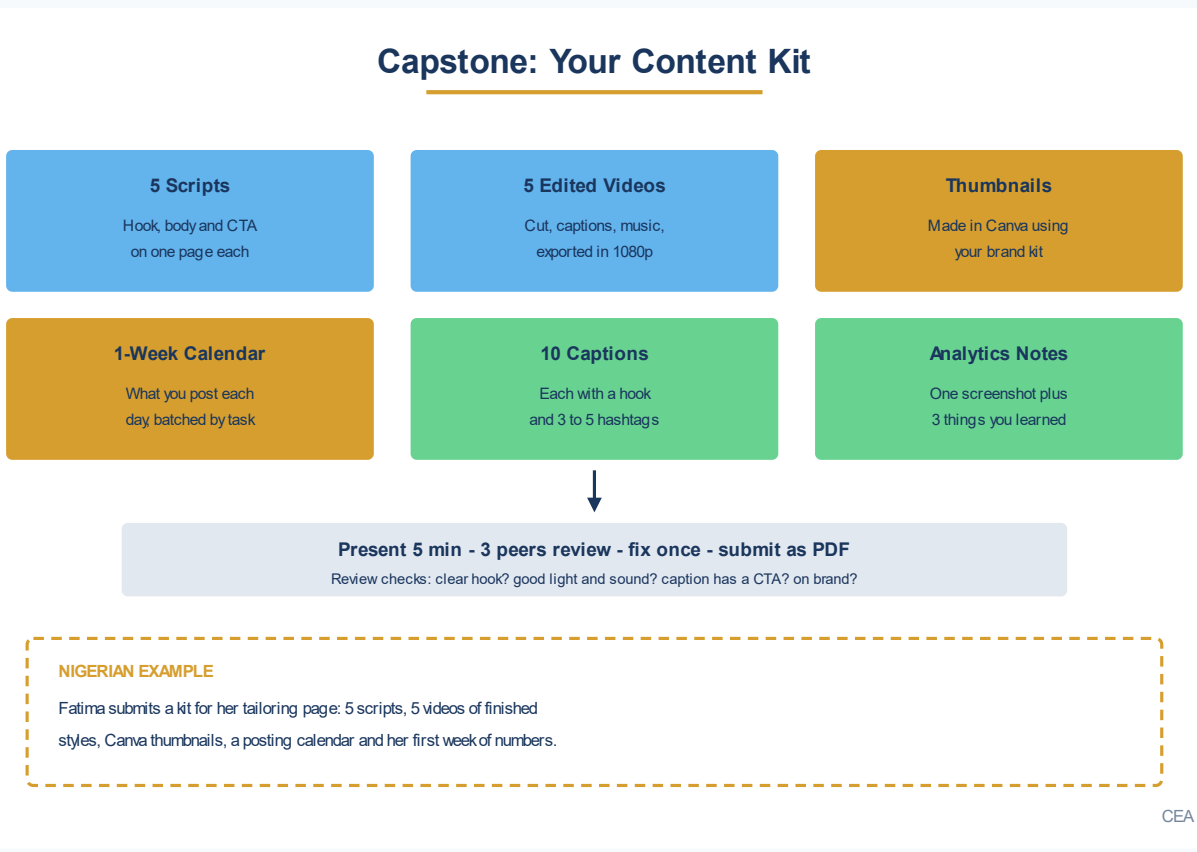
END OF SESSION 8

Next: Session 9 â€" Capstone: Assemble, Present and Review.

SESSION 09 OF 9

Capstone

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 09



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" CONTENT CREATION

SESSION 9 â€" CAPSTONE: ASSEMBLE, PRESENT AND REVIEW

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	9 of 9 (final session)
Session title	Capstone â€" Assemble, Present and Review
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Publish, Measure and Package (final session)
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner, applying Sessions 1â€"8 (no new software today)
Prerequisite knowledge	All of Sessions 1â€"8: niche, avatar and pillars (S1); shot footage (S2); clear audio and a script (S3); a first CapCut edit (S4); B-roll, music and a Canva thumbnail (S5); hooks, captions, CTAs

Item	Detail
	and hashtags (S6); a one-week calendar and brand kit (S7); published/draft links and an analytics note (S8).
Connection to previous session	The one-week calendar and analytics note from S7â€“S8 now feed the final package. In S8 you learned to read views, retention, saves and shares; today you turn that reading into a short spoken defence â€" "here is what I made, why, and what the numbers told me." Session 9 teaches no new material: it gathers every deliverable into one folder, checks it against the rubric, and presents it.
Preparation before class	(1) Print the Capstone Assessment Rubric (one per learner) and the peer-feedback form (Section I; two per learner). (2) Load the model Adaeze package on the projector (Instructor Guide). (3) Prepare the sign-off sheet: name, business, folder path, links, marks, signature. (4) Read the rubric and instructor guide in full. (5) For classes above about eight presenters, prepare a second room/assessor. (6) Remind learners to bring their whole package â€" videos, graphics, calendar, captions and links.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

This session delivers **LO10 â€" Present and defend a complete content package**: the learner can assemble a full package (videos, graphics, calendar, captions, links) and present it, explaining niche, audience, hooks, shot choices, edits and metrics.

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Assemble a complete package** in `CEA-Content-<YourName>` : three edited vertical captioned videos, three Canva graphics (two posts + one thumbnail), a one-week calendar, a captions document, and published links or ready-to-publish drafts.
2. **Organise and name files clearly** so a client could open the folder and understand it without help.
3. **Run a final quality check** against the rubric and fix the biggest gaps under time-limited build conditions.
4. **Deliver a 3â€"5 minute presentation** explaining niche, audience, hooks, shot choices, edits and metrics in their own words.
5. **Answer viva ("why") questions** on niche, hook, music/B-roll legality, B-roll placement, audio ducking, caption structure, retention, consent, thumbnail wording, strongest video, honesty and one improvement.
6. **Give and receive structured peer feedback** using a simple, respectful form.
7. **Explain the certification conditions** honestly.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One smartphone or academy computer per learner holding the finished deliverables; a cable or quick file-transfer method to the projector.
- Instructor computer connected to the projector; whiteboard and markers; a tripod (optional).

Software

- **CapCut (free)** for final trims, caption fixes or exports; **Canva (free)** for finishing a graphic or thumbnail.
- A file app (phone Files, Google Drive or a laptop folder) for organising the folder; a notes app, **Google Docs** or Word for the captions document and README.

Sample files / examples

- The model Adaeze package (Instructor Guide 5.1â€"5.7); the Viva Question Bank (Rubric Section 4); the example folder tree (Instructor Guide Section 4).

Worksheets / forms

- The Capstone Assessment Rubric; the peer-feedback form; the self-check checklist (Section H); the sign-off sheet.

Accounts / Internet

- The learner's own free publishing account to show a published or draft link; if content is private, an exported draft or WhatsApp Status screenshot counts. Internet is useful but not essential â€" build, check and presentation work offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- A learner without a working phone may present from the academy computer, a USB drive, or printed screenshots. The folder matters more than the device; pair anyone short of one file with the instructor for the last 10 minutes of the build sprint.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two folders side by side. First, the tidy `CEA-Content-<YourName>` tree â€" `01_Videos`, `02_Graphics`, `03_Planning`, `04_Raw_Footage`, `README.txt`. Second, a messy example: `VID_20261009_12938.mp4`, `IMG_5521.png`, and a caption saved as "New Text Document.txt".

What the instructor says:

> *"Three weeks ago most of you watched videos on your phone. Today you are not watching â€" you are presenting. Both folders hold the same amount of work. One you would happily send to a client paying thirty thousand naira; the other would make that client think you are not serious, even if your videos are good. Nothing new to learn today â€" everything to finish, organise, check and explain. A beautiful package you cannot explain cannot pass. That rule is fair, because a real client will ask 'why' too."*

Show of confidence: Ask every learner to hold up their device and tick off six things out loud: three videos, three graphics, a one-week calendar, a captions document, published/draft links, and a clean folder. Most have nearly everything and feel a small panic about one missing item â€" normal, and useful.

Reframe the panic (say this):

> *"If you are missing one or two things, you are not in trouble â€" you have 45 minutes to finish them. What would put you in trouble is arriving with two videos instead of three, because the package must be complete. Write one line on your rubric: the ONE missing thing you will finish first."*

Why this works: It puts the two pass-deciders on the table â€" **completeness** and **the ability to explain** â€" and converts nerves into one task per learner.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run a fast oral round-robin, one question per learner, so everyone speaks before presenting. Put the questions on the projector.

Q1 (S1â€"S2): "In one sentence, what is your niche and who is your audience avatar?"

- Expected: a specific topic/group, e.g. "affordable Ankara styles for young working women in Port Harcourt," and one named person like Blessing, a 27-year-old bank worker. Watch for a broad topic ("fashion") and ask "for whom and where."

Q2 (S2â€"S3): "Name one thing that makes phone footage look professional, and one thing that ruins audio."

- Expected: stability and good light (window light, no backlighting); a mic far from the mouth or a noisy room ruins audio. Watch for learners crediting the camera â€" it is stability, light and mic distance.

Q3 (S4â€"S5): "What is B-roll for, and what does 'legally usable music' mean?"

- Expected: B-roll covers cuts and holds the eye; legal music comes from the CapCut library, the YouTube Audio Library, or licensed free music â€" never ripped from random sites.

Q4 (S6): "What are the four parts of a caption, and how many hashtags should a beginner use?"

- Expected: hook, value, CTA, hashtags; 3â€"5 relevant tags (up to 10 acceptable) â€" relevance over volume.

Q5 (S7â€"S8): "What does a retention graph tell you, and what would you do if it drops in the first two seconds?"

- Expected: how long people watched; an early drop means the hook was weak, so open stronger next time.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Not one of those questions was about a camera. Every one was about a decision â€" who, why, how, what next. When you present, I am not checking whether your video looks like a Nollywood film; I am checking whether you can tell me why it opens the way it does. Explain your decisions and you have learned the craft."*

If more than a third cannot answer, spend five extra minutes on the four caption parts and hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA, which recur in every viva.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What the capstone is, and what "complete" means

The idea. The **capstone** is a **complete content package** for one small business â€" Adaeze Fashion, or a business you chose with approval. It is not a written exam and not one project; it is the whole body of course work, finished, organised and explained. It proves, in one folder, that you can do the whole job a small client would hire you for.

Plain-English definition. A complete package means **three edited vertical videos, three Canva graphics, a one-week calendar, a captions document, and published links or ready-to-publish drafts** â€" plus a short live presentation and viva.

The six deliverables:

#	Deliverable	What "good" looks like
1	Three edited videos	Vertical (9:16), 30â€"60s, captioned, clear voice, tight cuts, B-roll and/or music, a clear hook, a defined purpose each
2	Three Canva graphics	Two posts plus one thumbnail; readable text; one focal point; consistent brand colours and fonts
3	One-week calendar	Seven days; columns filled (date, platform, format, pillar, hook, caption idea, status); varied pillars; a lighter day
4	Captions document	A hook, caption, CTA and 3â€"5 hashtags for each video; roughly 40â€"80 words each
5	Published links or drafts	A real public link, or a clearly named exported draft; a WhatsApp Status screenshot counts
6	Presentation + viva	A 3â€"5 minute spoken walk-through and answers to "why" questions

Why "complete" is a hard gate. If any of the three videos or three graphics is entirely absent, the package is **incomplete** and the learner **cannot pass** on this attempt â€" a client who asked for three videos and three graphics does not want two videos and a promise. On the day, complete beats pretty.

The honesty rule. Every piece of music and footage must be legal, and every person who appears must have given permission. A package that uses a stolen song or films a customer without consent loses Criterion 6 and can fail the legal/privacy pass condition. Never trade trust for a quick win.

F.2 Assembling and organising the portfolio folder

The idea. Everything goes into **one folder named** `CEA-Content-<YourName>`, with subfolders for videos, graphics, planning and raw footage, plus a short README. This is 3 marks (Criterion 1) and the first thing an assessor sees.

Expected folder structure (show it on the projector):

```
CEA-Content-<YourName>/
â”œâ”€â”€ 01_Videos/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ video1_shop_intro.mp4
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ video2_care_tip.mp4
â”‚   â””â””â”€â”€ video3_customer_proof.mp4
```

```
â”œâ”€â”€ 02_Graphics/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ post1_new_stock.png
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ post2_promo.png
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ thumbnail_1280x720.png
â”œâ”€â”€ 03_Planning/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ content_calendar_week1.xlsx        (or .docx / a clear photo of a paper sheet)
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ captions_document.docx
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ script_video1.docx
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ storyboard_video1.(jpg/png/pdf)
â”œâ”€â”€ 04_Raw_Footage/                        (optional but recommended backup)
â””â”€â”€ README.txt
```

Naming. Use plain, descriptive names â€” `video2_care_tip.mp4`, not `VID_20261009_12938.mp4` â€” numbered 1, 2, 3 in presentation order.

The README (one short paragraph). Name the business, the platforms, and one line about each video, e.g.: "*Adaeze Fashion â€” Port Harcourt Ankara shop. Video 1: shop introduction (Instagram Reel). Video 2: Ankara care tip (TikTok). Video 3: customer proof (Instagram Reel).*"

Keep a backup of raw footage. Phones get lost, cards corrupt. `04_Raw_Footage` is your insurance â€” if a last-minute export fails, you cannot fix it without the source. A real client judges your professionalism by whether the folder looks organised.

F.3 The final quality check against the rubric

The idea. Before you present, run your package through the exact rubric the assessor will use. You are not guessing what "good" means â€” the rubric tells you.

The nine rubric criteria (30 marks) at a glance:

#	Criterion	Marks	Self-check question
1	Package completeness & folder organisation	3	Are all six deliverables present and clearly named?
2	Video hook & shooting craft	5	Do all three videos hook in the first 3 seconds; is footage stable, lit, framed?
3	Video audio quality	3	Is the voice clear, close to the mic, above the background?
4	Video editing â€” cuts & captions	5	Are silences cut; are captions correct at 3â€“5 words per line?
5	Video enhancement â€” B-roll, music, transitions	3	Does B-roll cover cuts; does music sit under the voice?
6	Legal & safe media use	2	Is all media allowed; is consent obtained where people appear?
7	Graphics â€” 2 posts + 1 thumbnail	5	On-brand, readable, thumbnail matches the video?
8	One-week content calendar	2	Are all 7 days filled with varied pillars?
9	Captions document	2	Does each video have a hook, value, CTA and 3â€“5 hashtags?

How to run the self-check (10 minutes) â€” fix in this order:

1. **Completeness.** Confirm all six deliverables exist and open. A missing video is fatal; a shaky one is not.
2. **Captions.** Auto-captions often carry wrong words. Fix them and keep 3â€“5 words per line.
3. **Audio balance.** Play a video on the speaker; if you cannot hear the voice over the music, lower (duck) the music.
4. **Thumbnail match.** Make it honestly represent the video; clickbait loses Criterion 7 and 6.
5. **Calendar and captions document.** Fill empty cells.
6. **Polish last.** Only then worry about a fancy transition or colour.

Worked example. Adaeze's self-check: "Video 2 captions had two wrong words â€” fixing. Music in Video 1 too loud at 0:30 â€— lowering. Biggest gap: Video 2 audio slightly noisy â€— will re-export with the fan off." She named her biggest gap and a fix â€— the honesty the viva rewards.

F.4 Preparing and structuring the 3â€“5 minute presentation

The idea. Your presentation is a spoken walk-through of the package, about 3â€“5 minutes. You open files, show the work, and explain the decisions behind it. It is not a script reading and not a feature list.

Why it matters. The presentation carries a separate 5-mark viva component and convinces the assessor the skill is in your head, not just in the software. A strong presenter with a modest package can score highly; a weak presenter with a beautiful package loses the "explains why" marks.

A reliable 5-part structure:

Part	Time	What you do	Example line
1. Introduction	~30s	Name the business, niche and avatar	"I created a one-week package for Adaeze Fashion, an Ankara shop in Port Harcourt. My niche is affordable Ankara for young working women; my avatar is Blessing, a 27-year-old bank worker who hates being overcharged."
2. Package tour	~1 min	Open the folder; show the videos, graphics, calendar and captions	"Here is my folder. Video 1 introduces the shop, Video 2 teaches an Ankara care tip, Video 3 is customer proof."
3. Key decisions	~2 min	Explain why: hook, shot choices, edits, music	"I opened Video 2 with the problem â€” 'Your Ankara is fading because of this one mistake' â€” because my avatar's biggest worry is wasting money on clothes that fade."
4. Metrics	~45s	Read the analytics note in plain words	"Video 1 got 214 views; retention dropped at second 2, so my text-only hook was weak â€” next time I will open with the dress on a person."
5. Close	~30s	State your strongest video and one improvement	"My strongest is Video 3 because the customer story earns trust; my first improvement is a stronger opening frame on Video 1."

How to speak. Stand, look at the audience, and open each file before you talk about it. Play only 5â€“8 seconds of each video and describe the rest. **Do not read a script** â€” it sounds flat and fails the "explains key decisions" line: three bullet cards are fine, paragraphs are not.

F.5 Running the viva â€” answering "why" questions

The idea. The **viva** is a short spoken Q&A after (or during) your presentation. The assessor asks three to five "why" questions from the viva bank, and you answer in your own words. A package can be copied, but understanding cannot be faked.

The viva bank â€” what you may be asked (learn the reasons):

Question	What a good answer shows
"What is your niche, and why?"	A narrow topic/group; focus helps people remember the page.
"Why does your video start the way it does?"	The first 3 seconds make a viewer stop; a problem, question or claim that matters to the audience.
"Where did your music and B-roll come from, and may you use them?"	CapCut library, YouTube Audio Library, or licensed free music; B-roll shot by you. Never ripped.
"Why did you put B-roll where you put it?"	To cover cuts/jump cuts and hold the eye, roughly every 5â€“7 seconds.
"How did you make the voice clear under the music?"	By ducking â€” lowering the music under the voice so the voice is always loudest.
"Why is your caption in that structure?"	Hook line, short value, CTA, 3â€–5 hashtags; ~40â€–80 words with line breaks.
"What does the retention graph tell you, and what would you change?"	How long people watched; an early drop = weak hook, a mid-video drop = slow pacing.

Question	What a good answer shows
"How did you get permission to film people?"	Asked each person directly (a guardian for under-18s), explained where it would appear, respected a no.
"Why is a thumbnail with three strong words better than a busy one?"	Readable at a glance; one focal point; strong contrast; honest.
"Which of your three videos is strongest, and why?"	A comparison referencing hook, value, editing or CTA â€” not just "the most likes."
"Why is buying followers or a fake review a bad idea?"	Dishonest, damages trust, breaches platform rules, builds no real customers.
"If you had one more week, what would you improve first, and why?"	A specific, prioritised answer; the reasoning matters more than the choice.

How to answer well. Use your own words â€” if you feel yourself reciting, stop and say it plainly. Give a reason, not a fact: "I put B-roll at 0:08 to cover the jump-cut where I changed my sentence" beats "I put B-roll at 0:08." Be honest about weak points. Point at specifics.

The honesty question. If asked about fake engagement, do not be clever: buying followers or posting fake reviews is dishonest, damages trust, can breach platform rules, and builds no real customers. CEA expects the straight answer.

F.6 Peer-feedback etiquette

The idea. While your classmate presents, you fill a peer-feedback form. Peer feedback makes the presenter better, teaches you to see craft, and is done with respect.

The three rules of good peer feedback:

1. **Be specific.** "It was nice" helps nobody. "The hook on Video 2 made me stop because I also hate clothes that fade" tells the presenter exactly what worked.
2. **Be kind and honest together.** One genuine strength, then one improvement. Never mock or compare to "better" learners.
3. **Comment on the work, not the person.** "The captions were a little small" â€” not "you are bad at captions."

What the form contains (see Section I). A strength, an improvement, one idea for the next video, and a thank-you line. The presenter keeps the form as evidence of peer review. When receiving feedback: listen without interrupting, do not defend, write it down, and thank the person. You need not act on every comment, but you must hear it.

Every line of feedback should be specific, tied to the rubric, and worded as help, not attack. Section G.4 shows a full worked example.

F.7 The Session 9 run-of-show (105 minutes)

#	Block	Time	What happens
1	Brief and restate the rules	5 min	Opening and ground rules (Section D); the two-hint limit; the deliverable list.
2	Model presentation	8 min	Instructor walks the reference Adaeze package (Section G).
3	Build sprint	45 min	Learners finish, organise and self-check (Section H). Instructor circulates; two-hint limit.
4	Presentations and viva	40 min	~4â€“5 min per learner; two parallel rooms if the class is large.
5	Wrap-up, reflection, sign-off	7 min	Recap, certificate conditions, sign-off sheet, close and celebrate.

The two-hint limit. Each learner may ask a maximum of two hints, and a hint is a question, not an answer. If a learner says "my video is too long, what do I do?", reply with a question: "Which parts repeat themselves â€” a greeting, a pause, or a second example?" The learner still does the work, because a capstone the instructor edits is not the learner's work.

If time runs short: cut the model presentation to a quick mention, set the reflection as take-home, and protect the presentations â€" a learner who does not present has an incomplete capstone. For more than eight presenters, run two parallel rooms with a second assessor using the same rubric.

F.8 Certification conditions

The idea. At the end of Session 9, the instructor confirms who is ready for certification. The certificate is earned by meeting clear conditions, not by attendance alone.

Conditions to be recommended for the CEA Certificate in Content Creation:

1. **Attendance:** at least 7 of the 9 sessions (a gate, but never a substitute for competence).
2. **Assignments:** all submitted and judged satisfactory.
3. **Capstone package:** a pass â€" at least 50% overall AND a complete package.
4. **Legal and privacy:** music and footage used legally; consent obtained where people appear.
5. **Presentation:** the learner has presented the package and answered the viva.

The pass rule in one sentence: *To pass you need 50% or more overall, a complete package, and to have presented and explained it. A pretty package you cannot explain cannot pass.*

Verification. The certificate verifies at **cea.ng/certificates/verify** â€" quote your reference when sharing it.

If a learner is not yet competent. Below 50%, an incomplete package, or an inability to explain the work means "not yet." Remediation is targeted: find the single biggest gap, do one focused practice, then retake. A retake is normal and is not a failure â€" the learner keeps all work already done.

Record-keeping before anyone leaves. Record on the sign-off sheet: name, business used, folder path, published/draft links, marks, signature.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

The demonstration happens before the build sprint, so learners have a model in mind while they work.

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- On the projector: the model Adaeze package â€" the folder tree, the three video descriptions (5.1), the three graphics (5.2), the sample caption (5.6), the sample calendar (5.5) and the sample analytics note (5.7).
- A partly completed peer-feedback form and the rubric on screen, so learners see which line each demo aims at.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" the model presentation (5 minutes)

Say: "Watch how I present, then you will do the same. Notice I do not read â€" I explain." Walk the reference package aloud using the five-part structure from F.4, in about four minutes:

> *"This is my package for Adaeze Fashion â€" an Ankara shop in Port Harcourt. My niche is affordable Ankara for young working women; my avatar is Blessing, a 27-year-old bank worker who hates being overcharged. (Open the folder.) Here is my folder: `01_Videos`, `02_Graphics`, `03_Planning`, and a README.*
>
> *Video 1 introduces the shop, opening on a close-up of a bright Ankara dress with 'The Ankara shop Port Harcourt keeps talking about' â€" a clear, confident claim in the first three seconds stops my fast-scrolling avatar. The owner then speaks in window light, with B-roll of hands arranging dresses covering the cuts. Video 2 teaches a care tip, opening with the problem â€" 'Your Ankara is fading because of this one mistake.' Video 3 is customer proof: a customer smiling, with 'She almost did not buy this dress' â€" honest, because she really did hesitate. My graphics share the brand colours and fonts, and the thumbnail is three words, 'NEW ANKARA STYLES,' matching Video 1.*
>
> *On metrics: Video 1 got 214 views, but retention dropped at second 2, so my text-only hook was weak â€" next time I will open with the dress on a person, not a hanger. My strongest video is Video 3 because the customer story earns trust; if I had one more week, I would reshoot Video 1's opening frame."*

Then point at the rubric: "Notice I touched every marked thing â€" hook, shooting craft, audio, captions, B-roll, legal media, graphics, calendar and captions document â€" and I explained why. That is the standard."

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" answering three viva questions aloud (7 minutes)

Say: "Now watch me answer viva questions with a reason, not a fact." Answer each in about 40â€"60 seconds, thinking aloud:

1. **"Where did your music and B-roll come from, and are you allowed to use them?"**

   > *"The music is from the CapCut library, which is free to use inside the app. The B-roll â€" hands arranging dresses, fabric in water â€" I shot myself in the shop. Nothing came from another creator's video, so yes, I am allowed to use all of it."*

2. **"How did you make sure the voice is clear under the music?"**

   > *"I used ducking. In CapCut I selected the music track and set the volume low, around 15â€"20 percent, so it sits under my voice but is still audible. I tested it on the phone speaker â€" if I could not hear my own words clearly, I lowered the music more."*

3. **"What does the retention graph tell you, and what would you change next time?"**

   > *"It tells me how long people kept watching. My graph dropped at second 2, meaning my first seconds did not hold them â€" almost always a weak hook. Next time I would open with the dress on a person instead of a text card on a hanger, because a face and movement stop the scroll better than words alone."*

Then ask the class: "Did you notice I never just said 'I lowered the music'? I said why and how I checked â€" the difference between a fact and an answer. In my metrics answer I admitted the hook failed and named the fix. That honesty is what the viva rewards."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" showing the peer-feedback form (3 minutes)

Put the partly completed form on screen and read it aloud:

> ***Strength:*** *"The hook on Video 3 â€" the customer smiling before we hear her â€" made me want her story."* ***Improvement:*** *"The music in Video 1 is nearly as loud as your voice; lowering it will help your words land."* ***Next-video idea:*** *"Open with the price on screen, since your avatar worries about cost."* ***Thank you:*** *"Well done â€" this package is clear and honest."*

Say: "Three specific lines. No 'it was nice.' When you give feedback today, follow this shape â€" one strength, one improvement, one idea. When you receive yours, listen and thank the person."

Ask the class: "Which rubric line was I aiming at when I explained the hook?" (Criterion 2.) "Why did I play only a few seconds of each video?" (My minutes are for explaining.) "Why did I admit my hook was weak?" (Honest self-review is rewarded.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: In this build sprint, each learner finishes, organises and self-checks their complete package so it is ready to present.

Starting materials: your phone or computer with all deliverables; CapCut and Canva open for last-minute fixes; the rubric and the self-check checklist; a device you can present from.

Procedure (instructor calls each step; learners work; instructor circulates; two-hint limit):

1. **Create or open** `CEA-Content-<YourName>` with the four subfolders: `01_Videos`, `02_Graphics`, `03_Planning`, `04_Raw_Footage`.
2. **Gather every deliverable** into the correct subfolder â€" three videos, three graphics, calendar, captions document, script and storyboard. Copy raw clips into `04_Raw_Footage`.

3. **Rename files in plain words:** `video1_shop_intro.mp4`, `post1_new_stock.png`, `thumbnail_1280x720.png`, `content_calendar_week1.xlsx`, `captions_document.docx`. No `VID_...` or `IMG_...` names remain.
4. **Write the README** â€" one short paragraph: business, platforms, one line per video.
5. **Completeness check.** Open every file; confirm all three videos play and all three graphics open. **Pause and predict:** "Is anything missing entirely?" If a video or graphic is missing, that is your first fix.
6. **Caption fix.** Read every caption line; correct wrong words; keep 3â€"5 words per line with contrast/stroke.
7. **Audio balance.** Play each video on the speaker; if music competes with the voice, lower the music. **Pause and predict:** "Can I hear every word clearly?"
8. **Thumbnail match.** Confirm the thumbnail honestly matches the video and shows about three clear words.
9. **Calendar and captions document.** Fill empty cells; confirm 7 days and a hook/value/CTA/hashtags for each video.
10. **Run the self-check checklist** and fix the single biggest remaining gap; re-export any re-edited video.

Expected result: a complete, organised, self-checked package ready to present. The two key predictions: after step 5, "What ONE thing, if missing, would fail my package?" (a whole video or graphic); after step 7, "If voice and music are fighting, which wins?" (the voice â€" duck the music).

Success criteria (ready to present when all are true): all six deliverables exist and open; files named and sorted; README complete; captions correct and readable (3â€"5 words/line); voice clearly above music on all three videos; thumbnail honestly matches a video; calendar covers 7 days with varied pillars.

Final self-check checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Folder with `01_Videos`, `02_Graphics`, `03_Planning`, `04_Raw_Footage`, `README.txt`
- ☐ Three videos present, play, vertical, 30â€"60s, captioned
- ☐ Voice clear above the music on all three videos
- ☐ Cuts remove silences/greetings; no abrupt endings
- ☐ Three graphics present (2 posts + 1 thumbnail), on-brand and readable
- ☐ Thumbnail matches a video with about 3 words
- ☐ One-week calendar with all 7 days and varied pillars
- ☐ Captions document: hook, value, CTA, 3â€"5 hashtags per video
- ☐ Published links or clearly named drafts recorded
- ☐ Music/footage legal; consent obtained where people appear
- ☐ README written

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task (done independently, in front of peers): Each learner presents their package and answers a viva, then fills a peer-feedback form for the classmate who presented before them. One learner presents while others watch and complete forms, rotating until everyone has presented.

Scenario. You are the freelance creator who delivered Adaeze Fashion's launch-week package. Adaeze (the instructor, playing the client) is in the room. She wants a 3â€"5 minute walk-through and will ask you "why" three to five times. She is fair, but she will not accept a package you cannot explain.

Requirements (presenter):

1. Deliver a 3â€"5 minute presentation using the five-part structure (introduction, package tour, key decisions, metrics, close).
2. Open your actual folder and show real files.
3. Explain your niche and avatar, two hook choices, one shooting/editing choice, one B-roll or music choice, one thumbnail choice, and your analytics reading in your own words.
4. Answer three to five viva questions from the bank (F.5) in your own words.
5. Do not read a script.

Requirements (observer): While a classmate presents, complete the peer-feedback form and hand it to them at the end.

Peer-feedback form (two copies per learner):

```
CEA CONTENT CREATION â€” SESSION 9 PEER-FEEDBACK FORM

Presenter's name: _____  Reviewer's name: _____

1. STRENGTH (be specific â€” name the exact moment or file):
   _____

2. IMPROVEMENT (one clear, kind suggestion):
   _____

3. ONE IDEA FOR THEIR NEXT VIDEO:
   _____

4. RUBRIC LINE THAT STOOD OUT (tick one): [ ] Hook [ ] Audio [ ] Editing
   [ ] Graphics [ ] Calendar [ ] Captions [ ] Legal/consent [ ] Presentation

5. THANK YOU LINE:
   _____

What I learned from watching this package (one line):
   _____
```

Time allowance: each presenter ~4â€“5 minutes (presentation + viva); the block runs about 40 minutes.

Success criteria (presenter): presentation is 3â€“5 minutes and uses five parts; speaks so the class can hear; opens files rather than describing them; explains why for hooks, edits, B-roll/music, thumbnail and metrics in own words; answers viva questions with reasoning and honest weak points; does not read a script.

Hints if stuck (two-hint limit):

- Hint 1: If you forget the structure, return to the five parts: intro, tour, decisions, metrics, close.
- Hint 2: If a viva question stumps you, describe what you did, why, and what you would change.
- Hint 3: If your voice shakes, picture the shop owner Adaeze in the seats and explain to her.

INSTRUCTOR-ONLY MARKING KEY (do not show learners)

This key maps what you see and hear during the presentation and viva onto the 30-mark package rubric and the 5-mark viva rubric. Mark the package the learner assembled and the reasoning they showed, not today's nerves.

A. Scoring the 30-mark package (from the assembled folder; Rubric Section 2):

Rubric area	Marks	What to look/listen for today	Rough scoring guidance
Completeness & folder	3	All six deliverables present, named, sorted	3 = all present & tidy; 2 = most present, naming messy; 1 = half; 0 = under half
Hook & shooting craft	5	First 3 seconds of each video stop you; footage stable, lit, framed	Band set by the weakest of the three videos, adjusted up if the other two are strong
Audio quality	3	Voice clear above the music on the speaker	If you must strain to hear, cap at 1â€“2
Cuts & captions	5	Silences removed; captions correct, 3â€“5 words/line, readable	Wrong words or crowding drops the band
B-roll, music, transitions	3	B-roll covers cuts (~5â€“7s); music sits under the voice	Over-use of transitions or loud music caps the band
Legal & safe media	2	Music/footage allowed; consent obtained	Any ripped song or unclear consent caps at 0â€“1
Graphics (2 posts + 1 thumbnail)	5	On-brand, readable, one focal point; thumbnail matches video	A missing graphic makes the package incomplete
Calendar	2	7 days, varied pillars, all columns filled	A page of 7 promotions caps at 1

Rubric area	Marks	What to look/listen for today	Rough scoring guidance
Captions document	2	Hook, value, CTA, 3â€"5 hashtags per video	A missing video's captions caps at 1

Completeness gate (apply first): if any one of the three videos or three graphics is entirely absent, the package is incomplete â€" the learner cannot pass on this attempt. Note the gap, give the remediation path, and still record marks for what exists.

B. Scoring the 5-mark presentation/viva (Rubric Section 3):

Viva item	Marks	What earns the mark	What loses it
Presents clearly and confidently	1	Speaks so the class can hear; opens the work and walks through it	Mumbling; describing files instead of showing them
Explains why key decisions were made	2	Own reasoning on niche, hook, B-roll, music, thumbnail	Reading a script; stating facts with no reasons
Answers viva questions correctly	1	Sound answers to three-to-five questions	Cannot explain a basic choice
Shows evidence (links/drafts, analytics, peer review)	1	A real link/draft, an analytics note, or a peer-feedback form	No evidence at all

C. Sample strong viva responses (accept any answer showing understanding):

- **Niche:** "Affordable Ankara for young working women in Port Harcourt â€" focus helps people remember my page."
- **Hook:** "The first three seconds must stop the scroll; I opened with the fading-Ankara problem because that is my avatar's real worry."
- **Ducking:** "I lowered the music under my voice so the voice is always the loudest layer."
- **Retention:** "It dropped at second 2, so my text-only hook was weak â€" next time I open with the dress on a person."
- **Consent:** "I asked each person directly and said where it would appear; I respected a no."

D. The hardest moment â€" a good package the learner cannot explain. Say plainly and kindly: "It looks good â€" now tell me why. Why this hook? Why this music?" If the learner still cannot explain, award the package marks the folder earned but mark the presentation/viva rows honestly (likely 1â€"2 of 5). A package the learner cannot explain cannot pass; the honest path is a targeted retake.

E. Fairness. Use the same rubric lines for every learner and business (fashion, food, salon, church, personal brand). Reward function over prettiness â€" a plain but complete, honest, explainable package beats a stylish incomplete one. Note any support given to a Level 1 learner on the sign-off sheet.

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Blessing* (a CEA Port Harcourt learner) used a church media team as her capstone business instead of Adaeze Fashion. The church wanted to grow its youth outreach, but its page posted only event flyers captioned "Come and worship with us," and attendance was flat. Blessing built a complete package: three videos (a Sunday testimony from a young member, a 40-second "what to expect on Sunday" walk-through, and behind-the-scenes of the media team), three graphics (two invitation posts and a thumbnail), a one-week calendar, a captions document, and a published draft link for the testimony.

Relevant facts. The testimony opened with the young member's face and the words *"I almost stopped coming to church"* â€" a strong, honest hook. The walk-through used B-roll of the building, instruments and a smiling greeter while the voice explained what a first-time visitor should expect. Blessing asked the member and her parent (she was 17) before filming, told her where it would appear, and respected one person who declined. The calendar rotated pillars â€" teach, show, trust â€" instead of seven identical invitations. Her analytics note: the testimony draft got 180 views in three days, lost about half the viewers around second 2, earned 11 shares and 3 comments, all replied to.

Decision point. When the media lead asked "why is this different from our old flyers?", what should Blessing say?

Possible approaches. 1) "It just looks better." 2) "I used a hook, a clear structure, legal music, captions and a varied calendar â€" every post has a reason and a next step, and I read the numbers so we know the hook needs work." 3) "I copied a bigger

church's videos."

Recommended solution. Approach 2. The difference is not decoration but method: a hook that earns the first three seconds, captions for people watching with sound off, legal music, a balanced calendar, and an honest reading of the numbers.

What actually happened. The church used the package for one month of outreach. Three young people told the team they came because of the testimony. Blessing named the limit honestly in her viva: "It was 180 views on a draft, not a viral video; the hook still loses people at second 2, so the next one must open with a face and movement." The church then asked her to handle its weekly posts for a small monthly fee.

Trade-offs / honest limits. The package did not make the church famous; it moved the needle slightly and gave the team a repeatable method. The weak hook was discovered by reading retention, not guesswork. Getting consent cost time and one person said no â€" respecting that no is part of the job.

Professional connection. This is exactly the work a small content creator is paid to do â€" for a church, a shop or a salon: a strong hook, clear captions, legal media, a varied calendar and an honest reading of the numbers. Blessing's first real paid client came directly from her capstone package.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide in the build sprint and during feedback. Point the learner to the row and ask a question rather than fixing it for them.

Mistake	Why it happens	Fix
Arriving with an incomplete package (two videos, two graphics, no calendar)	Left it to the last day; treated the calendar as "just planning"	Open the folder and tick the six deliverables; finish the missing item first. A missing whole video/graphic fails the package.
A good package the learner cannot explain	Copied a format without understanding the reason	Revisit the reason for each choice â€" niche, hook, B-roll, music, thumbnail â€" and practise explaining.
Reading a script instead of explaining	Nerves; a belief that memorising is safer	Reduce to three bullet cards and speak from them; the rubric wants your own words.
Unedited auto-captions	Trusting CapCut Auto captions	Read every line; fix wrong words; keep 3â€"5 words per line with contrast/stroke.
Stolen or unlicensed music	Grabbing a favourite song	Remove it; replace with CapCut library, YouTube Audio Library, or licensed free music.
Blurry or backlit footage	Dirty lens, movement, digital zoom, subject facing away from light	Wipe the lens; brace the phone; step closer instead of zooming; turn the subject to the light; reshoot key shots.
Clickbait thumbnail that does not match the video	Chasing clicks	Rebuild from a real frame of the video;

Mistake	Why it happens	Fix
		keep about three honest words.
No published or draft link	Fear, or time	Publish a draft/unlisted link, post to WhatsApp Status, or export a clearly named draft.
Filming someone without permission	Assumed it was fine	Take the clip down; get permission (a guardian's for under-18s); respect a no.
Panic on time (build sprint)	Seeing all the gaps at once	Ask "what ONE thing, if missing, fails my package?"; work completeness â†' captions â†' audio â†' polish; if short on time, protect presentations.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: do not fix a "loud music" problem until you play the video aloud; do not rebuild a thumbnail until you compare it to the video. Confirm the cause, then correct.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Assignment 9 â€" Assemble and Rehearse the Capstone Presentation"

Purpose: To turn the whole course's work into a complete, organised, presentable package and to rehearse the spoken defence that proves the learner understands it.

Realistic scenario. You are a freelance creator who has just finished a launch-week package for a Port Harcourt business. The owner â€" and possibly a second client â€" will sit in front of you. You have 3â€"5 minutes to walk them through the package and answer their "why" questions. This assignment is your dress rehearsal.

Detailed instructions:

1. Assemble every deliverable into `CEA-Content-<YourName>` with the four subfolders and a `README.txt`.
2. Confirm the package is complete: three videos (30â€"60s, vertical, captioned), three graphics (2 posts + 1 thumbnail), a one-week calendar, and a captions document.
3. Record your published links or clearly named drafts; if kept private, save and name a draft.
4. Run the self-check checklist (Section H) and fix the single biggest gap.
5. Write five speaking bullets: niche/avatar, two hook choices, one edit or B-roll/music choice, one thumbnail choice, your metrics reading.
6. Rehearse out loud at least twice â€" once alone, once to a friend â€" aiming for 3â€"5 minutes without reading a script.
7. Prepare to answer at least five viva questions from the bank (F.5) in your own words.
8. Bring everything to Session 9 on a device you can plug into the projector, plus a backup copy.

Required deliverables: the complete folder `CEA-Content-<YourName>` with all six deliverables and a README; published links or clearly named drafts; five speaking bullet points; the rehearsed 3â€"5 minute presentation and readiness for the viva.

Submission format: Bring the folder on a phone or USB drive; the instructor records your folder path on the sign-off sheet. Also save a copy to `/Content-Creation/Week3/Capstone/` if the academy folder is available.

Deadline: Presented live in Session 9; the folder path and links are recorded before the learner leaves.

Marking rubric (20 marks â€" rehearsal and preparation, feeding into the capstone):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Package completeness & folder	5	All six deliverables present, correctly named and organised

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Presentation structure	4	3â€"5 minutes; clear intro, tour, decisions, metrics, close
Explanation of decisions	4	Own reasons for niche, hooks, edits, B-roll/music, thumbnail
Metrics reading	3	Names real numbers and says what they suggest and what to change
Viva readiness	2	Answers "why" questions with reasoning; honest about weak points
Evidence (links/drafts/peer review)	2	A real link or named draft; an analytics note or peer-feedback form

Tie to the capstone rubric. These 20 rehearsal marks mirror the 5-mark presentation/viva and the completeness and evidence lines of the 30-mark package rubric.

Certificate sign-off conditions (restate). To be recommended for the certificate the learner must: attend at least 7 of 9 sessions; submit all assignments satisfactorily; pass the capstone (50%+ overall and a complete package); use music/footage legally and respect privacy; and present the package and answer the viva. Before the learner leaves, the instructor records name, business used, folder path, published/draft links, marks and signature on the sign-off sheet.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key below. This final check consolidates the whole course.)

Q1. Short answer (S3, S6). Name the three parts of a short-video script/caption, in order, and say what each does.

Q2. Multiple choice (S2, S3). Which is the single biggest cause of bad-looking phone video? a) An expensive phone is not used. b) The footage is shaky, badly lit (often backlit) or poorly framed. c) The video is vertical instead of horizontal. d) The learner posted at the wrong time.

Q3. Explain (S3, S5). Why is audio often more important than picture, and name one thing you can do to make a voice clear under background music.

Q4. Practical (S4, S5). List three editing actions you perform in CapCut, and explain the purpose of B-roll.

Q5. Short answer (S6). How many hashtags should a beginner use, and what makes a hashtag "good"? Give one relevant example for a Port Harcourt business.

Q6. Explain (S7â€"S9). A learner posts one excellent video and then nothing for three weeks. Explain why this is a problem, and say what the one-week calendar and basic analytics are for. Finally, name two things a complete capstone package must contain that are easy to forget.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. Hook (stops the scroll in the first 3 seconds), Body/Value (the reason or benefit â€" why keep watching), CTA (tells the viewer exactly what to do next). In a caption these are followed by 3â€"5 relevant hashtags. *(Accept hookâ€"bodyâ€"CTA in any accurate wording.)*

A2. (b) Shaky, badly lit (backlit) or poorly framed footage. It is about technique â€" stability, light and framing â€" not the price of the phone or the orientation.

A3. Viewers accept imperfect picture but switch off when they cannot hear the words; if the audio is bad the message is lost even with beautiful video. To make the voice clear: keep the mic 15â€"30 cm from the mouth, record in a quiet room, and duck the music (lower it under the voice) so the voice is always loudest.

A4. Any three: import footage, trim the ends, split/cut in the middle, reorder clips, add captions/text, add transitions, add B-roll, add music, export. B-roll is secondary footage that covers cuts/jump cuts and keeps the eye interested (roughly every 5â€"7 seconds), showing what is being discussed.

A5. 3â€"5 relevant hashtags (up to 10 acceptable) â€" relevance over volume. A good hashtag is specific to the location, niche and brand, not generic (#love, #fyp). Example: #PortHarcourtFashion, #AdaezeFashion or #PHFood *(accept any specific location/niche/brand tag)*.

A6. Posting once then disappearing breaks consistency, so the platform and audience never learn what to expect and growth stalls. The one-week calendar keeps posting steady and balanced by planning which pillar goes on which day, and basic

analytics (views, retention, saves, shares, comments) show what actually worked and what to fix. Two easy-to-forget items: the one-week content calendar and the captions document.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you proved what you learned. You assembled your course work into one complete package â€" three edited vertical captioned videos, three Canva graphics (two posts and a thumbnail), a one-week content calendar, a captions document, and a published or draft link â€" organised it into a folder a client could open without help, checked it against the rubric, and explained it in your own words. You are now a capable entry-level content creator.

The five big takeaways of the whole course:

1. **Plan before you produce.** A clear niche, a real audience and a hook beat random posting every time.
2. **Technique, not equipment.** Stability, light, framing, mic distance and tight editing â€" not an expensive camera â€" make content look and sound professional.
3. **Edit for the viewer.** Trim the silences, caption everything, place B-roll to cover cuts, and duck the music under the voice.
4. **Words carry the content.** A hook, value, a CTA and a few relevant hashtags turn a video into action.
5. **Publish, measure, and be honest.** Post consistently, read the numbers, respect consent and licences, and never fake engagement.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I assemble a complete, organised content package for a small business?
- Can I explain, in my own words, why I chose each hook, edit and thumbnail?
- Can I read my analytics and name one thing to change next time?
- Can I take a client from brief to published package using only a phone and free tools?

What the certificate honestly means. The CEA Certificate in Content Creation certifies that you are a competent entry-level content creator: you can plan, shoot, edit, caption and publish a small content package using a phone and free tools, and you understand the basic craft and language of social content. It does not mean you are a professional videographer, cinematographer, photographer or fully qualified marketing strategist â€" those are deeper specialisations. CEA will not over-claim on your behalf, and you should not over-claim on your own. What you have is real, useful and honest: a strong first step that lets you take on small real-world work â€" a shop's weekly posts, a church's event recaps, a personal brand â€" with confidence, while knowing there is more to learn.

Certification note. To be recommended for the certificate you need: attendance at 7 of 9 sessions; all assignments satisfactory; a pass on the capstone (50%+ overall and a complete package); legal/safe media use; and to have presented and answered the viva. If you have a gap, the retake path is planned and supportive; a retake is normal, not a failure.

Continuing the journey ("From Zero to Expert, Together"). This capstone package is your first real portfolio item â€" keep it, improve it, add to it. From here you can take small paid or volunteer jobs and pursue advanced CEA courses. You started as someone who watched videos on a phone; you are finishing as someone who makes them, packages them, publishes them and explains them â€" and this is only the beginning.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The folder is complete, clearly named and organised without prompting.
- The learner opens real files and walks through the package without reading a script.
- The learner gives a reason (not just a description) for the niche, hook, B-roll placement, music and thumbnail.
- The learner reads their analytics accurately and names one concrete improvement.
- The learner is honest about weak points and answers viva questions in their own words.
- The learner gives specific, kind peer feedback and receives feedback without defending.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Prettiness will cover an incomplete folder." â†’ Function over prettiness; a plain complete package beats a stylish incomplete one.
- "I can read a script; it is safer." â†’ The viva rewards your own words; reading loses the "explains why" marks.
- "High likes mean the strongest video." â†’ Strength is judged on hook, value, editing and CTA, not likes alone.
- "Posting once a week is enough if it is excellent." â†’ Consistency grows a page; the calendar exists for that reason.
- "A familiar song is fine to use." â†’ Only CapCut library, YouTube Audio Library or licensed free music is allowed.
- "I do not need permission; it is my customer." â†’ Always get consent (a guardian's for under-18s) and respect a no.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Explain-it drill:** give three of the learner's own choices (hook, B-roll, thumbnail) and ask "why?" until they give a reason, not a description.
2. **Rubric self-mark:** hand over the rubric and ask the learner to score their own package honestly, then discuss gaps.
3. **Viva rehearsal:** run five bank questions in a quiet corner and coach answers in their own words.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** present a reduced but complete package with assistance â€" shorter videos, a simpler calendar â€" marked against the same rubric, landing in the C/D range. Record the support on the sign-off sheet; the package must be complete even if modest.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the full package and presentation as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** present a second hook version for one video with a predicted winner and reasoning; name the business's next three weeks of content; or explain how the package would change for a second platform.

Fair grading across different businesses. Learners may use Adaeze Fashion or their own business â€" a salon, restaurant, phone-repair shop, church media team, tailor or provisions store. Grade the technique, not the theme: apply the same rubric lines to everyone, respect faith and culture, use the same consent and privacy rules, and never reward prettiness over function.

Viva guidance summary (for the assessor). Ask three to five questions, starting easy ("what is your niche?") and building up. Listen for the learner's own words; if they read a script, prompt: "explain that as if I were Adaeze, the shop owner." Keep each viva to 2â€"3 minutes so everyone gets a fair turn. Never accept a package the learner cannot explain: award package marks for what the folder earned and mark the presentation/viva rows honestly.

Timing guidance. Protect the presentations above everything. If the room is slow, cut the model presentation to a quick mention and set the reflection as take-home, but do not let the build sprint eat the presentation block. Announce the clock during the sprint (15 and 5 minutes left). Circulate constantly; keep to the two-hint limit â€" a hint is a question, not an answer.

END OF SESSION 9

END OF COURSE â€" You began as someone who watched videos. You leave as an entry-level content creator who can plan, shoot, edit, caption, publish and explain a complete content package. Keep the package, keep improving it, and keep going. Cyber Elias Academy â€" "From Zero to Expert, Together."